An Outline of the Grammar of the Safaitic Inscriptions

Second Edition

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Preface to online document:

This is a corrected, revised, and expanded form of the first edition (2015). The online document contains sections 4-20, which cover the grammatical description of the language. In its present form, it is not typeset or proofread. Feel free to cite the document with reference to the section numbers as:

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3 Phonology and phonetics

The system of transcription adopted in the second edition of this book follows the conventions used by OCIANA, with the exception of the transcription of the plain voiceless sibilants. The traditional transcription of the phonemes of Safaitic has followed in large part the transcription, and not the pronunciation, of CAr. For example, the reflex of Proto-Semitic *ṯ is transcribed as *ẓ*, even though in CAr it was pronounced as a pharyngealized voiced interdental fricative, [ðˤ]. While there are certain drawbacks to this approach, it does help to facilitate the use of this book in conjunction with OCIANA. The representation of the sibilants, however, now follows the conventions used in the SSHB series, where *s*[1] is represented simply by *s* and *s*[2] by *ś*. This helps facilitate the search option and is more efficient as it employs a single Unicode character for the representation of these phonemes.

Proto-Semitic	OCIANA	WH	This book	Classical Arabic	ASA
[s]	s^1	s	s	س	s^1
[ɬ]	s^2	š	ś	ش	s^2
[ts]	s^1	s	s	س	s^3

Figure 10: The Safaitic voiceless plain sibilants

The following table, adapted from Huehnergard (2012:24), provides the consonant correspondences between Safaitic and the other Semitic languages.

Safaitic[1]	QCT/CAr	Ug	BH	OfAr	Gz	Akk	PS
ʾ	ا/ ى و [ʔ]	ʾ	א	א	ʾ	ʾ/∅	[ʔ]
b	ب / [b]	*b*	ב	ב	*b*	*b*	[b]
g	ب/[g]	*g*	ג	ג	*g*	*g*	[g]
d	د / [d]	*d*	ד	ד	*d*	*d*	[d]
h	ه / [h]	*h*	ה	ה	*h*	ʾ/∅	[h]
w	و / [w]	*w*	ו	ו	*w*	*w*	[w]
z	ر / [z]	*z*	ז	ז	*z*	*z*	[dz]
ḥ	ح / [ħ]	*ḥ*	ח	ח	*ḥ*	ʾ/∅	[ħ]
ṭ	ط / [tˤ]	*ṭ*	ט	ט	*ṭ*	*ṭ*	[tʼ]
y	ى / [y]	*y*	י	י	*y*	*y*	[j]
k	ك / [k]	*k*	כ	כ	*k*	*k*	[k]
l	ل / [l]	*l*	ל	ל	*l*	*l*	[l]
m	م / [m]	*m*	מ	מ	*m*	*m*	[m]
n	ن / [n]	*n*	נ	נ	*n*	*n*	[n]
s */s/	س / [s]	*š*	ס	ס	*s*	*š*	[ts]
ʿ	ع /[ʕ]	ʿ	ע	ע	ʿ	ʾ/∅	[ʕ]
f */p/	ف / [f]	*f*	פ	פ	*f*	*p*	[p]
ṣ	ص / [sˤ]	*ṣ*	צ	צ	*ṣ*	*ṣ*	[tsʼ]
ḍ */ṣ̌/	ض / [ɮˤ]	*ṣ*	צ	ע	*ḍ*	*ṣ*	[tɬʼ]
q	ق/ [q]	*q*	ק	ק	*q*	*q*	[kʼ]

[1] When the transcription of glyphs in phonetic reconstructions of Safaitic differs significantly from the conventional transcription, the phonological transcription follows an asterisk between two front slashes, */x/.

r	ر / [r]	*r*	ר	ר	*r*	*r*	[r]
s	س / [s]	*s/ś*	ש	ש	*s*	*š*	[s]
t	ت / [t]	*t*	ת	ת	*t*	*t*	[t]
ṯ	ث/ [θ]	*ṯ*	ש	ת	*s*	*š*	[θ]
ḫ	ح / [x]	*ḫ*	ח	ח	*ḫ*	*ḫ*	[x]
ḏ	ذ / [ð]	*ḏ/d*	ז	ד	*z*	*z*	[ð]
ẓ */*ṭ*/	ظ / [ðˤ]	*ẓ/ġ*	צ	ט	*ṣ*	*ṣ*	[tθ’]
ġ	ع / [ɣ]	*ġ*	ע	ע	*ġ*	*ḫ/∅*	[ɣ]
ś */*ɬ*/	س/ [ʃ]	*š*	ש	ס	*ś*	*š*	[ɬ]

Figure 11: Semitic Sound Correspondences

Our knowledge of the phonetic realization of the Safaitic consonants derives mainly from the small number of Safaitic-Greek and Safaitic-Aramaic bilingual and partial bilingual inscriptions. To date, these consist almost exclusively of personal names. Loanwords and the spelling of foreign names in the Safaitic script also shed light on this issue. Greek transcriptions of Arabic names and vocabulary from the settled areas of the pre-Islamic southern Levant can complement this data and help fill in gaps in documentation. These sources are not entirely uniform, indicating that the Safaitic script conceals a degree of phonological variation in the spoken registers.

3.1 Consonants

*3.1.1 The voiceless plosives, *p, *t, *k*

The Safaitic-Greek bilinguals and Greek transcriptions suggest that the voiceless plosives, *t* and *k* were aspirated, [t^h] and [k^h], respectively; *t* = θ: Λοβαιαθου= *lb’t* (MISS.J 1); Θαιμος = *tm* (NEJII 1); *k* = χ: Χεσεμαν = *kḥsmn* (MISS.I 1); Αμμασιχηνος = *hmsk* (IGWS 1).

The realization of **p* is difficult to ascertain. The Greek of this period and region has no means of distinguishing between [f] and [p^h]. Safaitic authors, however, consistently render both Greek π [p] and φ [p^h] with the *f* glyph: *flfṣ* (KRS 1991) = Φίλιππος; *grfṣ* (KRS 1023) = Ἀγρίππας. This, I think, tips the scale towards a [p^h] realization, as one might expect the use of *b* to transcribe π otherwise. The significance of this pattern is brought into relief when we consider Greek imports in Sabaic. A type of South Arabian coin called <blṭt> appears in the later stages of the monetary system, which corresponds to the Athenian tetradrachm known as παλλάς (pallás), pl. παλλάδες (Beeston 1994: 41). We can be sure that Sabaic realized Proto-Semitic *p as [f] as Pliny the younger recorded the name of the autumnal incense crop in Latin as CARFIATHUM (Beeston et al. 1982: 62), corresponding to Sabaic *ḫrf*. Since Sabaic did not have a [p], it borrowed Greek π with *b*, as does modern Arabic. This contrasts with Safaitic, which uses its *f* glyph (etymological *p, CAr f), to render Greek [p], supporting the notion

that it retained its Proto-Semitic value.

*3.1.2 The voiced plosives, *b, *d, *g*

Greek utilizes β and δ to transcribe the voiced plosives *b* and *d* and there is no evidence for allophonic variation. Likewise, Safaitic **g* is consistently represented by Greek Gamma: *ḥg* = Αγγηνος (C 2823-4 + Greek); *gḥfl* = Γαφαλου (NEJII 1). Safaitic writers also use the *g* glyph to transcribe Greek and Latin [g]: *grgs* (KRS 1507) = Γρηγόρης and *grmnqṣ* (LP 653) = GERMANICUS. Had the phoneme become a voiced palato-alveolar affricate ǧ [d͡ʒ], as in the traditional pronunciation of CAr, we might expect the use of *k* or *q* for this purpose. The Safaitic evidence agrees with the transcription of Arabic names in Greek epigraphy of nearby settled areas (Al-Jallad 2017a, §3.6), therefore suggesting a plosive rather than affricate value for *g*. Greek transcriptions of Arabic names in 7th and 8th c. Egyptian administrative documents approximate the palatal stop with the digraph γι (Al-Jallad 2017c, §3.3). The absence of any such attempt in the Safaitic-Greek texts favors a plain voiced velar stop [g].

*3.1.3 The interdentals *ṯ and *ḏ*

The voiceless interdental *ṯ* is given with both Greek Theta, *yṯʿ* = Ιαιθεου (WH 3562 + Greek 2), and Tau, *ġṯ*= Γαυτος (NEJII 2), which suggests that the phoneme did not find an exact equivalent in Greek, and so likely [θ]. The voiced interdental is given with Delta: *ʿwḏ* = Αουειδηνος (NEJIII 2).

*3.1.4 The velars *ḫ and *ġ*

The *ḫ* glyph occurs once in a bilingual text where it is not indicated graphically in the Greek portion *ḫlṣ* = Αλιζου (C 2823-4 + Greek). This is the most common method of transcribing the phoneme in Arabic names of the settled areas, although one does occasionally find *ḫ* transcribed with χ (Al-Jallad 2017a, § 3.2). The voiced counterpart is attested once in transcription, where it is approximated with Gamma, *ġṯ*= Γαυτος (NEJII 2). The fragmentary Safaitic evidence therefore agrees with the general patterns in the transcription of Arabic in the southern Levant.

*3.1.5 The pharyngeals *ḥ and *ʿ*

There is no reason to assume a value other than [ħ] and [ʕ], respectively. Neither of these phonemes are represented graphically in Greek transcriptions.

*3.1.6 *q*

The *q* glyph is represented in Greek transcription by Kappa indicating that it was voiceless: *qdm* = Καδαμου (NEJII 3). This agrees with the representation of the phoneme in Greek inscriptions from settled areas (Al-Jallad 2017a, §3.7.5). Its voiceless and unaspirated character is further confirmed by its use to transcribe Latin C: *ʾqlds* (KRS 1507) = CLAUDIUS and *qṣr* (Ms 44) = CAESAR. Transcriptions alone do not allow us to decide whether the phoneme was realized as a glottalized velar stop [k’] or a uvular stop [q].

*3.1.7 *ṭ*

Like *q*, *ṭ* seems to signify an unaspirated unvoiced stop, as it transcribes Greek Tau: *mrṭs* (AbaNS 656) =

Μύρτος. It is attested once in a bilingual text, *mṭr* = Ματρος (NEJIII 1), matching the practice in the epigraphy of the settled areas, where Tau is consistently employed to transcribe Arabic *ṭ* (Al-Jallad 2017a, §3.7). While Greek transcriptions cannot help us determine the emphatic correlate of this phoneme, a Palmyrene inscription from Northeastern Jordan may suggest pharyngealization. In this text (PG 1), the word for 'writer' is spelled *ṣṭr'*, which would seem to derive from the Arabic *sāṭir-*. The spelling of *s* with *ṣ* could suggest the spread of emphasis, something common with pharyngealization but not glottalization. It, thus, seem that *ṭ* was realized as [tˤ] rather than [t'].

*3.1.8 *ṯ = ẓ*

This glyph occurs once in a bilingual text, where it is transcribed with Tau: *ẓn'l* = Τανννηλος (WH 1860 + Greek 2). This agrees with the way it is transcribed in the epigraphy of the settled areas and indeed in the Harran Inscription: ظلمو= Ταλεμου (= CAr *ẓālimun*; see Al-Jallad 2017a, § 3.7.3). The use of Tau moreover indicates that the emphatic interdental was voiceless, as it matches the transcription of *ṯ* rather than *ḏ*. The consistent use of Tau allows for the possibility that this phoneme was realized as an affricate, [ᵗθˤ]. The realization of *ṣ*, however, would seem to suggest against this.

*3.1.9 *ṣ*

This phoneme is transcribed in the names *nṣr'l* = Νασρηλος (WR.D 1) and *ḥlṣ* = Αλιζου (C 2823-4 + Greek). The unvoiced realization, however, seems to have been more widespread, as the sound was often used to transcribe Latin and Greek [s].

LP 653:	*grmnqṣ*	GERMANICUS
KRS 1023:	*grfṣ*	Ἀγρίππας
KRS 1024:	*hrdṣ*	Ἡρῴδης
KRS 1991:	*flfṣ*	Φίλιππος

The spread of emphasis from *ṭ* to *s* producing *ṣ* in PG 1(see §3.1.7) suggests that the emphatic correlate of *ṣ* was indeed pharyngealization. This, coupled with the observation that the phoneme is sometimes confused with *s* [s] – *b'*{*ṣ*} (KhBG 345) for *b's* 'misfortune' and perhaps *ṣʿd'l* (C 1813) for *sʿd'l* – suggests that it was also de-affricated, perhaps realized as [sˤ] and less frequently [zˤ].

*3.1.10 *ṣ́ = ḍ*

The reflex of the emphatic lateral is transcribed with Sigma in the Arabic names of the neighboring settled areas: Ρασαουθος = *rḍwt*. Sigma is also used to transcribe the tribal name *ḍf*—whose members produced numerous Safaitic inscriptions—in a monolingual Greek graffito carved by one of the tribe's members, Σαιφηνος = *h-ḍfy* (MISS.I 1). This practice suggests that the phoneme was unvoiced and a sibilant-like fricative, most likely preserving its original lateral articulation. Possible pronunciations include [ɬˤ], [ɬ'], or [ᵗɬ']. Considering, however, the evidence for pharyngealization presented so far, I would suggest that [ɬˤ] is the most likely phonetic realization.

*3.1.11 *s, *ś, *z*

**s*: The phonetic value of *s* has been the subject of much debate. Macdonald (2000; 2004; 2009)

suggested that Safaitic *s* was realized as [ʃ] based on its use to transcribe Aramaic *š* [ʃ] in, for example, the divine name *bʿlsmn* < */baʿal-šamēn/. To support this equation, he pointed to the fact that *ṣ* was used to transcribe Greek and Latin [s] more frequently than *s*. This would imply that that the emphatic *ṣ*, rather than plain *s*, was the closest approximation to the sibilant [s]. However, the matter seems a bit more complicated. First, the use of *s* for Aramaic *š* only confirms that *ś* did not have the same value as its CAr counterpart, namely, [ʃ]. Between the two plain sibilants, Safaitic authors judged the *s* as the better approximation of [ʃ]. Second, it seems that *s* was used just as frequently as *ṣ* to represent Greek and Latin [s]: *grgs* = Γρηγόρης (KRS 1507), *ʾqlds* = CLAUDIUS (KRS 1507; WH 837), *tts* = TITUS (HaNSB 293; KRS 3160), *mrṭs* = Μύρτος (AbaNS 656). This type of fluctuation could indicate that the Safaitic plain *s* had an apical realization, [s̪]. If Greek or Latin *s* were pure alveolar sibilants, then there would have been no direct equivalent in Old Arabic. The opposite scenario would also explain the facts. It is also important to point out that modern Arabic, which has a plain sibilant [s], also loans in foreign [s] with its emphatic *ṣ*, especially in the vicinity of backed vowels, e.g., [bɔːsˤ] < *bus* or [asˤ-sˤuːmaːl] < *Somalia*. In the case of the Safaitic inscriptions, however, the distribution does not seem to correlate with other features, such as vowel quality or the presence of other emphatic consonants. Finally, *s* seems to be the normal way to represent NWS Samech as well, *sfr* 'inscription' (*passim*) < *sifrā*; *ysf* (ISB 330) 'Joseph' < *yōseḫ*, although the month name *nṣn* (ASWS 202) = *nīsān* may reflect the rare use of *ṣ* for this purpose as well.

***ś*:** The phonetic value of *ś* can only be negatively defined. The fact that it was not used to transcribe Aramaic [ʃ] proves that it did not have the same value as CAr *šīn*. Some scholars in the past have suggested that it was pronounced as an *ich*-laut, which seems to be the phonetic value given to its reflex in the dialects Sibawayh, the 8th c. CE Arabic grammarian, described. This, however, does not seem to be true for Safaitic. The phoneme is consistently rendered with σ in Greek. Were it realized as [ç], we might expect it to go without any orthographic representation, approximated by the *spīritus asper*, just as *ḥ*. Thus, it is simplest to assume that its original lateral value [ɬ] was preserved.

***z*:** Safaitic *z* was the voiced counterpart of *s*, and is given as the equivalent of Palmyrene *z* in a bilingual text (see Macdonald 2009 II: 347). It is also attested in transcription once in a Greek inscription from the Ḥarrah: *ʿzz* = Αζειζου (NEJIII 1).

*3.1.12 *ʾ and *h*

The glottal stop and fricative – like the pharyngeal fricatives – are not represented in Greek transcriptions: *l hnʾ bn lbʾt* = Ενος Λοβαιαθου (MISS.J 1).

*3.1.13 *w* and *y*

Greek utilizes the digraph ου for the representation of *w* and Iota for the representation of *y*. The consonantal quality of both of these sounds survives in word-final position. Thus, we have the spelling of the name *ʿlw* as Αλουου in (WR.D 1).

3.2 Vowels

3.2.1 Short vowels

The Safaitic short high vowels *i and *u were generally realized lower than their CAr counterparts, in agreement with what is found throughout the Old Arabic of the southern Levant (Al-Jallad 2017a, § 4.1 ff.).

*i > [e]
yṯ‘ = Ιαιθεου /yayṯe‘ (WH 3562 + Greek 2)
śmt = Σαμεθος /śāmet/ (C 2823-4 + Greek)
hn’ = Ενος /hen’/ (MISS.J 1)
ẓn’l = Τανννηλος /ṭann’el/ (WH 1860 + Greek 2)

*u > [o]
lb’t = Λοβαιαθου /lobay’at/ (MISS.J 1)

*a > [a]
Short *a remains [a] in all contexts until the 6th c. CE in the Greek transcriptions from settled areas (Al-Jallad 2017a, §4.4.1). Safaitic reflects the same situation.

whblh = Ουαβαλλας /wahballāh/ (WH 1860 + Greek 2)
ḥg = Αγγηνος /ḥagg/ (C 2823-4 + Greek)
ḫlṣ = Αλιζου /ḫalīẓ/ < **ḫalīṣ* (C 2823-4 + Greek)

3.2.2. Long vowels

The vowel /ū/ has not yet appeared in bilinguals, but is almost always given with ου in the transcription of names in the settled areas (Al-Jallad 2017a, §4.1); **ī* has appeared once in the vicinity of an emphatic consonant where it is realized as [iː]: *ḫlṣ* = Αλιζου */ḫalīẓ/ < *ḫalīṣ (C 2823-4 + Greek). Long **ā* is transcribed with α and there is no evidence for raising to [eː], even in the vicinity of an i-class vowel: *śmt* = Σαμεθος /śāmet/ (C 2823-4 + Greek); *bls* = Βαλες /bales/ (NEJ II 3).

3.2.3 Diphthongs and triphthongs

a) Although Safaitic orthography does not normally represent word-internal diphthongs graphically, Greek transcriptions indicate that they were preserved in pronunciation, as they are written as αι (= ay) and αυ (=aw). While it is true that αι had collapsed to ē in the Greek of this period, the digraph was used exclusively for the outcome of the diphthong, and not the /e/ vowel (< *i). As such it should probably be parsed as the vowel α and ι, which is the normal way of representing *y*. This conclusion is supported by the use of αυ to represent the *aw* diphthong; αυ [au] at no point in the history of Greek collapsed to /ō/.

ay = αι

yṯ‘ = Ιαιθεου /yayṯe‘/ (WH 3562 + Greek 2)
tm = Ταιμος /taym/ (NEJII 1)
ḍf = Σαιφηνος /ṣayp/ (MISS.I 1)

aw = αυ
ġṯ = Γαυτος /ġawṯ/ (NEJII 2)
kn = Χαυνηνων /kawn/ (MISS.I 1)
dr = δαυρα /dawra/ (A1)

Word-final diphthongs are usually represented orthographically, *fty* ‘slave’ and *rḍw* (the god) ‘Roṣaw’. This might suggest that diphthongs in word-final position were realized differently than their word-internal counterparts, but exactly how is unclear. One could suggest a distinction between [ai], word internally, and [aj] word finally or that Safaitic uniquely developed a *mater lectionis* for the representation of word-final [ai].

b) Triphthongs are generally preserved, in both verbs and nouns, although there is a tendency to merge *awa* and *aya* in verbs (see 5.6.1.1.1).

Safaitic	**QCT**	**CAr**
ngwt /nagawat/ (C 4842) ‘escape, deliverance’	*ngwh* ‘salvation’	*naǧāh*
ḥywt /ḥayawat/ (ISB 14) ‘life’	*ḥywh* ‘life’	*ḥayāh*
mnwt /manawat/ (MISSB 1) ‘fate, divine name’	*mnwh* ‘divine name’	*manāh*

α) The attestation of the divine name *rḍw* as *rḍ’* in CSNS 304 suggests that the sound change of *aw*(*V*)# > *a’* occurred in the source of this particular manifestation of the deity. Since divine names can cross linguistic boundaries, this may not reflect a sound change that operated in the Safaitic varieties. Given that this sequence is preserved in all other environments in Safaitic, it would suggest that the sound change is foreign to the area.

	Bilabial	Labio-velar	Inter-dental	Dental/ Alveolar	Palatal	Velar	Pharyngeal	Glottal
Stop								
Voiceless	*p* [p^{h}](?)			*t* [t^{h}]		*k* [k^{h}]		ʾ [ʔ]
Voiced	*b* [b]			*d* [d]		*g* [g]		
Emphatic				*ṭ* /ṭ/		*q* /q/		
Fricative								
Voiceless			*ṯ* [θ]			*ḫ* [x]	*ḥ* [ħ]	
Voiced			*ḏ* [ð]			*ġ* [ɣ]	ʿ [ʕ]	*h* [h]
Emphatic			*ẓ* /$^{(t)}$ṯ/					
Sibilant								
Voiceless				*s* [s]				
Voiced				*z* [s]				
Emphatic				*ṣ* /ṣ/~/ẓ/				
Approx.		*w* [w]			*y* [j]			
Trill				*r* [r]				
Lateral								
Voiceless				*ś* [ɬ]				
Voiced				*l* [l]				
Emphatic				*ḍ* /ṣ̀/				
Nasal	*m* [m]			*n* [n]				

Figure 12: Consonantal Phonemes of Safaitic[2]

[2] No phonetic value is reconstructed for the emphatics given the existence of several equal possibilities.

3.4 Sound changes

This section will discuss some of the sound changes that can be deduced from the consonantal spellings of the inscriptions and Greek transcriptions. Given the uncertainties in chronology and geography, it is unclear if any of these changes applied generally to the dialects written in the Safaitic script or only affected a subset of those.

*a. *iyu, *iyi > ī:* This sound change is attested in the spelling of the active participles of III-w/y roots, when not used adverbially. It suggests that the aforementioned sequences collapsed to a long vowel, likely /ī/: *śt* /śātī/ 'wintering' (C 1868) < *śātiyu; *bġ* /bāġī/ 'seeking' (TaSTF 1) < *bāġiyu; *hd* /hādī/ 'guiding' (WH 1062). The same sound change applies to the prefix conjugation as well, *ydʿ* /yadʿī/ (QZMJ 468) 'he reads/invokes' < *yadʿiyu.

b. Loss of word-final short vowels: The spelling of two identical consonants on word boundaries with a single letter suggests that short vowels in word final position were sometimes lost.

C 3177: *h **rḍwlh*** /hā roṣaw-walleh/ < *hā ruṣawu walleh
'O Rḍw, cause grief ...'

AtIN 3: *lfṣ'l bnt bngd ḏ 'l rks w **l-h-rgm*** */lah-har-rogm/ < *laha har-rogm

'By Fṣ'l daughter of Bngd of the lineage of Rks and for her is the cairn'

WH 3420: *l ʿgm bn hb ḏ 'l ṣbḥ w **l-h-rgm*** */loh-har-rogm/ < *lahu har-rogm

'By ʿgm son of Hb of the lineage of Ṣbḥ and for him is the cairn'

It seems that the loss of final short vowels applied more generally to high vowels. The consistent spelling of the 3MS of III-y/w verbs with a final glide indicates that this final sequence is more likely to be a triphthong than a diphthong, therefore requiring the preservation of the final /a/. Clearer evidence in Safaitic spellings comes from III-y/w verbs with an i-theme vowel. The spelling of verbs of this class with a final glide indicates that they terminate in the sequence, *eya* rather than *ī* (<*iy), resulting from the loss of final /a/, e.g. KRS 1042 *rḍy* /raṣeya/ 'may PN be satisfied', contrast with Modern Arabic *nisi* < *nasiy < *nasiya 'he forgot'. The preservation of final *a* is also borne out by spellings such as *nngy* (WH 135) 'that I/we may be saved' in the subjunctive. This must be vocalized as /nangeya/, with a final a-vowel. Had the vowel disappeared, we would expect it to be spelled as *ngy*, compare to the indicative *ydʿ* /yadʿī/ discussed above. Finally, A1 attests the preservation of final *a* in Greek transcription, in the verb αθαοα /'atawa/ 'he came' and the accusative of the noun *bql*, βαχλα /baqla/, 'fresh herbage'. If this pattern reflects the common situation in Safaitic, then it would seem that only word-final short high vowels were lost, paralleling Gz.

The preservation of the final *a* is seemingly contradicted by the word-boundary spelling *l-h-rgm* in AtIN3. For the *h* of the pronoun and the article to be contiguous, we must posit the loss of the final *a* (or perhaps ā) of the pronominal suffix. This loss, however, may be explained through analogy.

c. w >y: The merger of *w* and *y* mostly affects II- and III-w verbs and seems to be analogical in nature, foreshadowing a similar change in the modern Arabic dialects.

*śatawa > *śty* /śataya/ 'to spend the winter', but *śtw* (CSNS 324; KhBG 376)
*ʾatawa > *ʾty* /ʾataya/ 'to come', but *ʾtw* (SIJ 975)
*daʿawa > *dʿy* /daʿaya/ 'to read aloud/invoke'
*ʾaʿlawa > *ʾʿly* /ʾaʿlaya/ 'to raise'

The divine name Rḍw */roṣaw/ and its variant *rḍy* */roṣay/, which must be the outcome of the above-described processes, have a much more balanced distribution. The preservation of the final *w* may reflect a traditional pronunciation, while the *y*-form reflected a pronunciation affected by the aforementioned merger.

d. w > y / y_ā: The progressive assimilation of *w* to *y* occurs when the two are contiguous and followed by a long /ā/. Other long vowels may trigger this change as well, but there are no attestations.

MKWS 8: *ʾym* */ʾayyām/ < *ʾaywām 'days' (but note *ʾwm* /ʾaywām in KRS 2453)
AbaNS 407: *ḥyt* */ḥayyāt/ < *ḥaywāt 'animals'

e. n-assimilation: The *n* inconsistently assimilates to a following consonant, both word internally and across word boundaries. Assimilation occurs most frequently in unstressed environments and with proclitic particles. The reflex of the preposition *min, for example, is almost always spelled *m-*, with assimilation, and only rarely *mn*.

α. *Word boundary*

C 1341: *w rḍw ʿwr* ***m ʿwr-h*** */maʿ-ʿawwara-h/ < *man-ʿawwara-hu

'and may Rḍw blind whosoever would efface it' (the inscription)

Compare to:

C 1957: {*y*}*ʿwr* ***mn ʿwr*** *h- sfr*

'may whosoever would efface this writing be blinded'

β. *Stressed word internal:* The assimilation of *n* occurs inconsistently in stressed word-internal environments; forms exhibiting no assimilation seem to be more common. The reflex of the word 'daughter' *bint, for instance, is most frequently attested as ***bnt*** /bent/, and only occasionally as ***bt*** /bett/.

bnt

KRS 1975: *qbrt ḥsm* ***bnt*** *ḫl-h*

'Ḥsm daughter of his paternal uncle was buried'

WH 1861: *l ʾʿḏq* ***bnt*** *whbʾl*

'by ʾʿḏq daughter of Whbʾl'

bt

WH 148.1: *l rḏwn* ***bt*** *ḥdl*

'By Rḏwn daughter of Ḥdl'

WH 214: *l mty* ***bt*** *ḫrʿt*

'by Mty daughter of Ḫrʿt'

f. **Prothesis:** *Prothesis:* There are three cases in which a word-initial consonant cluster is unambiguously resolved with a prothetic syllable, the Latin name CLAUDIUS is rendered in Safaitic as *ʾqlds* (KRS 1507), suggesting a pronunciation /ʾeqlawdos/, the *t2*-stem verb *ʾtgnn* 'he went mad (from grief)' (BS 880) /ʾetgannana/, and the *st*-stem *ʾstʿḏ* /estaʿāḏa/ 'he sought refuge' (MZKHJ 2). In other cases, it seems that word-initial clusters were tolerated or resolved by a vowel that was not represented orthographically: *śtky* /śtakaya/~/eśtakVya/ 'he petitioned' (C 31) and *qttl* /qtatala/~ /eqtatala/ 'he waged war'. These possibilities extend to the vocalization of the G-imperatives and biradical stems such as *bn* < *bin 'son'. There is one attestation of the word 'son' spelled as *ʾbn* (KRS 2340), but it occurs as part of a personal name and so it may reflect a Nabataean Arabic pronunciation, where 'son' is normally spelled *ʾbn* in the onomasticon.[3]

3.4.1 Uncommon consonant mergers and other sound changes

Proper nouns exhibit several sound changes not found in the lexicon. The loss of the interdentals is attested in the name *ḥrtt* (WH 2968) for etymological *ḥrṯt* /ḥāreṯat/ and is common in the spelling of the divine name *dśr* from original *ḏśr*(*y*) 'Dusares'. The forms lacking interdentals do not likely reflect a local pronunciation but have rather been drawn from an Aramaic source. Littmann (LP) still contains the most elaborate discussion on sound changes in the onomasticon, but many of his identifications are subject to alternative explanations. Ababneh (*AbaNS*, p. 41) lists a series of personal names in which etymological *ś is written with *ẓ*, which could suggest that these names were drawn from a vernacular form of Arabic, not habitually written in Safaitic, that had experienced such a shift.

[3] The patronymic *ʾbn* is attested in Nabataean spellings of Arabic personal names, e.g. the personal name *ʾbnklbt.*

Putting aside personal names, a few examples in the lexicon merit discussion:

a. q > ʾ: Two inscriptions attest the shift of *q* to ʾ:

MKMR 9: *w nfr f ʾy{**ḍ**}*
'and he deserted and then **spent the dry** season'

Mu 113: *w ḥll h-dr dṯʾ f ʾ**yḍ** f śty f h bʿlsmn qbll*

'and he camped in this place to spend the season of later rains, then **the dry season**, and then the winter, so, O Bʿlsmn, may there be a reunion with loved ones'

The spelling of *qyẓ* as *ʾyḍ* indicates that *q* had shifted to a glottal stop in some vernacular form of Safaitic (Macdonald 2004: 189). The maintenance of *q* in the spelling of *qbll*, however, suggests that its author composed his text using a variety that maintained *q*. His spelling of *qyẓ* therefore must have been the result of the influence his vernacular, which must have differed in this way from the written register.

b. ẓ > ḍ: The spelling *ʾyḍ* also provides evidence of the merger of *ẓ* with *ḍ*. While these two fall together in many modern dialects of Arabic, the directionality here seems to differ and is closer to the Arabic spoken at Petra and Nessana in the pre-Islamic period (Al-Jallad 2017a, § 3.7.4.1). The sound change is also attested in the spelling of *ẓʿnt* 'to seek water and herbage' as *ḍʿnt* (AAEK 244).

c. *ḍ > ẓ:* The word 'enclosure' is attested once as *ḍrt* (CSNS 318), while it is usually spelled *ẓrt* (Al-Jallad 2015a: 355).

d. *ḍ > ṭ*: In a new inscription from Wādī Salmā, which I am preparing for publication, the tribal name *ḍf* is spelled *ṭf*, suggesting a merger between the two sounds. This merger occurs in some pre-Hilalian Maghrebian dialects of Arabic (Al-Jallad 2015b). Another unpublished inscription from Marabb al-Shurafāʾ attests the divine name *rḍy* as *rṭy*, pointing towards the same sound change.

e. **ʾ > y or ∅:* A few inscriptions exhibit the loss of the glottal stop, as exemplified by the writing of *śnʾ* 'enemies' as *śny* (MSNS 1). In word medial position, we find the phrase *ḏ ʾl* is written *ḏyl* in an unpublished inscription, suggesting the pronunciation /ḏīyāl/ from original *ḏī-ʾāl. The same spelling of this phrase is also found once in a Hismaic inscription (see Clark 1980, no. 3). If my parsing and interpretation of the word *mykn* 'established' in the poetic text KRS 2453 is correct, then it offers yet another example of this phenomenon.

f. *ṣ̌, written with *q*: AJQ 1 attests the divine name *rḍy* spelled as *rqy*. This is not likely the result of a sound change, but rather the Aramaicization of the Arabian god's name.

4. Nominal and Pronominal Morphology

Overview

a. Most underived Safaitic nouns in their orthographic form fall into two categories, biradical CC and triradical CCC. Nouns belonging to the former category usually derive from roots containing a *w* or *y* in one of the three consonantal slots, or roots in which the consonants in second and third position are identical. A few isolated nouns, however, seem to reflect genuine biradical roots, e.g. *yd* 'hand', *bn* 'son'. One mono-radical noun is attested *f* 'mouth' (APMS 1). Nominal forms consisting of four consonants are also attested, but these are usually formed through various derivational processes, such as the addition of affixes or reduplication (§ 4.7). The following tables concisely illustrate unaugmented CCC and CC stems and offer tentative vocalizations based on the comparative evidence and what is known about Safaitic phonology.

CCC stems	spelling	vocalization	meaning	root
strong	*ṣfr* (C 99)	/sepr/	'writing'	√sfr
I-w	*wqʿ* (AKSD 5)	/waqʿ/	'inscription'	√wqʿ
II-w/y	*qyẓ* (ZeGA 11)	/qeyāṭ/	'dry season'	√mwt
III-w/y	*śty* (Mu 113)	/śetāy/	'winter'	√śty
$C^2 = C^3$	*ḫll* (LP 135)	/ḫalīl/	'friend'	√ḫll

Figure 13: Underived triradical noun patterns

CC stems	spelling	vocalization	meaning	root
biradical	*yd*	/yad/	'hand'	√yd
II-w/y	*mt* (LP 1198)	/mawt/	'death'	√mwt
III-w/y	*nw* (LP 325)	/nāww/ (?)	'migrating group'	√nwy
$C^2 = C^3$	*ʿm* (C 793)	/ʿamm/	'grandfather'	√ʿmm

Figure 14: Underived biradical noun patterns

Nouns inflect for two genders, masculine and feminine, and for three numbers, singular, dual, and plural. Masculine dual and external plural nouns are attested with a special "bound" form, used when the noun takes a pronominal clitic or when it is the non-final member of a construct-genitive phrase. Nouns may also be marked by an accusative case, which has a variety of related functions.

4.1 Gender

a. Grammatical gender often equals biological sex in the Semitic languages with humans, deities, and higher animates, such as mammals. Feminine nouns are often marked by the termination *-t*, e.g., *frst* 'mare' (AbaNS 383) vs. *frs* 'horse' (C 159); *mrʾt* 'wife', 'woman' (C 4768) vs. *mrʾ* 'man' (WH 2147); *ẓbyt* 'female gazelle' (WH 2342) vs. *ẓby* 'male gazelle' (L 184); *ḫlt* 'maternal aunt' (KRS 18) vs. *ḫl* 'maternal uncle' (HCH 10). There are several lexically feminine nouns that are not marked by the *-t* morpheme, such as *ʾm* 'mother' (ZSI 1) and *ʾtn* 'she-ass' (C 505). Unlike the CAr pausal form and most modern forms of Arabic, the feminine ending remains *t* in all positions

α. Only one possible instance of the /at/ > /ah/ sound change is attested, *nʿmh* 'ostrich' < *nʿmt* (AWS 302). The position of this word at the end of the inscription could point towards a CAr-like pausal form. But it should be noted that the inscription is only known from a hand copy.

4.2 Onomasticon

a. The gender of a personal name is dependent on the referent rather than its morphological shape. Names of males can terminate in *t* while the names of females sometimes show no overt feminine marking. In most cases, the gender of the referent must be determined by other features, such as the words *bn* 'son' or *bnt* 'daughter', references to the person as *fty* 'male slave' or *ʾmt* 'female slave', or agreement features on verbs and adjectives.

Male names		Female names	
C 3929:	*śddt bn ḥny*	WH 1861:	*ʾʿqd bnt whbʾl*
HCH 131:	*myt bn ʾkl*	C 4768:	*gḥm bnt ʾnʿm*
LP 264:	*mlkt bn ʾdyn*	KRS 59:	*slm ʾmt slm*

b. Most inscriptions begin with the *lam auctoris* followed by a lineage chain (see § 22), which minimally consists of a single element: the author's name. Some lineage chains extend back to the eponymous ancestor of the author's social group. The longest lineage chain attested is found in SSWS 200, which spans twenty generations.

SSWS 200: *l ġṯ bn khl bn śʿl bn khl bn ṣḥyn bn gʿl bn rsl bn qdm bn rsl bn mʿzz bn bwk bn ʿrs bn kśṭ bn śhr bn ḥysr bn hʿḏr bn rṭḥ bn ʿwḏ bn whbʾl bn ʿly*

c. The commonest way of expressing affiliation with a social group is the phrase *ḏ ʾl* (lit. 'of the *ʾāl*'), which is best translated as 'lineage group' in the context of the nomads and 'people' when it refers to outside groups, such as the Romans or Jews) followed by the name of the social group.

KhNSJ 5: *l grm bn lṯ bn ṣrmt ḏ ʾl ʿmrt*

'By Grm son of Lṯ son of Ṣrmt of the lineage of 'mrt'

CSNS 438: *l shm bn ʾsd ḏ ʾl tyr*

'By Shm son of ʾsd of the lineage of Tyr'

NEH 13: *l ʿdy ḏ ʾl nbṭ*

'By ʿdy of the people of Nabataea'

α. In very rare cases, an author may express affiliation with two *ʾl*'s: HaNSB 307 *l sʿdlh bn ʾs bn ẓnʾl bn ḥyn ḏ ʾl mʿyr w ḏ ʾl frṯ* 'by Sʿdlh son of ʾs son of Ẓnʾl son of Ḥyn of the lineage of Mʿyr and of the lineage of Frṯ'. The Safaitic inscriptions do not distinguish various sub-divisions of lineage groups—all are referred to as *ʾl*'s, as illustrated in the following inscription: RWQ 346 *l ʾs bn ḥsn bn ḥnn ḏ ʾl ḍf mn ʾl św'* 'by ʾs son of Ḥsn son of Ḥnn of the lineage of Ḍf, from the lineage (clan?) of Św". OAM2 simply lists two *ʾāl*'s in sequence: *l mṭr bn ṣbḥ ḏ ʾl ṣbḥ ʾl mṭr* 'By *mṭr* son of *ṣbḥ* of lineage of *ṣbḥ* of the lineage of *mṭr*.

4.2.1 One-word names

a. One-word names constitute the largest class of the Safaitic onomasticon. With the exception of the rare bilingual Safaitic-Greek inscriptions and names belonging to the ʾaCCaC pattern, it is usually impossible to determine the exact vocalization of a given name. For example, *slm* could be vocalized as *salm*, *sālem, salīm, solaym*, etc., all of which are found in Greek transcriptions from the area.

HCH 182:	*ʾnʿm* = /ʾanʿam/, Gr. Αναμος
HCH 194:	*rḍwt* = /raṣāwat/, Gr. Ρασαουαθος
M 112:	*mṭr* = /maṭar/, Gr. Ματαρος

4.2.2 Theophoric names

a. Theophoric names consist of sentences or genitive compounds containing the name of a deity, usually *ʾl* /ʾel/ and sometimes *lh* /allāh/. Many of these names are attested in Greek transcription:

C 1665:	*tmlh*	'servant of Allāh', Gr. Θαιμαλλας
C 4237:	*ʿbdlt*	'worshipper of Allāt', Gr. Αβαδαλλαθος
C 3751:	*nṣrʾl*	'the aid of ʾĒl', Gr. Νασρηλος
KRS 902:	*ḫlflh*	'Allāh has granted a successor', Gr. Αλαφαλλας

Theophoric names containing other deities occur less frequently:

AbaNS 265:	*ʿbdśms*	'worshipper of Śams", Gr. Αβδασαμσου
AbaNS 892:	{*ś*}*ʿbl*	'companion of Bēl'
Mu 836	*ʿbdśr*	'worshipper of Dū śarē', Gr. Αβδουσαρης
NTSB 1:	*ʿbdʾktb*	'worshipper of ʾaktab'
WH 627:	*mrʾʿzy*	'man of ʿozzay'

4.2.3 Basileophoric names

a. Nabataean basileophoric names are also rarely attested:

SIJS 11:	*ʿbdʿbdt*	‘slave of Obodas’, Gr. Αβδοοβδας
KRS 2327:	*ʿbdrbʾl*	‘slave of Rabbēl’, Gr. Αβδοραββηλος
AKSD 4.1:	*ʿbdml{k}*	‘slave of Malichus’, Gr. Αβδομαλιχος

4.2.4 Prepositional phrases

a. Prepositional phrases, sometimes including clitic pronouns, can form personal names:

C 226:	*k-ʿm-h*	‘like his grandfather’, Gr. Χαμμος
C 227:	*b-nṣr-h*	‘by his help’
C 2559:	*l-śms*	‘for Śms’, Gr. Λισαμσου

4.2.5 Greek and Latin names

a. A small minority of Safaitic inscriptions were carved by, or for, men with Greek and Latin names:

KRS 1507:	*grgs bn ʾqlds*	‘Grēgorēs son of Claudius’
NSR 44:	*tts*	‘Titus’
AbaNS 656:	*mrṭs*	‘Myrtos’
GRK 2:	*gyṣ*	‘Gaius’

α. CEDS 322 attests a social group with an eponymous ancestor bearing a Latin name, *ʾl tts* ‘the lineage of Titus’.

4.2.6 Names of social groups

a. The names of lineage groups to which the authors of the Safaitic inscriptions belonged follow the phrase *d̲ ʾl* and are morphologically singular:

HCH 53: *l śhm bn ʾdm bn bhʾ d̲ ʾl ḍf*
'by Śhm son of ʾdm son of bhʾ of the lineage of Ḍf'

b. The gentilic adjective can also express affiliation with a social group, although this option is less frequently used:

WH 1060: *l rsʿl bn qdm h- ḍfy*
'by Rsʿl son of Qdm the Ḍf-ite'

c. Names of outside peoples usually appear without the definite article:

WH 736.a:

h	*rḍw*	*sʿd-h*	*m-śnʾ*	*ġnmt*
VOC	Rḍw	aid.IMP.2MS -CPRO.3MS	against- enemy.PL	raider(or: spoil).PL
m- rhy	*w*	*nbṭ*	*w*	*ḥwlt*
from- Rhy	CONJ	Nbṭ	CONJ	Ḥwlt

'O Rḍw, help him against enemies, raiders (or: with spoil) from Rhy, Nbṭ, and Ḥwlt!'

But there are exceptions:

C 4448:

ḥrb	*h- md̲y*	*ʾl*	*rm*	*b- bṣr*
wage war.SC.3M	ART- Md̲y	people.CNST	Rm	near- Bṣr

'the Persians waged war upon Romans at Bostra'

C 220:

snt	*ḥrb*	*h- nbṭ*
year.CNST	war.CNST	ART- Nbṭ

'the year of the war of the Nabataeans'

4.3 Diminutives

a. The diminutive pattern was probably CoCayC(at), as suggested by the transcription of Arabic personal names from the southern Levant, such as Χοθαιβος and Σοραιχος, and nouns such as Γοναιναθ 'small gardens' from the Petra Papyri (Al-Jallad et al. 2013: 37-38). The orthography only clearly distinguishes this pattern in CC stems, where it is characterized by the appearance of a glide in medial or final position: *bny-h* /bonayy-oh/ 'his young(est) son' (C 4076), from *bn*; *ʾḫyt* /ʾoḫayyat/ 'little sister' (C 893), from *ʾḫt*; *rwḍt* /rowayṣat/ 'small meadow' (HAUI 70), from *rḍt*; and possibly *ʿyr* /ʿoyayr/ 'small ass' (AbaNS 855), from *ʿr*.

α. *ʿwlt* (C 5050) may attest the diminutive of the unattested ***ʿylt* or ***ʿylt* 'family', and as such should be vocalized as /ʿowaylat/. It could also reflect a by-form with a medial *w* /ʿāwelat/.

β. If *str* (SESP.U 26) and *strt* (WH 405) refer to the same type of structure, then the latter may reflect a diminutive, 'shelter' and 'small shelter', respectively. The same is perhaps reflected in the pair *ẓllt* /ṭolaylat/ 'small shelter' (CSNS 313) vs. *ẓlt* /ṭellat/ 'shelter' (C 4681).

4.4 Number

Overview

a. The unmarked form of the noun signifies the singular or collective, while marked forms can indicate the dual, plural, singulative, or plural of paucity.

4.4.1 Dual

a. The dual is formed by suffixing an *n* (CAr nom. *-āni*, obl. *-ayni*) to the singular or the singulative.

RVP 7:	*wrḫn* 'two months'	< *wrḫ* + *n*
WH 767:	*nʿmtn* 'the two ostriches'	< *nʿmt* + *n*
WH 182:	*bkrtn* 'the two she-camels'	< *bkrt* + *n*
WH 3912:	*nqt*{*n*} 'two she-camels'	< *nqt* + *n*

4.4.2 Plural

a. As in CAr, there are two strategies of pluralization: pattern replacement and external plural suffixes – masculine *n* (CAr *-ūna*, *-īna*; Arm *-īn*) and feminine *t* (CAr *-āt*; Hb *-ôt*). Since pattern replacement sometimes includes suffixation, often with *n* and *t*, the distinction between the two strategies is not always clear, and often must be made on comparative grounds. The consonantal orthography distinguishes six patterns used for nominal pluralization, ordered roughly by frequency:

I. ʾCC(C)
II. CC(C)n

III. CC(C)t
IV. CC(C)
V. ʾCC(C)t
VI. CC(C)y
VII. miscellaneous

While it is natural to assume that the broken plurals in Safaitic correspond to their CAr counterparts, there are clear cases where the patterns employed in both languages do not align, e.g., the plural of *rhṭ* = CAr *rahṭun* 'folk' in Safaitic is *ʾrhṭt* (ShNGA 1) /ʾarheṭat/ whereas CAr attests *ʾarhuṭun* and *ʾarāhiṭu*.

I. *ʾCC(C):* This pattern is characterized by a prefixed ʾ and the insertion of a vowel between the C2 and C3. As such, it encompasses at least two patterns in CAr, ʾaCCāC and ʾaCCuC. While the inserted long vowel of the former pattern was probably /ā/, one cannot rule out with certainty the existence of a pattern with an /ū/ infix, as in Gz. CC singulars tend to form their plurals according to this pattern.

CCC > ʾCCC

C 1148:	*ʾgml* 'camels'	s. *gml*
WH 3792.a:	*ʾśhr* 'months'	s. *śhr*
KRS 25:	*ʾrḫ* 'months'	s. *wrḫ*
ASFF 291:	*ʾnfs* 'funerary monuments'	s. *nfs*

CC > ʾC(w/y)C

KRS 2340:	*ʾdwd* 'paternal uncles'	s. *dd*
KRS 2340:	*ʾḫwl* 'maternal uncles'	s. *ḫl*
MKWS 8:	*ʾym* 'days'	s. *ym*

α. The ʾCCC plural of $C^2 = C^3$ roots exhibits a clustered form: *ʾʿm* /ʾaʿamm/ 'forefathers', 'grandfathers' (WH 399), from *ʿm*. In rare cases, the plural of *śʿ* 'companion' is spelled as *ʾśʿ* (CEDS 147; RWQ 120) instead of the expected *ʾśyʿ*. If this is not the result of a writing error, then it could reflect attraction to the $C^2 = C^3$ pattern, /ʾaśaʿʿ/ rather than /ʾaśyāʿ/.

β. KRS 2453 attests the plural of *ym* as *ʾwm*, which probably reflects an archaic variant /ʾaywām/, attested in Sabaic as *ʾywmm* /ʾaywāmum/, or perhaps an opposite pattern of assimilation, /ʾawwām/.

γ. The plural of *nqt* /nāqat/ 'she-camel' is attested in AbaNS 564.1 as *ʾnq*, and probably reflects the irregular plural /ʾaynoq/, attested in CAr as *ʾaynuqun*.

δ. It is unclear if the *ʾa*-prefix formed paucal plurals as in Classical Arabic. It should be pointed out that most nouns quantified by numerals under ten form ʾ-prefixed plurals, but there are too few attestations to prove the existence of a similar system.

II. *CC(C)n*: The termination *n* can signal: (1) a plural pattern augmented by the termination *-ān*, cf. CAr *faʿlānun, fuʿlānun*, etc., or (2) pluralization through the external suffix *-ūna/īna*.

(1)

CSNS 550:	*ẓbyn* 'gazelles'	/ṭobyān/	s. *ẓby*
KRS 2420:	*drn* 'places'	/dīrān/	s. *dr*
SIJ 352:	*ʾḫwn* 'brothers'	/ʾeḫwān/	s. *ʾḫ*

(2) In Proto-Semitic, the masculine plural of adjectives was formed by the addition of suffixes to the singular stem, **ūna* in the nominative and **īna* in the oblique. This continues to be the productive method by which the plural of participles is formed.

KRS 6:	*rġmn* 'stuck down.PPC.MP'	/raġīmīna/	s. *rġm*
HCH 71:	*mḥrbn* 'plundered.PPC.MP'	/maḥrūbīna/	s. *mḥrb*
RQ.A 10:	*rmʾn* 'archers'	/rammāʾīna/	s. *rmy*

α. In addition to *ʾḫwn*, another form with a pronominal suffix is relatively frequently attested, *ʾḫw -h*. This form is sometimes clearly a dual, /ʾaḫaway -h/, as it refers to two brothers mentioned elsewhere in the inscription. In other cases, it stands alone with no antecedent. While it is possible that in such contexts *ʾḫw* refers to two unmentioned brothers, it seems more likely that we should understand the term as a collective, meaning perhaps kinsmen, i.e. 'brethren'. Another alleged plural form, *ʾḫwy*, is attested in KRS 2890, but this should probably be corrected to *ʾḫw-h* 'his (two) brothers', otherwise the inscription terminates with a rather strange formula- tion, *wgm ʿl-ʾḫwy* 'he grieved for brothers' rather than the common *wgm ʿl ʾḫw-h* 'he grieved for his kinsmen'

β. As in other Semitic languages, the feminine *snt* 'year' forms an external masculine plural, *snn* 'years' (AZNG 1), probably /sinīna/ or /sinūna/.

III. *CC*(*C*)*t*: The final *t* can reflect the external ending /āt/ or a plural pattern augmented by the feminine ending /at/, comparable to CAr *fiʿālatun*, *faʿalatun*, etc. Suffixation with /āt/ is the productive method of pluralizing singulatives in CAr, and the same appears to be true in Safaitic.

WH 359:	*ḥyt* 'animals'	/ḥayyāt/	s. *ḥywy*
C 218:	*bʾst* 'misfortunes'	/beʾsāt/	s. *bʾs*
C 4448:	*ġnmt* 'goats'	/ġanamāt/	s. ***ġnm*
RSIS 204:	*mṭrt* 'rains'	/maṭarāt/	s. *mṭr*
WH 179:	*bkrt* 'she-camels'	/bek(a)rāt/	s. *bkrt*

α. Some III-w/y nouns corresponding to CaCiyyat and CVCyat patterns in CAr appear to lose their third consonant in the plural, e.g., *mṭyt* 'riding camel' (C 1837) = CAr *maṭiyyatun*, pl. *mṭt* (WH 2837); *dmyt* (C 1615) 'image' = CAr *dumyatun*, pl. *dmt* (KhMNS 5). The exact process responsible for this—whether phonological or analogical—is unclear. The plural *ḥyt* 'animals' from *ḥywy*, however, is probably unrelated. Instead, it reflects the progressive assimilation of the glide *y*, *ḥyt* */ḥayyāt/ < *ḥaywāt/ (§ 3.4b).

β. While *ḥyt* is the normal plural of *ḥywy* 'animal', the editor took the form *h- ʾḥyt* in HaNSB 345 as

a plural by-form. It is more likely, however, that the initial ʾ is to be identified as a definite article preceded by the *h*- demonstrative, *h ʾ- ḫyt* 'these animals', (see § 4.8).

IV. *CC(C):* Plurals of this class are usually identical to their singulars and can only be identified on contextual grounds. These could reflect a number of plural patterns known from CAr, *fiʿālun, fuʿūlun, fuʿʿālun*, etc. Biradical singulars become triradical when they take a plural of this class, *ḫṭ* 'carving' (C 1540) > *ḫṭṭ* /ḫoṭūṭ/ 'carvings' (KRS 995).

KRS 903:

ḫrṣ	*ʿl-**rgl**-h*
watch.SC.3MS	over- foot.soldier.PL -CPRO.3MS

'he watched over of his foot soldiers'

Compare with the singular *rgl* (C 2076).

α. If I am correct in identifying HN 161 *śnʾn* 'enemies' as a plural, then it could be the case that the more common *ḫrṣ śnʾ* reflects the idiomatic use of the singular /śāneʾ/ or perhaps a variant CCC plural, /śonnāʾ/. The same may apply to the noun *ʾṯr* 'trace', for which context sometimes prefers a plural interpretation (e.g., C 2713).

C 2315:

w	*dśr*	*slm*	*m- **śn**ʾ*
CONJ	Dśr	security	against- enemy.PL

'and Dśr, may he be secure against enemies'

β. *Ṣyd* 'snares' (MKWS 28) may reflect a CCC plural of a CC noun, if {*ṣ*}*d* (WH 2938) attests its singular.

V. *ʾCC(C)t*: This plural form, cognate with CAr *ʾafʿilatun* and Gz *ʾafʿəlt*, is relatively rare. The plural of *ʾlh* 'god' appears in KRS 1287 as *ʾʾlht*, /ʾaʾlehat/ and the plural of rhṭ 'kinsfolk' as *ʾrhṭṭ* /ʾarheṭat/ in ShNGA 1. The word *ʾlsnt* could be interpreted as the plural of the unattested *lsn* 'tongue' if it is not the word for ' year' with the *ʾl*-definite article.

KRS 1287:

f	*hy*	*ʾʾlht*
CONJ	VOC	Lt

'so O gods!'

VI. *CC(C)y*: Only a few examples of this class are attested, notably *bny* /benāy/ 'sons' (C 88), from *bn* 'son' (*passim*); *mʿzy* /meʿz(a/ā)y/ 'goats' (LP 360), probably from *mʿz* (C 4973), cf. CAr *maʿazun*; and *bʾry* /boʾarāy/ 'wells' (CSNS 803), from *bʾr* (RSIS 339).

VII. miscellaneous: The plural patterns CaCāCay and ʾaCCelāy are each attested once, *lyly* /layālVy/ 'nights' (KRS 2453), and *ʾrḍy* /ʾaʿreṣāy/ 'valleys' (WH 2139), s. *ʿrḍ* (Ms 44), respectively.

4.4.3 Singulative and paucal/Individuative

a. *Collective and Singulatives:* Many morphologically unmarked nouns, especially those denoting groups of animals, have a collective sense, *ḍʾn* 'sheep' (C 744); *bqr* 'cattle' (LP 155); *ʾbl* 'camels' (*passim*). A singulative (nomen unitatis) can be derived from many collectives by the suffixation the feminine *t* /at/, *nʿmt* 'an ostrich' /naʿāmat/ (KRS 1610), from *nʿm* /naʿām/ 'ostriches' (HaNSB 117); *ḍʾnt* /ṣaʾnat/ 'an ewe' (C 35), from *ḍʾn* /ṣaʾ(a)n/; and possibly *sfrt* /seprat/ 'an instance of writing' (WH 153), from *sfr* /sepr/ 'writing' (*passim*).

b. *Plural of paucity/individuation*: The singulative forms its plural with the external suffix /āt/. This may function as an individuative plural or as a paucal; no evidence has yet been attested to distinguish between the two. While the CAr paucal signifies a number between three and ten, there is no reason to assume that this precise quantity holds for the language of the Safaitic inscriptions. The paucal/individuative and singulative are identical in Safaitic orthography and therefore must be distinguished by context.

C 2307:

śr{q}	*{b-}h-* ***ḍʾnt***	*l-ḥrrn*
migrate.SC.3MS	{with}-ART- sheep.PCL	to- Ḥrrn

'and he migrated with a number of sheep to the inner desert, towards Ḥrrn'

Compare to the plural:

KRS 1304:

mrq	***ʾḍʾn***	*ʾl*	*mʾb*
pass.3M	sheep.PL.CNST	people.CNST	M'b

'the sheep of the people of M'b passed by'

Derivational relationship between the collective, singulative, paucal/individuative, and plural

collective: *ḍ'n* = /ṣa'(a)n/ → plural: *'ḍ'n* = /'aṣ'ān/

↓

singulative: *ḍ'nt* = /ṣa'(a)nat/ → paucal: *ḍ'nt* = /ṣa'(a)nāt/

4.5 State

a. In the Semitic languages, a noun governing another noun in the genitive case or bearing a pronominal suffix is said to stand in the construct state. In this state, it is (originally) distinguished from its independent form by the loss of final nasalization (*mimation* in the singular, *nunation* in dual and plural). Since final nasalization had already disappeared in all environments in singular nouns (but see § 4.5.1, below), only duals and external masculine plurals continue to exhibit morphologically distinct construct forms. The construct noun and the following noun, historically in the genitive, form the construct-genitive chain. This construction has a strict syntax: the construct noun must directly precede the noun it governs; definiteness is marked by the final term of the phrase, which is the only member which can be modified by the definite article or pronominal suffixes. In Safaitic, however, the demonstrative *h*, may precede the entire phrase. If the final member of the phrase is definite, either lexically or by means of the article or suffixed pronoun, then the entire phrase is definite. There are theoretically no limits as to the number of members a construct-genitive chain can have, but chains exceeding three members have not yet been attested.

Definite because of a proper noun:

C 96:

h	*'lt*	*'ss*
VOC	goddess.CNST	'ss

'O goddess of 'Usays'

KRS 59:

'mt	*slm*
slave girl.CNST	Slm

'the slave girl of Slm'

Definite because of the article:

SIJ 37:

b's	*'- snt*
misfortune.CNST	ART- year

'the misfortune of this year'

Definite because of a pronominal clitic:

C 2713:

ʾṯr	*ʾśyʿ-h*
trace.CNST	companion.PL -CPRO.3MS

'the traces of his companions'

Three-term construct-genitive:

C 320:

nʿm	*ʾl*	*ʿbd*
livestock.CNST	lineage.CNST	ʿbd

'the livestock of the lineage of ʿbd'

A single noun may govern two (or more) nouns in the genitive.

HAUI 72:

tʾmr	*h-śnʾ*	*snt*	*qṣr*	*w*	*h- mḏy*
be widespread.SC.3MS	ART-adversity	year.CNST	Caesar	CONJ	ART- Persians

'adversity was widespread in the year of Caesar and the Persians'

Unlike CAr, but similar to many contemporary dialects of Arabic and ASA, two (or more) construct nouns linked by a conjunction can govern a single genitive noun.

AWS 81:

sḥq	*w*	*mḥq*	*l- ʿm*	*w*	*wld*
ruin	CONJ	bad fortune	to-people.CNST	CONJ	offspring.CNST
ḏ	*yʿwr*	*h- sfr*			
REL	efface.PC.3MS	ART- writing			

'may the people and the offspring of him who would efface this writing be destroyed and wiped out'

b. *Dual:* The final -*n* of the dual is dropped in the construct state. The absence of any representation of the final diphthong /ay/ before the pronominal suffix -*h* could indicate that the diphthong was

interpreted as word internal in this context. However, when followed by another noun, as in RQ.A 10, some writers may have treated it as word final, representing the diphthong with *y*.

a.

C 4037:

{*h*}	*lt*	*whbt*	*śnʾ -h*	*bn*
{VOC}	Lt	give.SC.2FS	enemy.PL -CPRO.3MS	between
yd *-h*				
hand.DU.CONST -CPRO3MS				

'O Lt, may you give his enemies into his hands!'

RQ.A 10:

b- ***mʾty***	*frs*
with-unit.DU.CNST	horsemen

'with two cavalry units'

c. *Plural:* The external masculine plural ending *-n* is also dropped in the con- struct state. The first term of the construct-genitive *qtl ʾl rm* (ZeWa 1) 'warriors of the people of Rome' is likely /qātelī/, and may reflect the construct of the so far unattested masculine plural active participle ***qtln* /qātelīna/. The same is reflected in ASWS 59 *bn ʾʿẓmy* /banī ʾʿẓmy/, from the unattested unbound form ***bnn* */banīn/ (see, also, C 511) and in RR 4: *bʾs l-bġy bʾs* 'misfortune to seekers of misfortune', where *bġy* = /bāġeyī/.

4.5.1 Vestiges of nunation

a. A few examples of nunation are possibly attested in the inscriptions. The term *mḥlt* 'dearth of pasture' in the prayer segment of KRS 1551 is followed by an otiose *n*: *h lh rwḥ w* ***mḥltn*** *l- ḏ yʿwr h-sıfr* 'O Lh, send the winds (with rain) but may he who would efface this writing have a dearth of pasture'. One could also argue that the *n* reflects an idiomatic usage of the dual with an emphatic or amplifying meaning, 'twice a dearth of pasture!'. Finally, a vestige of nunation is possibly attested on the tribal name *ʿmrt* in C 2947, *ḏ ʾl* ***ʿmrtn*** 'of the lineage of 'mrt', but the hand copy is rather unclear in this area so a definitive reading must await the rediscovery of the stone.

4.6 Case

a. Proto-Semitic and Proto-Arabic distinguished three cases in most singular and broken plurals by means of final short vowels, nominative *u*, genitive *i*, and accusative *a*, and two cases in the dual and external plurals, nominative and oblique. In the dialect reflected in A 1, the loss of final short-high vowels seems to have eliminated the nominative and genitive cases, but it is unclear if these would have survived when they were distinguished by long vowels, such as in words like *ʾab* (nom. *ʾabū*, gen. *ʾabī*, acc. *ʾabā*), or before the few examples of nunation mentioned above. Likewise, it is impossible to determine if case inflection obtained in the dual (nom. *ā*, obl. *ay*) or the masculine plural (nom. *ū*, obl. *ī*), and other situations not dependent upon final short vowels. The construct form attested in RQ.A10 *b-mʾtyfrs* 'with two cavalry units' is in the expected oblique case, but, as in other Semitic languages, the oblique case is usually generalized once case inflection is lost. Thus, one can draw no conclusions from this example. A1 and the spellings of III-w/y adverbial participles suggest that the accusative case -/a/ survived longer than the others.

4.6.1 Functions of the accusative

a. Goal of travel and static location: Safaitic rarely employs prepositions to indicate the goal of travel or static location. As in other Semitic languages, both of these functions are marked by the accusative. This is clearly attested in A 1:

A 1:

αθαοεα /ʾatawa/	βανα-α /banaʾa/	α-δαυρ-α /ʾa(d)-dawra/
come.SC.3MS	Banaʾ-ACC	ART-place -ACC

'he came to Bn' at this place'

A 1:

ουα /wa/	ειραυ /yirʿaw/	βαϰλ-α /baqla/
CONJ	pasture.PC.3MP	fresh herbage -ACC

'and they pastured on fresh herbage'

WH 742:

ḫyṭ	***mdbr***
journey.SC.3MS	inner desert

'he journeyed to the inner desert'

WH 466:

rʿy	***bql***	*wḥd*
pasture.SC.3MS	herbage	alone

'he pastured on herbage alone'

WH 65:

ġzz	***h-nḫl***
raid.SC.3MS	ART-valley

'and he raided in this valley'

WH 766:

l	*hʿwḏ*	*bn*	*ḫbb*	***h-mdṯ'***
LA	Hʿwḏ	son.CNST	Ḫbb	ART- the spring pasture

'By Hʿwḏ son of Ḫbb, at this spring pasture'

α. Even if we admit the possibility of dialects which have lost all final short vowels, the various functions of the accusative could have continued syntactically. Compare to Hb. *wə-hû yōšēb petaḥ-hā-ʾōhel* 'and he was sitting at the entrance of the tent' (Gen 18:1) or *lāšebet bāyiṯ* 'that it may dwell in a shrine' (Isa 44:13).

β. The overlap between the locative function of the accusative and the preposition *b-* is illustrated in WH 784: *rʿy b- rḍ w mdbr w b- ʿls* */raʿaya bi-rawṣ wa madbara wa bi-ʿVls/ 'he pastured in meadows and in the inner desert and in grainland'.

b. *Adverbs:* III-w/y participles exhibit two forms: a bi-radical CC form when used as a nominal predicate: *dm* (C 1339) 'drawing' < √dmy; *śt* (C 1868) 'wintering' <√*śty*; *bġ* 'seeking' (TaSTF 1) √*bġy*, and a tri-radical CCy form when used adverbially: *rʿy* (C 2446) 'while pasturing' and *ʿny* 'while suffering' (KRS 1964). Although examples are limited, this distribution signals a morphological distinction, based on a suffix, between the two syntactic positions. The adverbial forms likely go back to a construction marked by the accusative, *rʿy* /rāʿeya/, while the others terminated in a high vowel and were subject to the sound change described in (§ 3.4a), *śt* /śātī/ < *śātiyu.

α. The adverb 'forever' is attested as both *l-ʾbd* /le-ʾabad/ (C 2446) and less frequently as *ʾbd* /ʾabada/ (KRS 1015; SWSS 193). These may reflect different strategies of adverbial marking, the former with the dative and the later with the accusative.

c. *Direct objects:* Syntactically speaking, the goal of travel can be understood the direct object of a verb of motion. It is, therefore, likely that this pattern of marking applied to all direct objects. There is

nothing similar to a direct object marker as found in NWS. A single example of a III-w/y noun as the direct object of a transitive verb is attested, but what it tells us about the marking of the accusative is not clear: LP 325 *ḫrṣ* ***h-nw*** *mʿʾḫ-h m-mdbr* 'he kept watch with his brother for the migrating party from the inner desert'. If *h-nw* should be vocalized as /han-nāwī/, a reflex of an active participle, then it would suggest that final short vowels had been lost in the dialect of this inscription. But it is equally possible that *nw* could reflect another vocalization, perhaps /nāww/, in analogy with the participles of $C^2 = C^3$ roots. In this case, the suffixation of an /a/ would not leave an orthographic trace.

d. *The terminative ending:* In addition to the accusative, PS had at its disposal another ending to mark the goal of travel and adverbs, the terminative *-*is*. This morpheme surfaces as /ah/ in WS (e.g. Hb *-â*; Ug *-h*). On the basis of the spelling of **mah* 'what' (cf. Ug *mh*) as *m* in Safaitic, it would appear that /ā/ is a possible reflex of **ah* in word-final position. Thus, the PWS directive *ah could have yielded /ā/ and so it is possible that this termination survived alongside the accusative. Both would be transcribed as α in Greek.

4.7 Nominal derivation

a. As discussed in the overview of this chapter, most substantives are identical to the consonantal root from which they derive in Safaitic orthography. This section will therefore focus on nouns with derivational affixes, the noun patterns of which can be more securely identified.

b. The *m*-prefix */ma/ forms nouns of location, which, by metaphorical extension, can be used temporally. Locative nouns follow two general patterns, one with the feminine ending, maCCVCat, and one without, maCCVC. The choice between either is lexical, although Safaitic exhibits a considerable number of by-forms.

maCCVC	WH 1663	*mnẓr* /manṭar/	'look-out point'	√nẓr 'to guard'
+n-assimlation	WH 318	*mẓr* /maṭṭar/		

maCCVC	KRS 2499	*mrb* */marVbb/	'land with abundant herbage'	√rbb 'to be large/plenty'

maCCVC	ZeGA 1	*mnṣb* /manṣeb/	'cult stone'	< *nṣb* 'to erect'
+n-assimlation	KRS 2914	*mṣb* /maṣṣeb/		
maCCVCat	C 511	*mṣbt* /maṣṣebat/		

maCCVC	WH 3500	*mśty* */maśtay/	'winter pasture'	√ śty 'to winter'
maCCVCat	M 358	*mśtyt* */maśtayat/		

Table #: *m*-CCC noun patterns

α. Nouns of place derived from II-w/y roots follow the pattern maCCvCat and have a long vowel in the penultimate syllable, *mqẓt* /maqīṭat/ (C 1240) 'place to spend the dry season' < √qyẓ; *mdnt* /madīnat/ (WH 1698) 'province' < √dyn; *mġrt* /maġārat/ (Rsh 1) 'tomb chamber' < √ġwr.

β. The G-passive participle *mqtl* /maqtūl/, is marked by the preformative /ma/: *mḥrbn* /maḥrūbīna/ 'plundered.PPC.MP' (HCH 71); *mqtl* */maqtūl/ 'killed.PPC.MS' (HCH 72); *msby* /masbīy/ 'captured.ppc.ms' (CSNS 1004); *mtrḥt* /matrūḥat/ 'perished.PPC.FS' (TG 1). Participles of the derived stems are also characterized by a prefixed *m-*, but the preformative vowel of this prefix was /o/ < *u; see (§ 5.6).

c. The suffix *-y* is used to form gentilic adjectives, and replaces the *-t* morpheme on feminine nouns. The fact that the suffix is consistently represented graphically indicates that it retained a consonantal value even following the loss of final short vowels, and as such was likely vocalized as /eyy/ or /īy/ rather than /ī/.

C 27:	*h- mʿṣy* 'the Mʿṣ-ite'	< *ʾl mʿṣ* 'the lineage of Mʿṣ'
HaNSC 2:	*h- ḍfy* 'the ḍf-ite'	< *ʾl ḍf* 'the lineage of Ḍf'
MISSB 1:	*h- nbṭy* 'the Nabataean'	< *nbṭ* 'Nabataea'
WH 852:	*h- lbʾy* 'the Lbʾt-ite'	< the personal name *lbʾt*
LP 653:	*h- smwy* 'the Samawite'	< *smwt* 'toponym' (AAUI 267)
KRS 30:	*h- dmy* 'the dumaite'	< *dmt* the oasis *Dumah*, in North Arabia

α. The masculine singular substantivized gentilic adjective can refer to groups of people: *h-ʿwḏy* (MSNS 1, 6) 'the 'Awīḏites' < *ʿwḏ* and *snt h-yhdy* (C 2732) 'the year of the Jews', cf. Hb *hak-kəna'ănî* 'the Canaanites.'

β. If the gentilic adjective *tmwy* (LP 82) refers to the oasis Taymāʾ, then it would appear that, as in CAr, nouns terminating in *āʾ* (<*-āy, *-āw) formed their gentilic adjectives with the termination *wy*. The gentilic adjective *tmny* (HaNSC 5) is also attested, but it is unclear if this form should be connected with the oasis of Taymāʾ. Instead, *tmn* may reflect *taymān* 'southern'; thus, *h- tmny* would mean 'the southerner'.

d. Other affixes such as a suffixed *-n* and a prefixed *t-* can occur on infinitives and abstract nouns, e.g., *ḫyṭn* 'travelling' (WH 1022); *ḥwr{n}* 'return' (WH 2837); *tḍb'* 'to raid' (LP 742). The suffixed *n* also forms the adjectival pattern CaCCān, which can also act as a participle, *kḏbn* /kaḏbān/ 'lying' (JQU 1).

4.8 Determination and deixis

a. As in other CS languages, definiteness is often overtly marked by a prefixed article, while indefinite substantives are unmarked. The most common form of the article is *h-*: *h-mlk* 'the king' /ham-malk/ (KRS 1023); *h-ḏ'b* 'the wolf' /haḏ- ḏe'b/ (LP 732); *h-mdnt* /ham-madīnat/ 'the province' (C 1240).

b. The article forms *'* and *'l* are also attested but they are less frequent than *h-*. While in some cases, the *'*-article may reflect a form of the *'l-* article with the assimilation of the *l* to coronals (see γ below), there are some instances in which the *'*-article precedes consonants that do not usually induce assimilation (e.g., HaNSB 312 and WH 3418 below). In such cases, the *'*-article article may reflect an assimilated form of the *'an*-article known from some contemporary Arabic dialects of southwest Arabia. Finally, a few examples of the *'l*-article without the assimilation of the *l* to a following coronal are attested. The non-assimilating *'l*-article is known from Nabataean and Greek transcriptions, and seems to have been a feature of the Arabic dialects of this region (see Al-Jallad 2017, § 5.5). The language of texts with the *h*-article is, as far as one can tell, identical to those with the *'*(*l*) article(s).

The *'*-article:

HaNSB 312:

l-h	*'- frs*
by -CPRO.3MS	ART- horse

'the horse is his'

WH 3418:

'- bkrt
ART- she-camel

'the she-camel'

WH 234:

bny	*'- rgm*
build.SC.3MS	ART- cairn

'he built the cairn'

KhMNS 5: *'- dmt*
ART-image.PL
'the images'

The ʾl-article:

C 5137:

w	*ḥll*	*ʾl- dr*
CONJ	camp.SC.3MS	ART-place

'and he camped in this place'

C 2446:

ʾl- {n}bṭy
ART- Nbṭ.GA

'the Nabataean'

HCH 194:

rḍwt	*ʾl- hdy*
Rḍwt	ART- commander

'Raṣāwat, the commander'

c. A man called Ḥmlt son of Slm carved two inscriptions, in one he used the ʾ article and in the other the *h*-article, suggested that both were in free variation within a single dialect.

ShNGA 1: *l* *ḥmlt bn* *slm* ***ʾ-lṣṭ***

PREP GN02 ART-bandit

'By Ḥmlt son of Slm, the bandit'

AMSI 50: *l* *ḥmlt bn slm* ***h-lṣṭ***

PREP GN02 ART-bandit

'By Ḥmlt son of Slm, the bandit'

α. There is some evidence for the elision of the onset of the ʾ-article:

BRCM 0194:

bny	*ʾ- nfs*	*w*	*str*
build.SC.3M –CPRO.3MS	ART- funerary monument	CONJ	[ART-] shelter

'he built the funerary monument and [the] shelter'

MKOWI 2:

ḥrb -h	*ʾ- ṯlg*	*w*	*smyt*
war.SC.3M –CPRO.3MS	ART- snow	CONJ	[ART-] heavens
ḥdt			
forbid.SC.3FS			

'the snow waged war upon him and [the] heavens were forbidding'

β. The Greek inscription on the same rock face as KRS 2420 (see Attallah and Al-Jibour 1997) confirms that the *h*-article triggered the gemination of the following consonant.

ΑΝΑΜΟΣ ΣΑΔΟΥ ΤΟΥ ΘΑΙΜΑΛΛΟΥ ΑΜΜΑΣΙΧΗΝΟΣ

This inscription renders *ʾnʿm bn sʿd bn tmlh h/ʾ-msky* = 'ʾAnʿam son of Saʿd son of Taymallāh the Masīkite (= ham-masīkeyy < *ʾl mskt,* SIJ 287).

γ. A1 transcribes an example of the assimilation *ʾl*-article, thus we have αλ-Ιδαμι /al-ʾidāmiyy/ 'the ʾIdāmite' but αδαυρα /ʾad-dawra/ 'this place'. It is unclear if the assimilated form of the *ʾl* article triggered gemination, as this author also wrote the assimilated form of the preposition *min* as μι- without the expected gemination of the following consonant. This may suggest that such forms did not induce gemination (at least in these environments) in this author's dialect or that he simply did not represent gemination orthographically.

d. A clear attestation of the *hn*-article occurs in LP 87, *hn-ḥwly*. This article may have been typical of the dialect of the Ḥwlites who were situated in North Arabia (Macdonald 2009: II, 35). Other attestations, such as *hn- ʿyr* 'the small ass' (N 101), do not provide any information about their authors, and so it is unclear if these texts were composed by outside groups as well. H 786 attests *l glḥ hn-wlt*, which the edition translates as 'This standing stone belongs to Glḥ'. If correct, then it would attest an example of the *hn* article before a non-laryngeal consonant.

e. The article may substantivize adjectives:

C 2446:

qtl-h	*ʾl-{n}bṭy*
kill.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	ART-{Nbṭ}.GA

'the {Nabataean(s)} killed him'

f. The definite article can also function as a proximal demonstrative. In most cases, the sense of the article must be inferred from pragmatic considerations. While ambiguity is common, some cases only permit a single interpretation. For example, the *h*-morpheme in KRS 1023 (below) can only be taken as a definite article.

KRS 1023:

mrd	*ʿl-h-mlk*	*grfṣ*
rebel.SC.3MS	against-ART- king	Grfṣ

'he rebelled against king Agrippa'

In curses against potential effacers of an inscription, the demonstrative force is preferred.

C 1293:

ʿwr	*ḏ*	*yʿwr*	*h-sfr*
blind.IMP.2MS	REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS	ART- writing

'blind him who would scratch out this writing'

C 893:

ʿwr	*l- ḏ*	*yʿwr*	*h- ḥṭṭ*
blindness	to- REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS	ART- writing

'may he who would scratch out this writing go blind'

Likewise, the article in inscriptions which express ownership of a structure or in signatures associated with rock art is better interpreted as a demonstrative.

KhMNS 5:

l	*slm bn ḥg bn ṭhm bn hmsk*	*ʾ- dmt*
LA	GNO4	ART- drawing.PL

'by Slm son of Ḥg son of Ṭhm son of Hmsk are these drawings'

WH 329:

l	*sʿd bn ṣbḥ*	*h- rgm*
LA	GNO2	ART- funerary cairn

'this funerary cairn is for Sʿd son of Ṣbḥ'

g. The existence of a separate demonstrative morpheme *h,* and possibly *ʾ,* is suggested where it precedes a genitive construction (1) or the article itself (2). Only in these cases will the *h/ʾ*- morpheme be glossed as DEM.

(1) Before a genitive construction:

HCH 79:

h dmyt	*zmrt*
DEM image.CNST	flute-playing girl

'this image of a flute-playing girl'

MSNS 1[4]:

wrd	*h-ʾḍyt*	*h- ʿwḏy*
go to water.SC.3MS	DEM-watering hole	ART- ʿwḏ.PL

'he went to this watering hole of the ʿwḏ-ites'

α. A less secure example is found in LP 534 – known only from a hand copy – which reads: *l PN h-mqʿd h-ṣṣd*. As Littmann suggested, the second *ṣ* of the last word could reflect a *y* or simply dittography, in which case it is possible to interpret the phrase as meaning 'hunting-seat', lit. 'place of hunting'. If correct, the *h*- preceding the entire phrase must be construed as a demonstrative, meaning 'this hunting place.'

(2) before the article:

In a few cases, the demonstrative *h* precedes the definite article, either *h* or *ʾ*. This is paralleled in contemporary vernacular forms of Arabic, in which the demonstrative *h* often combines with the article *il* to form *hal,* e.g., LAr *hal-walad* 'this boy'; *han-nās* 'these people'.

[4] In MSNS 1, the second term cannot be construed as an adjective modifying the first term because of the lack of agreement in gender. Thus, the first *h*- must be taken as a demonstrative before the genitive construction, *ʾḍyt h- ʿwḏy*. The same place is simply called *ʾḍyt h-ʿwḏy* 'the watering hole of the ʿwḏ-ites', without the demonstrative *h*, in MSNS 6.

AbaNS 407:

l	*śkr*	*bn*	*hf*	*h*	*h- ḥyt*
LA	S²kr	son.CNST	Hf	DEM	ART- animal.PL

'By S²kr son of Hf are these animals'

HaNSB 354:

l	*kmd*	*bn*	*ns't*	*h*	*'- ḥyt*
LA	Kmd	son.CNST	Ns't	DEM	ART- animal.PL

'By Kmd son of Ns't are these animals'

g. The article is not usually used before generic nouns when they are objects of prepositions or when they are the subjects of verbless clauses, e.g., *flṭ mn-sqm* 'deliverance from illness' (C 527); *slm l-hm* 'may they be secure', lit. 'security be theirs' (C 4039). Infinitives are not preceded by the article either, {*f*} *gls ḥlt* '{and} he halted to camp' (JaS 159.2). However, when generic nouns are the subject of a finite verb, they often take the article. Consider, for example, *t'mr h-śn'* 'adversity was widespread' (HAUI 72); *t'mr h-śḥs* 'want was widespread' (KRS 995).

h. HshNSMI 5 attests a dialect without the definite article, which is reminiscent of Hismaic: compare *ḥll dr* 'he camped in (this) place' (HshNSMI 5) to *ḥll h-dr* 'idem' (*passim*) and *lm yḫbl sfr* 'may (this) writing not be effaced' to the more common construction *'wr ḏ yḫbl h- sfr* 'blind him who would efface this writing' (*passim*).

4.9 The demonstrative pronouns

4.9.1 The proximal demonstratives

a. Since most inscriptions rarely contain more than a single sentence, there is little opportunity for the attestation of deictic pronouns and particles. The most common deictic element is the demonstrative *h*, and perhaps its rare variant *'*. These demonstratives usually refer to images accompanying the inscription, or to the present time period, e.g. *h-snt* 'this year'. The independent pronominal bases are much rarer and most members of the paradigm are not securely attested. The following paradigm illustrates the attested forms.

Masculine singular	*ḏ*	*h-rgm ḏ* (AUnp 2) 'this cairn'
Feminine singular	*t, ḏ²*	*t h-ḫṭṭ* (BS 870)

		'this writing'
Plural	*ʾly*	*h-ʾfs ʾly* (SMS 1) 'these funerary monuments'

Table 15: Demonstrative pronouns

a. *Masculine singular*: The masculine singular form is attested only once in post-positive position. Its vocalization is unclear; however, the common Arabic base in CAr and in the modern dialects is *ḏā* and it may be safe to assume the same pronunciation for Safaitic.

b. *feminine singular:* A feminine singular form derived from the *ḏ* demonstrative is also possibly attested before the word *dr* 'place, region', but the inscription lends itself to multiple interpretations.

ASWS 217:

w	*ḏ*	*h-dr*
CONJ	DEM.FS	ART- place

'while at this place' or: 'and he who sheds blood'

The feminine *t* demonstrative is attested securely twice, both times preceding its head.

HAUI 198:

h	*lt*	*qb{l}l*	*m-*	*t*	*h- snt*
LA	Ms'l	reunion	DEM.FS	DEM.FS	ART- year

'O Lt, may this year bring reunion with loved ones'

BS 870:

t	*h-ḫṭṭ*
DEM	ART-writing

'this writing'

α. There are a number of situations where the *t*-demonstrative is possibly attested. The word for 'land' appears in Safaitic as both *ʾrḍ* and *ʾrḍt*. The latter form may simply be a feminine biform, as in Classical Arabic *ʾarḍatun*. But it is also possible to understand it as *ʾrḍ* followed by the *t* demonstrative.

C 2953:

w	*ʿmr*	*h-* *ʾrḍ*	*t*
CONJ	dwell.SC.3MS	ART- land	DEM.FS

'and he dwelt in this land'

The same ambiguity exists with the term *nfst* 'funerary monument.' The biform *nfs* is also attested and may suggest that the *t* is a feminine demonstrative (Vogue 404.1-2). The term is attested as *npš* in the Northwest Semitic inscriptions (*DNWSI*, 748), and has this form in the Namārah inscription, *ty npš mrʾlqyš* 'this is the funerary monument of Mrʾlqyš', where its gender is also feminine, and in Dadanitic, *nfs* (Macdonald in Fiema et al. 2015). Further support for this interpretation comes from its plural counterpart, which is sometimes followed by the demonstrative, *ʾly*. This would suggest that the writing formula associated with the erecting of this particular funerary installation sometimes made use of a demonstrative.

The *t* demonstrative may also follow the place name *mdbr* 'inner desert' (C 2682; KRS 926). While feminine by-forms of nouns of place do exist, e.g. *mṣb* vs. *mṣbt*, *mdbr* is a proper noun referring to the Ḥamād, and none of its cognates in other languages exhibit a feminine by-form, Hb *midbār*, OArm *mdbrʾ*, Akk *madbaru* (see *DNWSI,* 595). Thus, if the demonstrative interpretation is correct, it may mean something like 'in the inner desert itself'. This usage is comparable to the function of the demonstrative *ḏātu* in CAr, where as a substantive it means 'being,' 'self' (Fischer 2002:149, n2).

C 2682:

f	*rḍy*	*ġnmt*	*h- snt*	*mdbr*	*t*
CONJ	Rḍy	spoil	ART- year	inner desert	DEM.FS

'So, Rḍy, let there be spoil this year in the inner desert itself'

Some editors have connected *drt* - in the expression *l-* PN *h- drt* – with CAr *dāratun* as a term for 'a wide space of land between mountains' (*Lane*, 931c). However, if *drt* and *dr* had different referents, one would expect the former to occur more frequently. So far, *drt* has appeared only four times in the corpus. This may suggest that *dr* and *drt* were not distinguished by referent, but rather deixis, i.e. *h- dr* 'at the (i.e. this) place' and *h-dr t* 'at this place'. One may therefore see *h-dr t* as equivalent to *ḏ h- dr* 'at this place', but in a dialect which employed the *t*-demonstrative.

WH 1958:

l	*ms'l*	*h-dr*	*t*
LA	Ms'l	ART- place	DEM.FS

'By Ms'l, at this place'

c. feminine dual: A form *hḏ* may be attested with a dual antecedent, and would seem to parallel Dadānitic *hṣlmn hḏh* (JSLih 82), if *ṣlmn* should in fact be taken as a dual rather than a diminutive. Like Dadanitic, this may suggest that the singular demonstratives were not normally preceded by *h*, but the dual was. There are a few possibilities when it comes to the vocalization of this form – if the dual was a distinct morphological category, then it may have terminated in the endings /ay/, /hāḏay/, or /ā/, /hādā/. On the other hand, the dual may have licensed feminine singular agreement with demonstratives, and so this form may reflect an underlying /hāḏī/. It should be mentioned, however, that the *h* on the photograph is badly damaged and may also represent an *l*, in which case the author may have intended *l-ḏśr*, but omitted the final two letters. Against this interpretation is the fact that the word for the animals dedicated to deities is always directly followed by the passive participle *qṣy* 'dedicated'.

H 457:

l	*zhd bn mʿl bn fḍg*	*h- bkrtn*	*{h}ḏ*
LA	GN03	ART- she-camel.DU	DEM.DU(?)

'by Zhd son of Mʿl son of Fḍg are {these} two she-camels'

4.9.2 Distal demonstratives

a. There is one possible attestation of the distal demonstrative *tk*. This inscription occurs on a rock containing two carvings of two bull-camels and what appears to be a donkey. The short text lends itself to several interpretations. This first is that the author referred to all three animals with *gml*. The feminine *tk* is the expected concord form for the plural of non-human nouns (see §6.3b). It is also possible that the writer used the collective, which also licensed feminine agreement. Less likely is the possibility that the author omitted the *lam auctoris* and *tk* is a personal name.

WH 516:

tk	*h-gml*
DEM.F	ART- camel.COL

'those (two) are the camels'

4.9.3 The ḏ-particle

a. An otiose *ḏ* particle can sometimes precede nouns without any apparent change in meaning. The orthography does not provide evidence for inflection, which is reminiscent of the reports of the Arab grammarians, who observed that an otiose *ḏī* can be added at will to proper names (Rabin 1951: 76).

WH 614:

l	*ʾṣmʿ*	*w*	*tnẓr*	*ḏ*	*mny*
LA	ʾṣmʿ	CONJ	await.SC.3MS	DEM	Fate

'by ʾṣm and Fate lay in wait' (= *tnẓr mny*)

KRS 3029:

tẓr	*ḏ*	*mny*
await.SC.3MS	DEM	Fate

'Fate lay in wait' (= *tẓr mny*)

ISB 117:

ʿyr <<r>>	*hn*	*wgd*	*ḏ*	*ṯnt*
journey.PC.MS	here	find.INF	DEM	dry herbage

'having journeyed here to find dry herbage'

KRS 2961:

tnẓr	*ḏ*	*ḥbt*
await.SC.3MS	DEM	rain

'he awaited rain' (cf. *tẓr h- smy*)

4.10 Relative-determinative pronoun

a. The relative pronoun is most frequently attested as a component of the phrase *ḏ ʾl*, which expresses affiliation with a lineage group. Agreement is inconsistent; the MS often appears with FS and MP antecedents. This seems to indicate that the relative pronoun lost its agreement features in many of

the varieties written in Safaitic. When the relative-determinative pronoun heads a clause, it has a definite force, 'he who', 'the one who', as opposed to the indefinite *m* or *mn* 'anyone', 'who(so)ever', 'whatever'. The relative-determinative pronouns form the following paradigm:

Masculine singular	*ḏ*	(passim)
Feminine singular	*ḏt*	JbS 1
	ḏ't	CSNS 412
	ḏ'	SHS 10
Plural	*ḏw*	C 2156

Figure 16: The relative-determinative Pronoun

b. *masculine singular*: The masculine singular form *ḏ* is cognate with the CAr determinative pronoun, NOM. *ḏū*, GEN. *ḏī*, and ACC. *ḏā*. The vocalization of the Safaitic reflex is dependent upon whether case inflection survived in declensions based on long vowels. The Nabataean theophoric name *'bddwšr'* */'abd-ḏū-śarē/ suggests that the form no longer inflected for case in the Nabataean Arabic dialect. The same is witnessed in the Namārah inscription, where the relative pronoun *dw* has a genitive antecedent. The generalized *ḏū* for may be attested in QUR 689.3.1 (Al-Jallad 2017d: 79), which elides the glottal stop of *'l*, producing a homorganic *w*: *ḏwl*. Since this phrase should be in the genitive, it would suggest that the dialect of this author had neutralized case inflection. On the other hand, the spelling *ḏyl* is also found, with the correct case vowel. Thus, the inflection of this pronoun does not appear to be stable.

HCH 69:

wgm	*'l- hn'*	*ḏ*	*'l*	*m'ṣ*
grieve.SC.3MS	for- Hn'	REL.MS	lineage.CNST	M'ṣ

'he grieved for Hn' of the lineage of M'ṣ'

KRS 1964:

'ḫlṣ	*'- ḍ'n*	*ḏ*	*'l*	*ḥlṣ*
keep safe.CS.3MS	ART- sheep.COL	REL.MS	lineage.CNST	Ḥlṣ

'he kept the sheep of the lineage of Ḥlṣ safe'

α. RSIS 351 attests the following curse *grb l-ḏy y'wr h-ḫṭṭ* 'may he who would efface this writing have scab', where *ḏy* substitutes for *ḏ* in other inscriptions. Unless other unambiguous examples come to light, it is best to take the extra *y* as dittography, since the writing of a word final vowel is very unlikely.

c. *feminine singular*: The Safaitic inscriptions attest three forms of the FS relative pronoun. The form form *ḏ't*, */ḏā'at/ or */ḏī'at/, is attested four times in genealogies of the lineage of Tm (CSNS 412, 620, 621, 622). This form is cognate with the Old Aramaic demonstrative *z't* and Hebrew *zō(')t*. SHS 10 attests the form *ḏ'* */ḏā'/, which finds a cognate in the Old Aramaic feminine singular demonstrative *z'*. Interestingly, AtIN 3 – which is from the same cairn - attests an identical statement, but uses instead the masculine singular form *ḏ*. It is therefore unclear if the form *ḏ'* is simply the result of dittography or reflects a third dialectal variant. The form *ḏt* */ḏāt/ is attested only once, and corresponds in form to CAr *ḏāt-* and ASA *ḏt*. The absence of the glottal stop cannot easily be explained through the loss of the phoneme, since it is preserved in several other words in this inscription. It may be significant that the object of our author's longing belongs to the lineage of people of *'g'*, perhaps Jebel 'Ağa' in the area of Ḥā'il (Najd). Perhaps this dialectal variant was characteristic of that speech area.

CSNS 412:

l	*'d*	*bnt*	*'s*	*bn*	*ḥn'l*	*ḏ't*
LA	'd	daughter.CNST	's[1]	son.CNST	Ḥn'l	REL.FS
'l	*tm*					
lineage.CNST	Tm					

'by 'd daughter of 's[1] son of ḥn'l of the lineage of Tm'

CSNS 620:

l	*ḫrg*	*bnt*	*ġṯ*	*ḏ't*	*'l*	*tm*
LA	Ḫrg	daughter.CNST	Ġṯ	REL.FS	lineage.CNST	Tm

'by Ḫrg daughter of Ġṯ of the lineage of Tm'

SHS 10:

fṣ'l	*bnt*	*brd*	*ḏ'*	*'l*	*rk{s}*
Fṣ'l	daughter.CNST	Brd	REL.FS	lineage.CNST	{Rks}

'Fṣ'l daughter of Brd of the lineage of Rks'

JbS 1:

tśwq	*'l*	*'{b}tl{ś}n*	*ḏt*	*'l*	*'g'*
long.sc.3ms	for	{'btlśn}	REL.FS	lineage.CNST	'g'

‘he longed for {‘btlśn} of the lineage of ’g”

d. *masculine plural*: This masculine plural *ḏw* is only attested twice. Like the MS, its vocalization depends on whether case inflection survived, nom. /ḏawū/ or obl. /ḏawī/. In H 506, the MP is unexpected, since the formula usually requires the MS, *ḏ*.

C 2156:

wgd	*’ṯr*	*ʿś -h*	*qbrn*
find.SC.3MS	trace.PL.CNST	kinsmen- CPRO.3MS	bury.PPC.MP
ḏw	*’l*	*yẓr*	
REL.MP	lineage.CNST	Yẓr	

‘he found the traces of his buried kinsmen who were of the lineage of Yẓr’

H 506:

ʿwr	*l- ḏw*	*ʿwr*	*h- sfr*
blindness	to-REL.MP	efface.SC.3MP	ART- writing

‘may they who would efface this writing go blind’

e. *Non-Agreement*: The masculine singular relative *ḏ* is also attested with FS and MP antecedents, indicating that agreement neutralized for some writers.

AtIN 3:

l	*fṣ’l*	*bnt*	*bngd*	*ḏ*	*’l*	*rks*
LA	Fṣ’l	daughter.CNST	Bngd	REL.MS	lineage.CNST	Rks

‘By Fṣ’l daughter of Bngd of the lineage of Rks’

C 1758:

wgm	*ʿl- ʾśyʿ-h*	*ḏ*	*nsl*
grieve.SC.3MS	for- companion.PL-CPRO.3MS	REL.MS	were captured.SC.3MP
b- ṯbr			
in- Ṯbr			

'he grieved for his companions who were captured during Ṯbr (Sagittarius)'

f. *Agreement in definiteness*: The relative pronoun exhibits agreement in definiteness in two inscriptions, both with animate antecedents.

RWQ 73:

ḥḍr	*b- ʾẓmy*	*h*	*lt*	*w*	*h*
camp at water.SC.3MS	near- ʾẓmy	VOC	Lt	CONJ	VOC
ḏśr	*lʿn*	*ḥwlt*	***h-ḏ***	*ʾṯm*	
Ḏsr	curse.IMP	Ḥwlt	ART-REL	act wrong.SC.3M	

'he camped by permanent water near ʾẓmy; O Lt and O Ḏśr, curse the Ḥwlt-ites who acted wrongfully'

LP 718:

ẓhr	*ʾsf -h*	*mn*	***h-ḏ***	*y's*
be evident.SC.3MS	regret –CPRO.3MS	from	ART- REL	upset.SC.3MS

'his regret on account of him whom he upset was evident'

α. In rare cases, the relative-determinative can also function as a genitive marker, as an alternative to the construction chain, KRS 1964: *ʾḫlṣ ʾ ḍʾn ḏ ʾl ḥlṣ* 'he kept the sheep of the lineage of Ḥlṣ safe'.

4.11 Indefinite relative

a. The indefinite relative has two forms when its antecedent is human, *mn* and *m*, which probably reflect inconsistent *n*-assimilation at word boundaries, likey /man/ and /maC/, respectively.

KRS 109:

rḍy	*ʿwr*	*m*	*ʿwr*
Rḍy	blind.IMP.3MS	REL	blind.SC.3MS

'Rḍy, blind whosoever would efface (this inscription)'

C 1186:

ʿwr	*l- mn*	*ḫbl*
blindness	PREP- REL	efface.SC.3MS

'may whosoever would efface (this inscription) go blind'

C 2947:

nqmt	*mn*	*mn*	*mṣr-h*
retribution	PREP	REL	attack.SC.3MS-CPRO.3ms

'(let there be) retribution against whoever attacked him'

With non-human referents, the indefinite relative pronoun is always *m*, most likely /mā/.

Ms 44:

h	*gdḍf*	*lʿn*	*ḏ*	*yʿwr*	*m*	*yhnʾ*
VOC	Gdḍf	curse.IMP.2MS	REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS	REL	please.PC.3MS

'O Gdḍf, curse him who would efface that which pleases'

4.12 Quantifiers

a. The quantifier *kll* corresponds with CAr *kullun* 'all, each, entire, every', although the writing of two *l*'s indicates a different pronunciation. A similar form is found in Ug *kll* /kalīlu/, which may suggest an identical vocalization for Safaitic, thus */kalīl/. On the other hand, the pre-Islamic personal name *ʿabd kulāl* is attested in Islamic literary sources. It is possible that the final element is the word for 'all', referring to the entire divine pantheon. This would point to the vocalization /kolāl/ in Safaitic. The expanded form of the quantifier with two *l*'s is also found in Hismaic and Dadanitic, suggesting it was an areal feature of northern Arabia.

H 191:

tśwq	[ʾ]*l-* ***kll***	*ʿśr*	*ṣdq*
long.SC.3MS	[for]- QUANT.CNST	kinsman	righteous.MS

‘he longed {for} every righteous kinsman’

WH 161:

rʿy	***kll***	*ʾrḍ*
pasture.sc.3ms	QUANT.CNST	land

‘he pastured every region’

ZSIJ 16:

kll	*ʾlh*	*b-h-smy*
QUANT.CNST	god	PREP-ART-sky

‘every god in the sky’

KRS 6:

ʾśyʿ-h	***kll-hm***
companion.PL -CPRO.3MS	QUANT -CPRO.3MP

‘his companions, all of them’

HaNSB 16:

kll	*h-snt*
QUANT.CNST	ART-year

‘the entire year’

HaNSB 304:

mrq	***kll***	*slsl -h*
throw off.SC.3MS	QUANT.CNST	bond.PL -CPRO.3MS

‘he threw off all of his bonds’

α. There is so far only one attestation of the quantifier ‘all’ with one *l, kl ʾbd* /kolla ʾabad/ ‘all eternity’ (SW 193).

b. When used independently, *kll* may mean ‘everything’ or ‘everyone’:

KRS 2646:

ḥrb	***kll***
plunder.SC.3MS	QUANT

'he plundered everything'

c. A quantifier with one *l* is attested once in a dual context, probably reflecting the dual form /kelā/, cf. CAr *kilā* 'both'.

LP 305:

kl	*ḍlly*
both	lost.SC.3D

'both were lost'

4.13 Numerals

a. The agreement features of the numerals are in line with other classical Semitic languages: the digits exhibit gender polarity with the quantified noun. Both the decade and the digit of twelve, and presumably eleven (unattested), exhibit polarity with the noun they qualify. The decade of the teens agrees with its complement while the digit exhibits gender polarity. The qualified noun of numerals three through ten is plural, while numerals above ten modify singular nouns. The following examples are attested.

Numeral	Masculine	Feminine
1		*wḥd*
3	*ṯlṯt*	*ṯlṯ*
4	*ʾrbʿt*	*ʾrbʿ*
5	*ḫmst*	*ḫms*
6		*st*
7		*sbʿ*
8		*ṯmny*
10		*ʿśr*
12		*ṯnʿśr*
14	*ʾrbʿʿśrt*	
18	*ṯmnʿśrt*	
20	*ʿśrn*	
30	*ṯlṯn*	
21	*ḫmstʿśrtn*	
30	*ṯlṯn*	
100	*mʾt*	
1000	*ʾlf*	

Figure 17: Attested Safaitic numerals

α.The spelling *ṯmny* suggests a vocalization ṯamāney or ṯamānay, with a true final consonant unlike Classical Arabic *ṯamāni*.

β. If *ḫmstʿśrn* is correctly spelled, then it suggests that the conjunction *w* could have been elided in such forms, perhaps due to erosion in rapid speech.

b. Littmann identified several inscriptions which count the years using Aramaic numerals, closely resembling Palmyrene and Nabataean (LP 94, 162, 1198), but reliability of some of these copies is questionable.

c. Two possible examples of ordinal numbers are attested: *ʾwl* 'first' (SW 168), which in its context functions as a substantive meaning 'beginning', and *ṯlṯ* 'third' (ASWS 360), which seems to refer to a time period, perhaps a month.

4.14 Personal pronouns

a. The narrative component of most Safaitic inscriptions is set in the 3rd person and opportunities for the attestations of the pronouns of other persons is rare. The following independent and clitic forms are known.

Independent Pronouns	
1CS	*ʾn* /ʾanā/ or /ʾana/
3MS	*hw* /howa/; *h* /hū/

Figure 18: The attested independent pronouns

Clitic	Singular	Dual	Plural
1CS	Ø, *y*		-*n* (c) /nī/
2M	-*k* /ka/	-*km* */komā/ (?)	-*km* /kom/
2F	-*k* /ek/ or /kī/		
3M	-*h* /oh/ -*nh* /Vnnoh/		-*hm* /hom/
3FS	-*h* /ah/ or /hā/		

Figure 19: The attested clitic pronouns

4.14.1 Independent pronouns

a. *subject*: The independent nominative pronouns act as the subject of sentences without finite verbs, and can also serve to topicalize the subject of a finite verb.

1cs: *ʾn*

WH 1403b:

w	***ʾn***	*frds*[1]	*bn*	*ʿrḍ*
CONJ	IPRO.1CS	Frds[1]	son.CNST	ʿrḍ

'and I am Frds[1] son of ʿrḍ'

KRS 268:

w	***ʾn***	*ʾtm*	*bn*	*śrw*
CONJ	IPRO.1CS	ʾtm	son.CNST	Śrw

'and I am ʾtm son of Śrw'

3ms: *hw*

AUnp 1:

ʾḫḏ	*rgln*	***hw***	*w-tm bn msk*	*f*	*ʾsr-hm*
take.SC.3MS	man.DU	IPRO.3 MS	CONJ-GNO2	CONJ	capture.3M-CPRO.3U

'he took two men, he and Tm son of Msk, and captured them'

b. *object*: Only one secure attestation of an independent object pronoun is known, so it is impossible to discern the functional range of this category. If these forms functioned as their CAr counterparts, then they may have, among other things, served to topicalize direct objects. The Safaitic form consists of a stem *y* and a pronominal suffix *h*. The former is clearly related to CAr *ʾiyyā*, but perhaps without the initial syllable, so perhaps /yā/ or with a vowel onset /eyyā/. A connection with the vocative *y* should be considered, which may well be the source of the CAr *ʾiyyā* < **in* + *yā*.

AWS 218:

sʿd -h	*rḍw*	*nʿm*	*w*	*b-ḏ*
help.SC.3MS –CPRO.3MS	Rḍw	grace	CONJ	PREP-REL
ḍr	*w*	***yh***	*brk*	
harm.SC.3MS	CONJ	OPRO.3MS	bless.SC.3MS	

‘may Rḍw help him by means of grace, and against him who would harm (him), and may he (Rḍw) bless him’

4.14.2 The clitic pronouns

a. The clitic pronouns have a genitive or accusative function, and attach to nouns in the construct state, prepositions, and verbs.

b. 2MS and 2FS: *-k:* The second person singular M and F are identical in the consonantal orthography. The underlying forms are probably M */ka/ and F */ek/, although */kī/ is also a possibility.

2ms: *-k*

KRS 1683:

h	*śʿhqm*	*slm*	*w*	*ʿwḏ-**k***
VOC	S²ʿhqm	security	CONJ	protection-CPRO.3MS

‘O S²ʿhqm, [grant] security and your protection’

2fs: *-k*

Mu 550:

h	*ʾlt*	*sʿd*	*ysmʿl*	*bn*	*fḥl*	*ʿbd-**k***
VOC	ʾlt	aid.IMP.2FS	Ys¹mʿl	son.CNST	Fḥl	worshipper-CPRO.3FS

‘O ʾlt, aid Ysmʿl son of Fḥl, your worshipper’

c. 3MS and 3FS: *-h*

-h

The third person singular M and F forms are likewise identical in the orthography. Based on word boundary assimilation patterns, these were likely vocalized as M /oh/ and F /ah/, respectively, when attached to prepositions. The FS may have been /hā/ or /ha/ in other contexts.

b. The vocalization of these forms before long vowels and diphthongs is unclear and the evidence is conflicting. The spelling *yd-h* ‘his two hands’ (C 4037) suggests that the pronouns were not preceded by a vowel in such cases, thus /yaday-h/. If the form were *yaday-oh*, we should expect it to have been spelled as *ydyh*. On the other hand, the word ‘his nights’ in KRS 2453 is spelled *lyly-h*, suggesting a pronunciation /layālVy-oh/. The latter example, however, is attested in a short poem written in a mixed Safaitic-Hismaic script, and so may reflect a distinct dialect or register.

3MS: *-h*

HaNSB 197:

ʾśrq	*m- ḥrn*	*b-ʾbl-**h***
go to the inner desert.SC.3MS	from-Ḥrn	with-camel.COL -CPRO.3MS

'he set off to the inner desert from Ḥrn with his camels'

LP 306:

wgd	*ʾṯr*	*ʾśyʿ-**h***
find.SC.3MS	trace.CNST	companions.PL-CPRO.3MS

'he found the traces of his companions'

3FS: *-h*

AiTN 3:

l	*fṣʾl*	*bnt*	*bngd*	*ḏ*	*ʾl*	*rks*
LA	Fṣʾl	daughter.CNST	Bngd	REL.MS	lineage.CNST	Rks
w	*l-**h***		[h]	*rgm*		
CONJ	PREP-CPRO.3FS		[the]	funerary cairn		

'For Fṣʾl daughter of Bngd of the lineage of Rks and for her is this funerary cairn'

ZSI 1:

ndm	*ʿl-ʾm-h*	*trḥt*	*w*
devastated.SC.3MS	PREP-mother -CPRO.3MS	perish.PPC.3FS	CONJ
bny	*ʿl-**h***		
build.SC.3MS	over -CPRO.3FS		

'he was devastated by grief on account of his mother who had perished and he built upon her (a cairn)'

d. 3S *-nh:* A special *n*-form of the 3MS pronominal suffix occurs occasionally on verbs. This form has been confused in the past for a plural marker on the prefix conjugation; however, several facts rule this out: (1) the relative pronoun preceding these verbs is consistently masculine singular; (2) the formula

logically requires a singular form; and (3) the ending occurs on the imperative and the suffix conjugation as well (e.g. KRS 307). Moreover, verbs terminating in an *n* do not seem to take a nominal direct object. There is one exception, WH 2112 *yʿwrnh h-bkrt*; however, here the second term seems to have been a later addition. Similar forms are found in Hb, *yiqtəlénnû* kill.PC.3MS –CPRO.3MS < *yiqtulinhū; BArm *yiqtəlin<u>k</u>ôn* kill.PC.3MS –CPRO.2MP, and on the participles in some contemporary forms of Arabic, *fāʿilinha* do.ACP.MS –CPRO.3FS.[5] These forms invite comparison with the energic endings in Arabic and Ugaritic. Considering the comparative evidence, the most likely vocalization of this termination is /-Vnnoh/.

LP 566:

ʿwr	*l- <u>d</u>*	*yʿwr-**nh***
Blindness	to- REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS-CPRO-3MS

'let there be blindness to him who effaces it (the inscription)'

Ms 37:

ʿwr	*<u>d</u>*	*yʿwr-**nh***
Blind.IMP.2MS	REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS -CPRO-3MS

'blind him who effaces it (the inscription)'

KRS 307:

h	*y[<u>t</u>]ʿ*	*śʿ-**nh***	*b-<u>d</u>*	*wd*
VOC	[Y<u>t</u>ʿ]	join.IMP.M -CPRO.3MS	with- REL.MS	love.SC.3MS

'O Y<u>t</u>ʿ, join him with the one whom he loved'

KRS 3074:

*ʾgʿ-**nh***	*ʿn*	*bn*	*ʾns*	*ʾ- śn'*
cause pain.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	ʿn	son.CNST	*ʾns*	ART- enemy

"n son of ʾns, the enemy, has caused him pain'

e. 1CP *-n*: The 1CP is only attested once, rhetorically with a singular antecedent. Interestingly, the 1CP is used in an identical way in Hismaic - on the same noun - MNM b 6 *wqʿn <u>d</u>h* 'this inscription of ours'. There is no way to determine the vocalization of this form, but there is nothing to contradict the CAr form /nā/.

[5] These data come from Hasselbach (2006:317); see that publication for more evidence and citations.

AKSD 5:

ṯqb	*yd-h*	*w*	*dśr*	*ʿl*	*ksr*
cut.sc.3ms	hand-CPRO.3MS	CONJ	Dśr	against	destroyer.MS.CNST
*wqʿ-**n***					
inscription.-CPRO.1CS					

'may he he cut off his hand that Dśr be against the destroyer of our inscription'

f. 2D/P *-km*: The two clear attestations of this form occur with dual antecedents, and in C 25, both antecedents are feminine. Unless gender distinction collapsed in the plural, the form *km* must then reflect a dual /-komā/.

C 25:

hy	*lt*	*w*	*h*
VOC	Lt	CONJ	VOC
śms	*ʾṭn*	*ʾl-**km***	*yd-h*
Śms	cut.CSC.3MS	PREP-CPRO.2DU/PL	hand.DU.CNST -CPRO.3MS
l-ṯʾr			
ASV- revenge.SC.3MS			

'O Lt and O Śms, may he cut off his hand for you both (as a promise) that he will have vengeance'

KRS 1683:

h	*gdʿwḏ*	*w*	*h*	*gdḍf*
VOC	Gdʿwḏ	CONJ	VOC	Gdḍf
*ʿwḏ-**km***	*h-ʾbl*			
put under protection.SC.3MS -CPRO.2DU/PL	ART-camel.COL			

'O Gdʿwḏ and O Gdḍf, he placed the camels under your protection'

α. KRS 1683 also attests what seems to be the use of the singular *-k* with a dual antecedent. This may reflect optional feminine singular agreement in pronouns with dual antecedents (see §6.4b.β). The *blessing* component of the inscription reads: *hy lt w h śʿhqm slm w ʿwḏ-**k** w h gdʿwḏ w h gdḏf ʿwḏ-km h-ʾbl* 'O Lt and O S²ʿhqm, let there be security and your protection, and, O Gdʿwḏ and O Gdḏf, he put the camels under your protection'. If this interpretation is correct, then it would imply that *ʿwḏ-km* later in the same inscription would refer to all four previously mentioned deities.

g. 3D/MP *-hm*: If the 3MP is to be compared with the *hm* of the Namārah inscription, then it probably is a reflex of the short form /hom/ rather than /homū/, which would have been written *hmw* in the latter document. The same form is used with two antecedents (e.g. KRS 6), in which case it could reflect either a distinct dual /homā/ or simply the use of the 3MP for both categories.

LP 243:

tśwq	*ʾl-dd-h*	*w*	*ʾśyʿ-h*
long.SC.3MS	PREP-paternal uncle- CPRO.3MS	CONJ	companion.PL -CPRO.3MS
*kll-**hm***			
all-CPRO.3MP			

'he longed for his paternal uncle and his companions, all of them'

KRS 6:

wlh	*ʿl-**hm***	*l-ʾbd*
mourn.SC.3MS	PREP-CPRO.3MP/D	forever

'he mourned for (both of) them forever'

NST 3:

snt	*ḥrb-**hm***	*ʾl*	*ʿwḏ*
year.CNST	plunder.SC.3M –CPRO.3MP	lineage.CNST	ʿwḏ

'the year the lineage of ʿwḏ plundered them'

5 The Verb

a. Overview: The verb has six principal parts: a SUFFIX CONJUGATION, PREFIX CONJUGATION, IMPERATIVE, INFINITIVE, ACTIVE PARTICIPLE, and PASSIVE PARTICIPLE. The purely consonantal orthography often makes it unclear as to which of these is encountered in a given inscription and so both syntactic and pragmatic contexts are required to disambiguate the majority of forms.

5.1 Suffix conjugation

5.1.1 Form

a. The suffix conjugation, cognate with CAr *faʿala*, inflects for PNG through suffixes. The paradigm is incomplete:

	Singular	dual	plural
2f	*-t* /t/ or /tī/	NA	NA
3m	Ø /a/	*-y* /ay/	Ø /ū/
3f	*-t* /at/	NA	*-n*

Figure 19: Attested PNG endings on the Suffix Conjugation

b. 3MP and 3MS: The 3MS is formally identical to the stem to which PNG suffixes are added. Since final long vowels are not indicated in the orthography, the distinction between the 3MP and the 3MS must be determined based on context. The feminine plural is attested once with a collective subject.

3MP

H 506:

ʿwr	*l- ḏw*	***ʿwr***	*h- sfr*
blindness	PREP-REL.MP	efface.SC.3MP	ART- writing

'may they who would efface this writing go blind'

LP 679:

h	*lt*	*ṯ'r*	[*m*]	*m*	***'slf***	{*w*}
VOC	Lt	vengeance	[PREP]	REL	act.SC.3MP	CONJ
{*ṯ*}{*b*}*r*	*l -hm*					
perdition	PREP-CPRO.3MP					

'O Lt, he shall have against whoever has committed this act and may peridition befall them'

3MS

WH 1516:

’{***ḫ***}***ḏ***	*klb-h*	*ḏ’b*
take.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	dog- CPRO.3MS	wolf

'a wolf took his dog'

WH 1698:

snt	***ngy***	*qṣr*	*h-mdnt*
year.CNST	announce.SC.3MS	Caesar	ART- province

'the year Caesar announced the province'

3FP

QZMJ 128:

ṭrdn	*h-ḫl*
year.CNST	announce.SC.3MS

'the horses were driven together'

c. *Wawation on 3rd person verbs*: A few verbs in RSIS are attested with an otiose *w*. While it is tempting to consider this an alternative plural ending, perhaps /aw/, the context in which these verbs are attested does not require a plural.

RSIS 199:

l	*bll*	*bn*	*grm*	*bn*	*drr*	*w*
LA	Bll	son.CNST	Grm	son.CNST	Drr	CONJ
rʿyw	[*w*]	***wrdw***	*h-nmrt*	*f*	*h*	*lt*
pasture.SC.3M	CONJ	go to water.SC.W	Al-Namārah	so	VOC	Lt
rwḥ						
ease						

‘By Bll son of Grm son of Drr and {they/he} pastured then went to water at Namārah so, O Lt, let there be ease’

RSIS 204:

l	*bll*	*bn*	*grm*	*bn*	*drr*	*w*
LA	Bll	son.CNST	Grm	son.CNST	Drr	CON
tśwqw	*ʾl- msˡkt*	*w*	*ḫrṣw*			
long.SC.W	PREP-Msˡkt	and	watch.SC.W			

‘By Bll son of Grm son of Drr and they longed for Msˡkt while they/he kept watch’

RSIS 304:

l	*śʿṯm*	*bn*	*wtr*	*bn*	*ʾbgr*	*ḏ*
LA	S²ʿṯm	son.CNST	Wtr	son.CNST	ʾbgr	REL.MS
ʾl	*frṯ*	*w*	***rʿyw***	*h- ḍʾn*		
lineage.CNST	Frṯ	CONJ	pasture.SC.W	ART- sheep		

‘by S²ʿṯm son of Wtr son of ʾbgr of the lineage of Frṯ and they/he pastured the sheep’

d. 3DU: The dual has been attested once clearly and terminates in a *y* which can reflect nothing other than the dual ending /-ay/. This ending is found in the ASA languages, but differs from CAr and Dadānitic, which both exhibit a reflex of /ā/. Dadanitic, however, maintains a *-y* ending on the the 3MD clitic pronoun, *-hmy.*

LP 305:

w	*wgm*	*ʿl- ʾs*	*w*	*ʿl- wdʿ*	*w*	*kl*	***ḍlly***
CONJ	grieved.sc.3MS	PREP-ʾs¹	CONJ	PREP-wdʿ	CONJ	both	lost.SC.3DU

‘and he grieved for ʾs and wdʿ, and both were lost’

e. 3FS: The 3FS must reflect the ending /at/, and, like nouns, there is no evidence for its shift to /ah/.

AKSJ 1.2.3:

l	*hgr*	*w*	***tśwqt***	*ʾl- ʾlbʾ*
LA	Hgr	CONJ	long.SC.3FS	PREP- ʾlbʾ

‘By Hgr and she longed for ʾlb’’

SIAM 30:

l	*grmt*	*b{t}*	*ḫr*	*w*	*glst*	*ʾl*	*yʾm<<f>>r*
LA	Grmt	{daughter.CNST}	Ḫr	CONJ	HALT.SC.3FS	until	{Capricorn}
f	*wg[d]t*	*ṣfr*	*ʾb*	*f*	*wgmt*	*ʿl-h*	
CONJ	find.SC.3FS	writing.CNST	ʾb	CONJ	grieve.SC.3FS	PREP-cpro.3ms	

'By Grmt daughter of Ḫr and she halted until *yʾmr* (Capricorn}, then she found the writing of ʾb and so she grieved for him'

f. 2S: The identification of the second person forms is challenged by similarities in form and syntax with the infinitive. Since the infinitive can sometimes substitute for a finite verb and often terminates in a *t*, it is impossible to prove that any given form is one or the other. The form *whbt* in the invocation in C 4037 below, for example, could be interpreted as both a 2FS form */wahabt(ī)/ or an infinitive, perhaps /wahbat/. The spelling of the form *lʿt* in CSA 1.2, however, suggests that the final consonant of the verb root, *n*, was contiguous with the *t*. This suggests then a 2fs form of the suffix conjugation, /laʿatt(ī)/ < **laʿanti*.

C 4037:

{h}	*lt*	***whbt***	*śnʾ-h*	*bn-yd-h*
VOC	Lt	give.SC.2FS	enemy-CPRO.3MS	PREP- hand.D.CNST-PRO.3MS

'O Lt, may you give his enemy into his hands'

CSA 1.2:

w	***lʿt***	*lt*	*mn*	*yḫbl-h*
CONJ	curse.SC.2FS	Lt	REL	obscure.PC.3MS –CPRO.3MS

'and may you, Lt, curse whosoever would obscure it (the writing)'

5.1.2 Functions

a. The basic meaning of the suffix conjugation is a perfect; however, it can be translated in various ways depending on its context. With the possible exception of its use as a perfect, which is once marked by *qd* (see α below), the other uses of the suffix conjugation are unmarked, and therefore must be inferred syntactically or pragmatically.

b. Preterite/perfect: The suffix conjugation can indicate a completed action in the past, corresponding to the English past and present perfect.

MKJS 1:

śty	*ʿnzt*
winter.SC.3MS	ʿnzt

'he spent the winter at 'nzt'

C 2036:

wgd	*ḥbb-h*	*f*	***bky***
find.SC.3MS	beloved-CPRO.3MS	CONJ	weep.SC.3MS

'he had found his beloved and so he wept'

c. Pluperfect: The pluperfect always occurs in a subordinate or coordinate clause dependent on another clause containing the preterite/perfect suffix conjugation. In all cases, this function must be inferred from context.

Ms 44:

smʿ	*ʾn*	***myt***	*flfṣ*
heard.SC.3MS	CORD	died.SC.3MS	Flfṣ

'he heard that Flfṣ had died'

C 25:

wgd	*ʾṯr*	*ʾḫ-h*	*f*	*wlh*
find.SC.3MS	trace.CNST	brother-CPRO.3MS	so	be.distraught.SC.3MS

'he had found the trace of his brother and so he was distraught'

α. One unformulaic inscription attests the verbal particle *qd* before the suffix conjugation, which seems to have an identical function to its CAr counterpart *qad*, namely, to emphasize the completion of the action or state.

l	*bṯ*	*w*	*nyk*	*bgrmh*

C 285:

LA	Bṯ	CONJ	copulate.SC.3MS	*bgrmh*
f	*ʾtm*	*zf*	*f*	
CONJ	celebrate.SC.3MS	sending of the bride	CONJ	
qd	*ʾbṣ*			
PERF	be pleased.SC.3MS			

'By Bṯ and he copulated with Grmh after celebrating the sending of the bride and was pleased'

d. Optative: The suffix conjugation can also have an optative force, which is commonly encountered in prayers expressing wishes, hopes, and curses.

HaNSB 371:

sʿd-h	*rḍw*	*m-h-nṣʿ*
aid.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	Rḍw	PREP- enmity

'May Rḍw aid him against enmity'

HaNSB 8:

sʿd-h	*rḍw*	*w*	***ʾkl-h***	*rḍw*
aid.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	Rḍw	CONJ	nourish.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	Rḍw

'may Rḍw aid him and may Rḍw nourish him'

JaS 189.2

ḏkrt	*lt*	*ʾls*	*w*	*rb*
be mindful.SC.3FS	Lt	ʾls	CONJ	Rb

'may Lt be mindful of ʾls and Rb'

α. While optatives are more often encountered with 3rd person verbs, the 2nd person can have this function as well, as illustrated in CSA 1.2 above.

e. Inchoative: The suffix conjugation is often used to describe travels to distant places from the Ḥarrah. These authors had not yet reached their destinations and carve prayers of protection for the journey. In

these cases, verbs of motion like *ʾsfr* "to travel" or *ḫyṭ* "to journey" should be taken as inchoatives, that is, "to set off for," "to begin the journey to" which in turn explains the following prayers for wellbeing.

C 1649:

w	*ʾsfr*	*tdmr*	*f*	*h*	*bʿl*	*slm*
CONJ	travel.SC.3MS	Palmyra	CONJ	VOC	Bʿl	secure.SC.3MS

'and he set off to Palmyra so, O Bʿl, may he be secure'

WH 589:

w	*ʾśrq*	*f*	*h*	*bʿlsmn*	*slm*
CONJ	travel to desert.SC.3MS	CONJ	VOC	Bʿlsmn	secure.SC.3MS

'and he set off for the inner desert so, O Bʿlsmn, may he be secure'

NST 7:

w	*ḫyṭ*	*mdbr*	*f*	*h*	*lt*	*mgdt*
CONJ	journey.SC.3MS	inner desert	CONJ	VOC	Lt	bounty
w	*slm*					
CONJ	security					

'and he set off for the inner desert so, O Lt, let there be bounty and security'

f. Future perfect: This function is most often encountered in curse formulae, where it has a potential force, signifying a possible action that has not yet occurred. On these constructions, see §24.7.2.

NST 3:

w	*ʿwr*	*dśr*	*ḏ*	***ḫbl***
CONJ	blind.SC.3MS	Dśr	REL.MS	obscure.SC.3MS

'and may Dśr blind him who would obscure [this inscription]'

C 1649:

w	*ʿwr*	*l-ḏ*	***ʿwr***	*h- sfr*
CONJ	blindness	PREP-REL	blind.SC.3MS	ART-writing

'and may he who would efface this writing go blind'

WH 613:

f	*gdḍf*	*slm*	*m- śn'*	*slm*	*l- ḏ*
CONJ	Gdḍf	security	from-enemies	secure.INF	PREP-REL.MS
dʿy					
read aloud.SC.3MS					

'So, Gdḍf, may he who would read (this) aloud be secured well against enemies'

5.2 Prefix conjugation

5.2.1 Form

a. The prefix conjugation inflects for PNG through the use of prefixes and suffixes. The 3MS and 3FS are securely attested and are marked by the *y* and *t* prefixes, respectively. Two first person forms with the preformative prefix *n* are attested (especially LP 495, but also WH 135), but it is unclear if they should be interpreted as 1CS or 1CP. If the latter is correct, then it would suggest that the dialect of the Safaitic inscriptions underwent the same analogy as Jewish Palestinian Aramaic and the Maghrebine dialects of Arabic, namely, the leveling of the *nV*- preformative prefix from the 1CP to the singular, producing the symmetrical paradigm, *nifʿal* and *nifʿalū*. While context of LP 495 is unclear and permits both interpretations, WH 135 points towards a 1CS interpretation:

WH 135:

l	*qny*	*f*	*h*	*lt*	*qbll*	*ʾhl*	*slm*
LA	Qny	CONJ	VOC	Lt	reunion	family.(CPRO.1CS?)	safe
f	***nngy***						
CONJ	be saved.PC.1CS(?)						

'By Qny, so, O Lt, may there be a safe reunion with (my) family that I/we may be saved'

The author of this inscription seems to have switched persons in the prayer component, indicating perhaps that it reflects a fixed oral expression. If the word *ʾhl* 'family' is followed by a 1CS suffix pronoun that is not expressed graphically, cf. *h lt qbll ʾhl -h slm* 'O Lt, may there be a safe reunion with his family' (KRS 1990), then the prefix conjugated verb should be taken as a 1CS rather than a plural. Even if *ʾhl* should be taken simply as 'family', without a pronominal suffix, the final verb can still be interpreted as such on contextual grounds: an individual is more likely to be saved by being reunited with a group rather than the other way around.

b. A1 attests the prefix conjugation of the verb 'to pasture' in the form ειραυ */yirʿaw/ 'they pasture'. If names in the Graeco-Arabica such as Ιαμβλιχος /*yamlik/ reflect the Safaitic situation, then it would seem that Barth's law was operational.[6] However, names based on the prefix conjugation could be traditional, and so perhaps the two sources cannot be directly compared.

c. The same verb ειραυ in A 1 suggests that the masculine plural ending verbs derived from III-w/y roots was */aw/ as in CAr. The absence of the *-n* ending indicates that this verb reflects a short prefix

[6] i.e. the vowel is /a/ when the theme vowel of the verb stem is /i/ or /u/ and the preformative vowel is /i/ when the theme vowel is /a/.

conjugation (see below), with a preterite meaning. There are no other unambiguous instances of the second or third person plurals.

	Singular	Dual	Plural
1c	*n-* (?)	NA	*n-*
3m	*y-*	NA	ɛι = *y*
3f	*t-*	NA	NA

Figure 20: Attested preformative prefixes of the prefix conjugation

5.2.2 Function

a. Historically, the CS prefix conjugation had two forms: (1) a short form (=Ar, Hb Jussive): 3MS *yaqtul*, 3MP *yaqtulū*, and (2) an augmented form, which terminated in /na/ in forms ending in a vowel (i.e., the 2FS, the duals, and the 3MP) and in /u/ in other cases (cf. the CAr indicative mood) – 3MS *yaqtulu*, 3MP *yaqtulūna*. The augmented form signifies the indicative imperfect, which is formally unmarked for tense, but generally signifies the present-future and durative aspect. The short form was originally a preterite, but this function was largely supplanted by the suffix conjugation in WS. While the preterite sense is preserved in certain constructions in CAr, its primary function is modal, a volitive/optative. Arabic developed a second augmented form, the *subjunctive*, which terminates in /a/, rather than /u/, but lacked the /na/ endings on the 2fs, 2mp, and 3mp forms: 3MS *yaqtula*, 3MP *yaqtulū*. The subjunctive is used in subordinate clauses, mainly after the coordinator *ʾan*, and in result clauses after *fa-*. All of these functions are attested in the Safaitic inscriptions, but must be, for the most part, inferred as there is usually no graphic distinction between the two forms. Finally, a few examples of the preterite use of the prefix conjugation are attested.

b. Non-Past Indicative: The indicative imperfect is infrequently encountered in the inscriptions, mainly because most formulae require a preterite verb.

WH 3929:

ytẓr	*ḥyt*
await.PC.3MS	animal.PL

'(while) lying in wait for animals'

c. Subjunctive: The subjunctive function of the prefix conjugation is most often encountered in blessing and curse formulae. In this context, its sense is identical to the potential force of the future-perfect suffix conjugation.

C 4803:

w	*ḥyy*	*l-ḏ*	***yqrʾ***	*h- ktb*
CONJ	life	PREP-REL.MS	read.PC.3MS	ART-writing

‘and may he who would this writing aloud have long life’

C 286:

h	*rḍy*	*ʿwr*	*l- ḏ*	***yʿwr***
VOC	Rḍy	blindness	PREP-REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS

‘O Rḍy, may he who would efface go blind’

WH 2112:

h	*rḍw*	*ʿwr*	*ḏ*	***yʿwr -nh***
VOC	Rḍw	blind.IMP.2MS	REL.MS	effaces.PC.3MS -CPRO.3MS

‘O Rḍw, blind him who would efface it (the inscription)’

d. Volitive: The prefix conjugation can also be used – independently or following the asseverative *l* – as a volitive, cf. CAr *li-yafʿal* ‘let him do’.

Independent:

LP 643:

ngʿ	*ʿl- śmt*	*ʾsr*	*f*	*h*	*lt*
grieve in pain.SC.3MS	PREP-S²mt	captured.PPC.3MS	CONJ	VOC	Lt
yslm					
secure.PC.3MS					

‘he grieved in pain for S²mt who was captured so, O Lt, let him be secure’

With the asseverative *l*:

h	*rḍw*	*f*	***l-yʿwr***
VOC	Rḍw	CONJ	ASV- efface.PC.3MS
m	*ʿwr*	*w*	***l-yqʾ***
REL	efface.SC.3MS	CONJ	ASV-thrown-out.PC.3MS -CPRO.3MS
b- ṣdq			

AWS 237:

PREP-friend			

'By Rḍw, let anyone who would efface be made blind, then let him be thrown out of the grave by a friend'

The negated short imperfect can also have a volitive meaning:

HshNSMI 5:

w	***lm***	***yḫbl***	*sfr*
VOC	Rḍw	blind.IMP.2MS	REL.MS

'and may [the] writing not be effaced'

e. The prefix conjugation is also used in purpose and result clauses, where one would normally encounter the subjunctive in CAr. The final consonant of the III-w/y prefix conjugation in result clauses surfaces in the orthography, which points towards a final triphthong, e.g., *nngy* 'that I/we may live long'. Such a form can only go back to a triradical stem terminating in an /a/ vowel /nangeya/, as III-w/y participles show that the sequence *iyu* collapsed to a long vowel (§3.4a). The second subjunctive prefix conjugation, *nḥyy* (LP 495), only indicates that it goes back to a triradical stem which terminated in a vowel, the quality of that vowel is unclear. The indicative *niḥyayu would yield /neḥyay/ while the subjunctive *niḥyaya would yield /neḥyaya/, both in turn would have been spelled as *nḥyy*.

LP 495:

h	*rḍw*	*flṭ -n*	*m- b's*	*w*	***nḥyy***
VOC	Rḍw	deliver.IMP.MS -CPRO.1CP	from- misfortune	CONJ	live.PC.1CP

'O Rḍw, deliver us from misfortune that we may live long'

LP 712:

wrd	*b-r'y*	*ḏl*	[*l-*] {***y***}***śrb***
go to water.SC.3MS	PREP-rising.CNST	Pisces	[to-] drink.{PC.3MS}

'he went to water during the rising of Pisces in order to drink'

LP 180:

trwḥ	*l-yśrq*	*l-mdbr*
set off at night.SC.3MS	PREP-travel to desert.PC.3MS	PREP- inner desert

'he set off at night in order to travel to the inner desert towards the inner desert'

f. Explicit future: While the *u*-augmented prefix conjugation can be used to signify present or future time, CAr marked the explicit future through the use of a preverbal particle *sawfa* and its clitic form *sa-*. This particle is attested once in the Safaitic inscriptions.

ASWS 18:

slm	*l-ḏ*	*sʾr*	*w*	*nqʾt*
security	PREP-REL	remain.SC.3MP	CONJ	thrown out.INF
l-ḏ	***s-yʿwr***			
for- REL	FUT-efface.PC.3MS			

'may those who remain (alive) have security and may he who will efface
be thrown out of the grave'

f. Preterite: The original preterite sense of the unaugmented prefix conjugation is preserved following the negative particle *lm*, just as in CAr *lam yafʿal* 'he did not do'. A1 attests an unaugmented prefix conjugated verb in a context in which a past tense interpretation is preferred: ουα ειραυ βακλα βι-Χανου[ν] */wa yirʿaw baqla bi-kanū[n]/ 'and they pastured fresh herbage during [Kanūn]'.

MSNS 2

bġy	*ʾḫ -h*	*f*	***lm***	***yʿd***
seek.SC.3MS	brother-CPRO.3MS	CONJ	NEG	return.PC.3MS

'he sought after his brother but he did not return'

5.3 Infinitive

a. The infinitive is a substantive which refers to the act or state denoted by the verb, corresponding roughly to the English gerund and *to*-infinitive.

5.3.1 Form

a. The infinitive must usually be identified syntactically, as it is often orthographically identical to the suffix conjugation. The infinitive of weak roots is sometimes distinguished from the SC by derivational prefixes or suffixes; these will be discussed more extensively in the following section. Unlike finite verbs and adjectives, the infinitive does not exhibit agreement with its logical subject. It is unclear if the infinitive was marked by the accusative when it was the complement of a finite verb or if it was generally unmarked by case endings. If *ḫwf* in KRS 1949 is to be interpreted as part of an infinitive chain construction (§16.1), then the coalescence of its *f* with the following conjunction in spelling suggests that it was not followed by a vowel.

5.3.2 Function

a. Infinitives have a variety of functions, including assertion, commands, purpose and result clauses, and even replacing a finite verb entirely. They are unmarked for TAM and so acquire these features from their pragmatic context. These functions will be discussed in greater detail in (§16), so a few illustrative examples will suffice here:

Purpose

NST 3:

ʾty	***nẓr***	*h- ṯbrn*	*mn- ʾl*
come.SC.3MS	guard.INF	ART- warrior.PL	PREP- lineage.CNST
ṣbḥ	*snt*	*ḥrb-hm*	*ʾl*
Ṣbḥ	year.CNST	war.SC.MP-CPRO.3MP	lineage.CNST
ʿwḏ			
ʿwḏ			

'the warriors of the lineage of Ṣbḥ came to guard the year the lineage of ʿwḏ waged war against them'

Command

SIJ 808:

w	*nẓr*	*ś{n}ʾ*	*f*	*h*	*lt*	***fṣy***
CONJ	guard.SC.3MS	{enemy.PL}	CONJ	VOC	Lt	deliver.INF

'and he stood guard against {enemies}, so, O Lt, deliver!'

Replacing a finite verb

Mu 253:

wgd	*ʾṯr*	*ʾb -h*	*f*	*bk{y}*
find.SC.3MS	trace.CNST	father -CPRO.3MS	CONJ	{weep.SC.3MS}
w	***ḏkr***	*l- ʾ{ḫ} -h*	*{ʔ}wl*	
CONJ	remember.INF	PREP-brother -CPRO.3MS	{ʿwl}	

'he found the trace of his father, and so he wept and remembered his brother ʿwl'

5.4 Imperative

a. The imperative expresses a direct request or command. They occur almost exclusively in prayer and curse formulae, where in most cases they can only be distinguished from cognate abstract nouns by their syntax. The imperative will take a direct object whereas the corresponding formula containing nominal forms mark the logical object with the dative *l-* or with the object wholly unexpressed. Compare the following:

Imperative
KRS 102:

w	*rḏw*	***ʿwr***	*ḏ*	*yʿwr*
CONJ	Rḏw	blind.IMP.3MS	REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS

'O Rḏw, blind him who would efface'

Abstract noun
KRS 1161:

h	*lt*	***ʿwr***	*l-ḏ*	*yʿwr*
VOC	Lt	blindness	PREP-REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS

'O Lt, may he who would efface go blind' (lit. blindness be to him…)

Imperative
LP 1013:

h	*ḏśr*	***slm-h***	{*m-*} {*h*}- *sl*{*ṯ*}{*n*}
VOC	Ḏśr	secure.IMP.M-CPRO.3MS	{from} {ART-} {authorities}

'O Ḏśr, keep him safe from the authorities (i.e., the Romans or Nabataeans)'

Abstract noun
C 2315:

h	*lt*	*w*	*dśr*	***slm***	*m- śn'*
VOC	Lt	CONJ	dśr	security	from- enemy.PL

'O Lt and Dśr, let there be security against enemies'

5.5 Participles

a. Overview: The participle is an adjective containing the meaning of the verb. They come in two forms - the active and passive and decline as adjectives:

MS	FS	MD	MP
trḥ	*trḥt*	*trḥn*	*trḥn*

Table #: Attested forms of the participle *trḥ* */tarīḥ/ 'perished'

Function

a. The syntax of the participle will be discussed in more detail in §5.5, but a few notes on its functions are appropriate here.

b. Imperfective: The participle can replace the prefix conjugation with the same modal nuances:

LP 257:

h	lt	{*ḫ*}*rs*	*l-m*	***mḫbl***	*h-* {*s*}*fr*
VOC	Lt	{dumbness}	PREP-REL	obscure.APC.MS	ART-{writing}

'O Lt, may anyone who would be an obscurer of this writing become dumb'

C 1339:

l	*ḥy'l*	*bn*	*ẓ*{*n*}'{*l*}	***dm***	*l- 'slm*	*'ḍl-h*
LA	Ḥy'l	son.CNST	{Ẓn'l}	draw.APC.MS	for- 'sˡlm	companion-CPRO.3MS

'By Ḥy'l son of Ẓn'l who has drawn for 'slm his companion'

c. The participle can be used adverbially to signal an action contemporary with the main event.

C 28:

w	*byt*	***ḫyṭ***	*f*
CONJ	spend the night.SC.3MS	to journey.APC.MS	CONJ
tẓr	*h-'sd*		
await.SC.3MS	Leo		

'and he spent the night while journeying, and awaited [the appearance of] Leo'

d. Perfective: The participle can also have a perfective sense when used in adverbial clauses. While this function is typical for the passive participle in other Semitic languages, it is uncommon with the active.

However, many modern dialects of Arabic attest a similar function, e.g. Damascene Arabic, *fāteḥ* 'having opened' < **fātiḥun*, *ʾāri* 'having read' < **qāriʾun* (Cowell 2005:258ff.).

MKJS 1:

w	*śty*	*ʿnzt*	***nfr***	*mn-ʾ- rm*
CONJ	winter.SC.3MS	ʿnzt	flee.APC.MS	PREP-ART- Rm

'and he wintered in ʿnzt having fled from the Romans'

ISB 421:

l	*ḫzr*	*bn*	*frhz*	*h- dr*	***mḥrb***	*ygr*
LA	Ḫzr	son.COST	Frhz	ART- place	plunder.PPC.MS	persevere.PC.3MS

'Ḫzr son of Frhz perseveres in this place having been plundered'

ASWS 73:

ngʿ	*ʿl-ḥbb*	*w*	*ʿl-h- ʾbl*
grieve in pain.SC.3MS	PREP-loved one	CONJ	PREP-ART- camels
rʿy-h	***hgr***	*m-mdbr*	
pasture.SC.3MS –CPRO.3FS	migrate.APC.MS	PREP-inner desert	

'and he grieved in pain for Ḥbb and for the camels which he had pastured having migrated from the inner desert'

5.6 Verb stems

a. Like other Semitic languages, different stems – characterized by vowel apophony, gemination, prefixes, and infixes - are used to express voice and causative/factitive features in the verb. The orthography distinguishes six basic *classes* behind which stand at least eight verb stems. They are:

Verb Stems

CCC = G (= CAr. faʿala); D (= CAr. faʿʿala); L (= CAr. fāʿala)
ʾCCC = C (= CAr. ʾafʿala) and possibly a cD (Gz. ʾaqattala)
CtCC = Gt (= CAr. iftaʿala)
tCCC = tD (= CAr. tafaʿʿala); tL (= CAr. tafāʿala); tG (= EAr. itfaʿal; Arm. *eṯqṭel*)
nCCC = N (= CAr. infaʿala)
stCCC = Ct (CAr. Istafʿala)

b. Semiticists further sub-divide these stems into two conjugational classes: strong and weak. The definition of *weak* differs from language to language, but generally refers to verbs that do not maintain all three root consonant across the various principal parts. In the Safaitic inscriptions, weak verbs encompass roots with a glide consonant, *y* or *w*, in any position, and geminate roots, i.e., those roots in which the second and third consonant are identical. Strong verbs include everything else. The following overview will discuss the attested forms, their functions, and possible vocalizations.

5.6.1 CCC

a. This is the most common class in Safaitic, which comprises three verbal stems, G, D, and L. The G can be distinguished from the latter two if the corresponding participle is attested. The D and L, however, must be distinguished on etymological or semantic grounds. Moreover, the existence of the L-stem is purely conjectural, and is only posited because some CCC-class verbs have a reciprocal sense, which is typically associated with the L-stem in CAr.

5.6.1.1 G-stem

a. The basic G-stem verb can have either a transitive or intransitive meaning. Based on comparative evidence, this distinction was likely signaled by a change in the vowel of the penultimate syllable, /a/ for transitive, CAr *qatala* 'he killed', and either /i/ or /u/ for intransitive and stative meanings, CAr *ʿaliqa* 'it hung', and *ḥasuna* 'he was handsome, good'.

b. *Suffix Conjugation:* The vocalization CvCvC, rather than (v)CCvC as in some later varieties of Arabic, is confirmed by the fact that I-n roots never exhibit assimilation of the first consonant and the spelling of the verb *ʾtw* as αθαοα in A1.

c. *Prefix Conjugation*: The morphological shape */yVCCvC/ is confirmed for the augmented prefix conjugation based on the spelling of I-n verb *ygr* 'he endures' (ISB 421) */yVggor/ < */yVngur/ and by the spelling of the II-w/y root √nwy as *yny,* indicating a vocalization with a medial vowel rather than a consonant (see §5.6.1.1.1). The short form is attested in A 1 as ειραυ */yirʿaw/ 'they pastured'.
d. *Infinitive and Abstract Nouns*: The infinitive of strong roots is attested as both *qtl* and *qtlt*. These could correspond to nearly twenty forms in CAr used for verbal and abstract substantives. Indeed, the spelling of the infinitive of weak roots indicates that a variety of patterns were in use (see below).

e. *Imperative*: The imperative has the shape *qtl*. Since no I-n roots have been attested as imperatives, it is impossible to determine whether this form was vocalized as */VqtVl/ or */qVtVl/.

f. *Participles*: The active participle – also spelled *qtl* - was likely vocalized as CāCeC. Names derived from this pattern are well attested in Greek transcription, e.g. Ανεμου /ġānem/, Μαλεχαθη /mālekat/, Αμηρος /ʿāmer/. The passive comes in two shapes, *qtl* and *mqtl*. The former probably reflects two patterns, *qatīl* and *qatūl*, both of which are found in CAr, e.g. *qatīlun*, *qatūlun* 'killed'. The Graeco-Arabic transcription from the southern Levant attest both patterns in Arabic personal names, Ουασιμαθος /wasīmat/ and Αβουβαθη /ḥabūbat/. The second form *mqtl* is cognate with the productive *maqtūl*-passive of CAr and is found in Nabataean graffiti from the Sinai, *mdkwr* /maḏkūr/, in the Graeco-Arabica, in the personal name Μαχσουραθη /maqṣūrat/, and in a toponym in P. Petra 17, Μεφωρ /meḥfōr/ 'dug out'.

SC	PC	INF	IMP	APC	PPC
qtl	*yqtl*	*qtl*(*t*)	*qtl*	*qtl*	*qtl/mqtl*

Figure 21 : G *principal parts*

Transitive:

C 3820:

wgd	*ʾṯr*	*ʾḫ-h*
find.SC.3MS	trace.CNST	brother -CPRO.3MS

'he found the trace of his brother'

C 4443:

qtl-h	{ʾ}*l*	*ṣbḥ*
kill.SC.3 -CPRO.3M	{lineage.CNST}	Ṣbḥ

'the lineage of Ṣbḥ killed him'

LP 325:

h	*lt*	*slm*	*w*	*ġnmt*	*l- ḏ*	***dʿy***	*h- sfr*
VOC	Lt	security	CONJ	spoil	PREP-REL	read aloud.SC.3MS	ART- writing

'O Lt, may he who would reads this writing aloud have security and spoil'

Intransitive/Stative:

C 2190:

snt	***myt***	{*d*}{*d*} *-h*
year.CNST	died.SC.3MS	{paternal uncle} -CPRO.3MS

'the year his paternal uncle died'

KRS 29:

ḫrṣ	*ḏ*	***bʿd***	*m- ʾśyʿ*
watch.SC.3MS	REL.MS	be far.SC.3MS	PREP- companion.PL

'he kept watch for him who was far from companions'

NSR 117:

w	***wḥd***
CONJ	alone.SC.3MS

"and he was alone'

5.6.1.1.1 Notes on weak roots

a. I-y/w

Suffix Conjugation: Roots containing a glide as an initial radical do not exhibit irregular behavior in the G suffix conjugation, *whb* 'he gave' (passim); *wgm* 'he grieved' (passim); *yʾs* 'he despaired' (CSNS 957).

Prefix Conjugation: In an unpublished inscription from Wādī al-Ḥašād, the prefix conjugation of the verb *wgd* 'to find' is attested in the expression: *lm ygd-h* /lam yaged-oh/ 'he did not find him' (Al-Jallad 2016: 80).

Infinitives and Abstract Nouns: The infinitive of this class seems to lack the initial consonant and terminates with a *t*: *qyt* 'to protect' (C 1837, 4068) < √wqy, while abstract nouns may retain the initial *w: wqyt* 'to preserve' (WH 159) < √wqy.

Imperative: The imperative of *whb* 'he gave' is attested as *hb* (LP 460; Mu 571), without the initial glide (cf. CAr *hab*). Other inscriptions (e.g. C 3757), however, attest *whb* in a context where it should be

understood as a command. This could reflect the use of the D-stem as the equivalent of the G or the infinitive.

b. II-w/y

Suffix Conjugation: The original realization of roots containing a glide in C^2 position is disputed. Huehnergard (2005:177, n.75) has suggested that the collapse of these sequences to /ā/ was the result of a Proto-Semitic sound change. The medial radical was then restored independently in Gz, *kōna* < *kawna < *kawina and ASA *kwn*. Suchard (2017), however, has argued that forms with a medial glide must be reconstructed for Proto-Hebrew, which, in turn, suggests that a tri-radical stem must be reconstructed for Proto-Canaanite. This would mean that the Gz and ASA forms are in fact archaisms and the remaining Semitic languages collapsed the diphthong in this position independently. The interpretation of the Safaitic evidence is therefore dependent upon which view of the Proto-Semitic situation we chose. The inscriptions attest two forms, one with a medial glide and one without: *mt* 'he died' and *myt; bt* 'he spent the night' (C 3466) and *byt*; *ʿd* 'he returned' (KhMNS 13) and *ʿwd*, *ʿyd*; *rḥ* 'he departed at night' (CSNS 818) and *rwḥ*. Some of these, especially those expressing movement, can be seen as the result of semantic overlap between the G and D, something which is attested in the modern dialects of Arabic, LAr *rāḥ* and *rawwaḥ*, both 'he left'. This explanation, however, seems unlikely in the case of intransitive G-stems, where the D usually forms the causative/factitive. Thus either the medial glide was analogically restored or the tri-radical forms reflect the Proto-Arabic situation, and the biradical forms already display the collapse of the original triphthong, a process that seems to have been complete by the time of the Arabic Grammarians in the 8th c. CE.

If indeed forms like *myt* preserve the original situation, then it begs the question as to why the medial glide no longer reflects the original value of the root – one would expect *mwt*. It is possible that the *y* value was simply leveled to all II-w/y roots in the suffix conjugation, which would, in turn, mean that CCC verbs exhibiting a medial *w* must belong to the D-stem. However, another explanation is possible. In Gz, all II-w/y belong to the intransitive CaCi/uCa pattern of the suffix conjugation (cf. *kōna* above). The same seems to be true in the pre-history of Arabic (Suchard 2017; Al-Jallad 2018). The suffix conjugation of II-w/y verbs exhibits an interesting allomorphy, where in the 3P, the medial vowel is /ā/ while in the first and second it is a short high vowel, either /u/ or /i/. The reflex is lexical and cannot be inferred from the shape of the root. To explain this variation, Bauer (1912: 111) posited two, stress-based sound changes: *áwi/u* > *ā* and *awí/ú#* > *i* and *u*, respectively: *máwita* > *māta* but *mawítta* > *mittu* and *qáwuma* > *qāma* but *qawúmtu* > *qumtu*. Safaitic forms such as *myt* and *byt* may therefore reflect a pre-contraction situation. If so, then the *y* of *myt* could be explained by the fact that the root probably formed an *i*-class suffix conjugation stem, CaCiCa. In this case, the /w/ could have shifted to /y/ under the influence of the following /i/, **mawita* > **mayita* > *myt* /mayeta/. Forms such as *rwḥ* may reflect a CaCuCa pattern or the use of the D-stem.

Curiously, there are no inflected examples of G-stems with a medial glide. A feminine form of the root √mwt is attested thrice as *mtt*, twice in a context where it could be understood as an adjective (NST 2 and ASWS 70) and once where it must be a suffix conjugated verb (AbaNS 86). The sample size is obviously too small to arrive at any conclusions. This distribution may simply be a result of coincidence,

namely, that all of the feminine forms attested reflect dialects which have collapsed the medial triphthong. It is also possible that such forms reflect an underlying /maytat/, with the syncope of the medial vowel. Finally, one may suggest that triphthong collapsed when followed by a closed syllable, yielding 3ms */mayeta/ but 3fs */mātat/ < *mayetat; the stem of the 3FS could have eventually been leveled to the masculine, producing forms like *mt* /māta/. If the identification of *qt-h* as the infinitive *qyt* 'to protect' with a pronominal suffix is correct, it may suggest that a similar sound change was operational there as well: /qeyatoh/ > /qātoh/ vs. /qeyat/, without a suffix.

One possible example of the 2FS is attested, *ʿṣt* */ʿeṣt(ī)/(?) 'may you cause hardship' (CEDS 183) < √ʿwṣ, but a 3FS interpretation is also possible.

Prefix conjugation: Only three verbs of this root class are attested in the prefix conjugation, one reflecting the short prefix conjugation: *lm yʿd* */yVʿod/ 'he did not return' (MSNS 2)[7] < √ʿwd; and the other which could be interpreted as either a short or augmented form, *ʿkd-h yṣn* */yVṣūn/ 'after it [the withholding of the rain], may he preserve [it]' (LP 722 = SG 1) < √ṣwn.

The prefix conjugation of the verb *nwy* 'to migrate' is attested as *yny* (C 1108); doubly weak verbs such as this inflect according to the III-w/y pattern, so perhaps *yanyī*, cf. CAr *rawā, yarwī*. If *ygy* (KRS 583) is cognate with CAr *yaǧīʾu*, then it may have originally been a III-w/y root.

Infinitive/Abstract nouns: The infinitive is attested without the medial glide *ḥb* 'to lament' (WH 116) probably */ḥūb/ or */ḥawb/ < √ḥwb. Other forms with medial glides probably reflect a pattern with a long vowel following C², {*ġ*}*yr* 'to provide provisions' (SIJ 463), perhaps */ġVyār/ or */ġVyūr/. The *ʿn* in the blessing component of C 5182, *h* {*l*}[*t*] {ʿ}*n,* could reflect the use of an infinitive as a command /ʿawn/ or /ʿūn/ 'help!', or even an imperative /ʿūnī/. The infinitive of *ʿwḏ* is attested with an *n*-suffix: *ʿl-h ʿwḏn* 'may it/he be protected' (KRS 1427).

Participles: Active participles with a medial glottal stop are attested beside forms with a medial glide: *kʾn* (LP 1198) 'existing' < *√kwn to *ḫyṭ* 'journeying' (C 28) < √ḫyṭ, and *gyʿ* 'starving' (C 3811) <√gwʿ. These no doubt reflect dialectal variation. A participle or verbal adjective of *myt* might be attested once in C 1133 as *mt*: *w wgm ʿl- ʾbrś mt mn*{*y*} 'and he mourned for ʾbrś who died by the hand of Fate (lit. by Fate)', since this formula usually makes use of adjectives. However, one cannot exclude the possibility of a finite verb in this position. Other attestations are ambiguous (see CSNS 65, 89). The II-w/y participle is attested once in CSNS 282 *mlm* /malīm/ 'blameworthy', from √lwm.

c. III-w/y

Suffix conjugation: Bearing in mind the possible sound change *w* > *y* in word final position, the class does not exhibit irregular behavior, *ngy* 'he was announced' (WH 15); *mṭy* 'he journeyed' (C 663); *śry* 'he purchased' (C 2832). The final *y* is preserved in the 3FS as well: *ngyt ʾ- mlkt* 'the Queen was announced' (SIJ 786). There is no unambiguous evidence for the collapse of the etymological word-final triphthong.

[7] This form reflects a historic short vowel, as in the CAr jussive.

These forms can reflect three vocalizations */qataya/, */qatoya/, and */qateya/. The verb *rḍy* (KRS 1042) goes back to a form with an *i theme vowel: /raṣeya/ < *raṣiwa. Relic forms are also attested where the etymologically correct third radical is preserved, *śtw* */śatawa/ 'he wintered' (CSNS 324), *ngw* */nagawa/ 'he escaped' (CEDS 136), *ʾtw* 'he came' (SIJ 957) = Αθαοα /ʾatawa/ (A 1).

Prefix conjugation: The subjunctive preserves the final *y*, *nḥyy* 'that I/we may live' */nVḥyaya/ (LP 495) and *nngy* 'that I/we may be saved' */nVngoya/ (WH 135). The indicative, however, lacks the final consonant, in turn proving the presence of a final /a/ on the subjunctive, *ydʿ* /yadʿī/ (QZMJ 468).

Infinitive and Abstract Nouns: The infinitive is often identical to the suffix conjugation, *rʿy* 'to pasture' (KRS 37), *fṣy* 'to deliver' (C 1137; SIJ 808), and may reflect either CVCy or CVCv̄y patterns. A by-form of the infinitive *śty* 'to winter' is attested with a *t*-suffix and the loss of the glide, *śtt* (KRS 37), perhaps /śatat/ or /śatāt/ < **śatayat*. Abstract nouns of this class can appear with a final *-t: fṣyt* 'deliverance' (KRS 1706); *rʿyt* 'pasturing' (KRS 1886); {*n*}*gwt* 'escape' (C 4842); and without, *ḥlw* 'healing' (C 3365).

Participles: As discussed in (§4.6), the few examples of active participles of this root class seem to point towards a morphological difference between nominative and adverbial forms. The former are bi-radical - *dm* (C 1339) 'drawing' */dāmī/ < √dmy; *śt* (C 1868) 'wintering' */śātī/ <√śty; *ḥḍ* (ASWS 124) 'frightening /ḥāḍī/ < √ḥzy, while the later exhibit the final radical - *rʿy* (C 2446) 'while pasturing' and *ʿny* 'while suffering' (KRS 1964), most likely /rāʿeya/ and /ʿāneya/, respectively. Passive participles retain the final radical in the singular and plural, *sby* (C 2113) 'captured', perhaps /sabeyy/, and *sbyn* (ASWS 18) /sabeyyīna/, and *msby* 'idem' (HCH 132) */masbeyy/.

d. $C^2 = C^3$

Suffix Conjugation: All of the CS languages attest two patterns in the declension of geminate roots: the first clusters C^2 and C^3 without an intervening vowel (*yaruddu*) and the second treats them identically to strong roots (*yardudu*). The former pattern is considered a CS innovation (see Huehnergard 2005: 173ff.). A similar pattern is encountered in the suffix conjugation - the G-stem of geminate roots is often biradical, *ḥl* (C 726, 2104) 'he camped' < √ḥll; *mr* (RSIS 80) 'he passed by'; *wd* (KRS 307) 'he loved' <√wdd; *f ḥy* (C 1280) 'that he may live long' < √ḥyy < *√ḥyw, but some verbs of this root class have by-forms where both consonants are kept apart, thus *ḥll* 'he camped' (passim) alongside *ḥl*. It is unclear if the doubled forms are archaisms reflecting /ḥalala < **ḥalala*, innovations based on the analogy of strong roots, or, perhaps most likely, the use of the D in place of the G.

Prefix Conjugation: The stem of the prefix conjugation is attested only twice in the clustered form, *l-yḥg* 'in order to go one a pilgrimage' /le-yaḥogga/ (WH 3053) < √ḥgg; *ysr* /yaserr/ 'to be satisfied, successful' (KhBG 411).

Infinitive: The infinitive of √ḥll is attested in JaS 159.2 and C 2158 as *ḥlt* 'to camp', which should probably be vocalized as */ḥVllat/. Other cases of C^2=C^3 roots with a t-suffix can be interpreted as infinitives or abstract nouns: *wdt* 'to (show) love' (WH 2194) <√wdd; *rdt* 'compensation; to compensate' (C 1639) < √rdd.

Participles: The active participle is clearly attested once in a clustered form, *ḥl* 'camping' */ḥāll/ (C 407) < √ḥll, cf. CAr *ḥāllun*. The particle of the root √*ġzz*, however, is attested in an unclustered form in WH 128, *ġzz* 'having gone on a raid'. This is unexpected because the finite verb is always *ġzz*, pointing towards a D-stem, the participle of which would be *mġzz*. However, since this root is a back-formation from an original √ġzy, it is possible that there was a suppletive G-stem participle, or that this form reflects the so-called emphatic participle, *ġazzāz*. Greek transcriptions mostly attest unclustered forms, e.g. Τανενου /ṭānen/; Βανενη /bānen/. Passive participles/adjectives only attest unclustered forms, *wdd* (LP 673) 'beloved' */wadīd/ < √wdd; *ḥbb* (C 96) 'loved one' */ḥabīb/ < √ḥbb; *ḍll* (HCH 131) 'lost' */ṣalīl/, and possibly an *m*-passive participle: *mḥbb* (WH 116) 'loved one' */maḥbūb/ < √ḥbb, although this form can also be interpreted as a C-stem (see below).

5.6.1.2 D/L-stem

a. The D-stem makes stative G-stems transitive and forms the causative of transitive G-stems, but it can also replace the G and C with no apparent difference in meaning.

Suffix Conjugation: Verbs of this class are indistinguishable from their G counterparts in consonantal garb. There is nothing to contradict a direct reflex of the original vocalization, CaCCaCa, thus *ḫbl* 'he obscure' /ḫabbala/ (NST 3).

Prefix Conjugation: There is no evidence for the vocalization of this form, but again nothing contradicts a normal reflex of *yuCaCCiC, thus *yḫbl* /yoḫabbel/ (KRS 1042) and *yslm-h* /yosallem-oh/ (AWS 264).

Infinitive and Abstract Nouns: The infinitive is attested with a *t*-prefix (cf. CAr *tafʿīlun*, *tifʿāl*), *tḍbʾ* 'to raid' (LP 742), probably */taṣbīʾ/; *trwḥ* */tarwīḥ/ 'to send the winds' (SESP.U 18), and the abstract noun *tsfr* /taspīr/ 'writing' (HAUI 76).

Imperative: The imperative is identical to the suffix conjugation and can only be inferred from context. There is nothing to contradict the vocalization */CaCCeC/, thus *wlh* 'cause grieve!' */walleh/ (C 3177).

Participles: The active and passive are distinguished by vowel ablaut in the stem final syllable, CAr active *mufaʿʿilun* and passive *mufaʿʿalun*. The Greek transcriptions from southern Syria suggest a similar vocalization, although no passives have been attested - Μοαινος /moʿayyin/; Μοαιερος /moġayyer/, and so on. If these transcriptions reflect the situation in the Safaitic dialects, then the vocalization moCaCCeC for the active participle seems likely, *mḫbl* */moḫabbel/ (Mu 278). One example of the passive has so far been attested, *mʿwr* /moʿawwar/ 'effaced' (AWS 48).

SC	PC	INF	IMP	AP	PP
qtl	*yqtl*	*tqtl/qtlt*	*qtl*	*mqtl*	**mqtl*

Figure 22: The principal parts of the D-stem

The D-stem as a causative of the G:

C 3177:

h	*rḍ*[*w*]	***wlh***	*w*	***ʿwr***
VOC	Rḍ[w]	make grieve.IMP.2MS	CONJ	blind.IMP.2MS
m	*ʿwr*			
REL	efface.SC.3MS			

'O Rḍw, make grieve and blind whosoever would efface [this inscription]'

Compare to the G-stem in C 25: *wlh ʿl-h* 'he grieved for him'.

C 4010:

h	*lt*	*r*{*w*}*ḥ*	*m- ḏ*	***b'ś*** *-h*
VOC	Lt	{relief}	from- REL.MS	afflict.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS

'O Lt, let there be relief from him that which has afflicted him'

Compare to the G-stem in *b'ś* (C 2544) 'he was afflicted'.

α. The D-stem sometimes overlaps with the C-stem: *'ʿwr* (C 763) = *ʿwr* 'to blind' (passim); *'śrq* (passim) 'migrate to the inner desert' = *śrq* (C 1875); and possibly *hb* (LP 460) 'give!' and *whb* (C 3757), if the latter is not an infinitive.

β. As discussed above, geminate roots may have been reanalyzed formally as D-stems, even though they retain the semantics of the G. By-forms exist with no appearant difference in meaning.

b. The existence of an L-stem in the Arabic dialects of this region is suggested by transcription of the personal name Μοσαλεμος /mosālem/. While indistinguishable orthographically, L-stems are posited mainly for the root *qtl* when it has a reciprocal sense. Note, however, that this function is not found in the relic forms of the L-stem in the NWS languages, and thus may be an Arabic innovation.

HCH 71:

snt	***qtl***	*ḥw*{*ṣ*}*t*	*w*	*b*{*y*}*g'*
year.CNST	fight.SC.3	{Hwṣt}	CONJ	{Byg'}

'the year {Hwṣt} and {Byg'} fought'

BWM 3:

snt	***qtl***	*ḥrb*	*w*	*'lmn*
year.CNST	fight.SC.3	ḥrb	CONJ	'lmn

'the year Ḥrb and ʾlmn fought'

5.6.1.2.1 Notes on weak roots

a. II-w/y

Suffix Conjugation: The behavior of stems of this root class is unexceptional, but there is some evidence for the confusion of the etymological value of the medial glide. The verb *ʿyd* 'to bring back' (KRS 1706) ultimately derives from the root √ʿwd, and therefore must reflect the leveling of the *y*, perhaps from the suffix conjugation, across the paradigm.

Imperative: Prayers to Bʿlsmn often request from him 'send the winds (with rain) or to give ease' *rwḥ* (passim). In rare cases, II-w roots are confused with II-y ones, thus *ʿyr* 'blind' (KRS 1695) and *ryḥ* (KRS 78). These instances likely reflect the development described above.

b. III-w/y

Some roots of this class have been reanalyzed as $C^2 = C^3$ in the suffix and prefix conjugation, sometimes with no change in meaning. One form, however, is usually dominant. Relics of this situation make their way into the medieval Arabic dictionaries, where the lexicographers record, for example, both *rabbā-hu* and *rabbaba-hū* for 'to bring up, rear' (*Lane*, 1002b). This is by no means a universal phenomenon in Safaitic, and there are clear attestations of D-stems which retain the final *y*, *sbyt-h ṭy'* 'the (tribe) Ṭy' took him captive' (CSNS 1004), *sbyt-h* should be vocalized as /sabbayat-oh/, and *ʿly ʾnfs l-frs' grm'l* 'he erected the funerary monuments for the horsemen of Grm'l', where *ʿly* must be /ʿallaya/. The following examples of the overlap between III-y/w and II=III are attested:

III-w/y	$C^2 = C^3$
ġzy (KhBG 11)	*ġzz* (passim) 'he raided'
bny (passim)	*bnn h- str* (AbaNS 78) 'he built the shelter'
mrby (KRS 167) 'foster child'	*yrbb* (C 1186) 'he brings up'
gly (AbaNS 881) 'to be cut off'	*ygll* (KRS 213) 'to erase'
**ḫly* 'to keep watch'	*ḫll* (RWQ 281) 'to keep watch'

Imperative: The FS is clearly attested once as *dn* */dannī/ 'render contemptible' (KWQ 119).

Infinitive and Abstract Nouns: An abstract noun is attested once with *t*-prefix and suffix: *tfyt* */tawfeyat/ 'fulfillment' (C 1744) < √wfy.

c. $C^2 = C^3$

Imperative: Only one clear example of the imperative is attested as *ḥy* 'grant life!' (LP 335), which suggests the vocalization /ḥayyī/. While this root is not originally a $C^2 = C^3$ root, progressive assimilation in this environment would have caused it to merge with this root class.

5.6.2 ʾCCC

a. The C-stem has two functions. It is primarily used to derive causatives from intransitive roots. There is, therefore, some overlap with the D; indeed, some roots form their causatives with both, without any apparent difference in meaning. The second function indicates direction of travel or movement. These verbs are usually denominative, but their meaning has sometimes developed independently of the semantics of the root. For example, the verb *ʾśrq* 'to migrate to the inner desert' derives originally from the root *śrq* meaning 'east' (Macdonald 1992a: 4-5).

Suffix Conjugation: The suffix conjugation is characterized by a glottal stop prefixed to the verbal root; there is no evidence for sibilant reflex of the causative morpheme, but a single lexicalized *h*- reflex has been attested (see §5.6.5). The exact vocalization of this stem is unclear. If the elative were vocalized identically to the suffix conjugation of the C-stem, then Greek transcriptions indicate the vocalization ʾaCCaC, e.g., Ασλαμος /ʾaslam/.

Prefix Conjugation: The causative morpheme is elided in the prefix conjugation. Greek transcriptions of personal names based on the C-stem suggest that the preformative vowel was realized as /o/ < **u*, Θοκιμη /toqīm/ < **tuqīmu* 'she established' < √*qwm*. This stem was therefore likely vocalized as /yoCCeC/.

Infinitive: The infinitive is attested only once for a III-w/y root, *ʾʿly* 'to raise up', where it is spelled identically to the suffix conjugation. Nothing contradicts the expected vocalization */ʾeCCāC/.

Imperative: No imperatives of strong roots have been attested, although a single attestation of the C-imperative of √ġny as *ʾġn* (SW 264) suggests the pattern ʾaCCv(C).

Participles: The glottal stop is elided in the participle as well. Greek transcriptions attest several names derived from the participle, which give the vocalization /moCCeC/, thus: Μολεμος /moḥlem/ = *mḥlm*, Μοσβεος /mosbeḥ/ = *msbḥ,* etc.

SC	PC	INF	IMP	APC	PP
ʾqtl	*yqtl*	*ʾqtl*	*ʾqtl*	*mqtl*	--

Figure 23: The principal parts of the C-stem

Causative:

WH 1696:

f	*śʿhqm*	*ʾʿly*	*l -hm*	*ʿn*	*m- bʾs*
CONJ	Śʿhqm	raise.INF	PREP-CPRO.3PL	help	PREP-misfortune

'so Śʿhqm bring up to them help against misfortune!'

ʾyʾs-h	*ḫyṭn*

WH 1022:

make sad.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	travelling

'travelling made him sad'

CEDS 183:

h	*lt*	*l*	*ʿṣt*	*ḏ*	***ʾḏyr***
VOC	Lt	ASV	cause hardship.SC.2FS	REL.MS	anger.SC.3MS

'O Lt, may you indeed cause hardship for him who has caused anger'

Direction:

C 325:

w	***ʾ{y}mn***
CONJ	{go south}.SC.3MS

'and he went south'

LP 180:

w	*trwḥ*	*l-* ***yśrq***	*l- mdbr*
CONJ	he set off at night.SC.3MS	PREP-migrate.PC.3MS	PREP-inner desert

'and he set off at night in order to migrate to the inner desert, towards the inner desert'

C 1649:

ʾsfr	*tdmr*
travel.SC.3MS	Tdmr

'he set off for Palmyra'

5.6.2.1 Notes on weak roots

a. I-y/w

Suffix Conjugation: The initial glide of two I-y C-stem verbs is expressed orthographically, *ʾy's* */'ay'asa/ and *ʾ{y}mn* */'aymana/. This is unexpected given the fact that word-internal diphthongs are not usually represented graphically, but rare examples of their notation do exist, e.g. *qyṣr* (MISSD 1) = CAESAR. All examples of I-w C-stems, however, leave the initial consonant unrepresented: *ʾḥd* */'awḥada/ 'he was left alone' (AAUI 281); *ʾgʿ* */'awgaʿ/ 'he caused pain' (KRS 3074). One possible explanation of the spellings *ʾy's* and *ʾymn* is that they reflect the so-called cD stem, that is, the causative prefix applied to the D-stem, forming a portmanteau ʾaCaCCaC. Thus, *ʾy's* would not reflect /'ay'asa/ but rather /'aya''asa/. This form is known in Gz, where it would reflect a parallel development. While positing

such a form would certainly rid us of the orthographic problem created by I-y verbs, it does not explain why I-w roots would not form causatives according to this pattern. Thus, it is most economical to assume that these two cases represent the ad-hoc choices of their writers to treat the coda of the diphthong as a consonant.

b. II-y/w

Suffix Conjugation: The medial glide of this root class is sometimes preserved - *ʾʿwr* 'to efface' /ʾaʿwara/ (C 793); *ʾḏyr* 'to anger' /ʾaḏyara/ (CEDS 183) and other times elided, *ʾʿḏ* (AWS 380) /ʾaʿāḏa/ 'place under protection'. A similar situation is found in CAr, where both *ʾaʿāra* and *ʾaʿwara* are known (*Lane*, 2194a), although they have different meanings. The interpretation of this phenomenon is not straight forward. The forms preserving the medial glides could reflect an innovation analogous to strong verbs. In light of the I-y forms discussed above, it is even possible to take *ʾʿwr* and *ʾḏyr* as CD stems, thus */ʾaʿawwara/ and */ʾaḏayyara/, respectively.

Prefix Conjugation: This part is only known in the prefix conjugation from the root, √ʿwr, attested as *yʿr* 'to efface' */yoʿīr/ (KRS 2569) eight times so far.

Infinitive and Abstract Nouns: The infinitive is attested once in *ʾqwy* 'to grant endurance' (SIJ 1008) <√qwy, perhaps */ʾeqwāy/. A verbal noun without the representation of the medial radical is also attested, *ʾḫl* 'uncertainty' (C 1186) < √ḫyl; its vocalization is unclear, but may reflect again variation between forms preserving the medial glide and those which collapse it to a long vowel.

Participle: The active participle is attested only once, in the poetic text KRS 2453. The word *mykn* may reflect the C-passive of the root √kwn, meaning 'to be established'. The initial *y* must be explained as a reflex of the causative morpheme, here in a dialect which has lost the glottal stop following vowels, thus /moyakān/ < **muʾakānu*. Since none of the other forms reflect the preservation of a reflex of the glottal stop, this must be considered an archaism, perhaps restricted to the poetic register or maybe an example of a rare dialectal form. The C-active participle is common in personal names, and Greek transcriptions confirm the vocalization */moCīC/, e.g. *mġṯ* C 2947, Gr. Μοιθος.

c. III-y/w

Suffix Conjugation: The final radical is maintained: *ʾṣly* */ʾaṣlaya/ 'he made a burnt offering' (SIJ 293).

Infinitive: The spelling of the infinitive does not contradict the pattern *ʾifʿālun* - *ʾʿly* 'to raise' */ʾeʿlāy/ (KRS 2420) and *ʾqwy* 'to grant endurance' */ʾeqwāy/ (SIJ 1008) <√qwy, but other vocalizations are naturally possible.

Imperative: The final glide disappears in the imperative, *ʾġn* 'to render free of want' (SW 264), which can reflect a short form /ʾaġni/ < √ġny, as in CAr, or a long form */ʾaġnī/, as is the case with III-w/y roots in vernacular Arabic today.

d. $C^2 = C^3$:

Suffix Conjugation: The same issues regarding C^2=C^3 stems in the G-stem hold for the C. We find examples of unclustered forms, *ʾḏll* /ʾaṣ̌lala/ 'he led astray' (KRS 303), *ʾḥbb* /ʾaḥbaba/ 'he loved' (MKWS 8), *ʾʿzz* */ʾaʿzazī/ 'make steadfast' (C 74), and clustered forms *ʾṭn* 'he cut off' */ʾaṭanna/ (C 25), *ʾṣḫ* */ʾaṣaḫḫa/ 'he cried aloud in grief' (LP 409), and *ʾmd* /ʾamadda/ 'he sent reinforcements' (miss.d 1), but the latter are seemingly less common. One must remember, however, that C-stem verbs of this root class are rather rare in general, and so this distribution could simply be an accident of attestation rather than representative of any linguistic reality. Both forms are attested in Greek transcription – Αυδαδου /ʾawdad/ = *ʾdd* and Αθαμμος /ʾatamm/ = *ʾtm*.

Participle: Only one clear example of the C-stem participle is attested, the passive *mḥb* */moḥabb/ (CSNS 1021). Only clustered forms are discernable, as unclustered forms would appear identical to the D-stem.

5.6.3 tCCC and CtCC

a. Stems augmented by the derivational morpheme *t* can correspond to several different Proto-Semitic derivational patterns, the tG/Gt, tD, and tL. Unlike the CCC stems, however, these are not easily distinguished on a semantic or pragmatic level, due to the fact that the *t* morpheme can appear as an infix or prefix in other Semitic languages, the general overlap of the G and D in Safaitic and the G and Gt in Classical Arabic, which serves as the first point of comparison. The following section will discuss the various possible morphological interpretations of the *t*-stems. In an effort to stay neutral, I will label stems with a t-infix T1-stems and those with a t-prefix T2-stems. Most *t*-stem verbs are either reflexive or intransitive, and can overlap in meaning with the intransitive G-stem, e.g. compare *wḥd* 'to be alone' (WH 128) and *twḥd* 'idem.' (AWS 244).

5.6.3.1 T1: *the t-stem of the G, CtCC = CAr iftaʿala*

a. This stem is characterized by the infixing of the *t*-morpheme between C^1 and C^2.

Suffix Conjugation: The *t*-morpheme, when applied to the G-stem, can occur as either a prefix or an infix in the various Semitic languages. Both configurations are possibly attested in the Safaitic inscriptions, but it is the infixed form alone that can be securely associated with the T-stem of the G. A small number verbs have so far been securely attested in this pattern – *śtky* 'to complain' (C 31), equivalent to CAr *ištakā*, and *qttl* 'to battle' (KRS 1024), equivalent to the rare CAr form *iqtatala*, and *tdy* 'to call upon' (ARR 1), presumably from <**intadaya* √ndy, although this exact verb is not known in Classical Arabic.

	SC	PC	INF	IMP	APC	PP
t-infix	*qttl*	*yqttl* (?)	----	----	----	----
t-prefix	*tqtl*	*ytqtl*	*tqtl*	----	*mtqtl*	----

Figure 24: Principal parts of the T-stems

T1-stem

C 31:

w	***śtky***	*'l- lt*
CONJ	complain.SC.3MS	to-Lt

'and he complained to Lt'

KRS 1024:

snt	***qttl***	*hrdṣ*
year.CNST	wage war.SC.3MS	*hrdṣ*

'the year Herod waged war'

5.6.3.2 T2: *the t-stem of the G tCCC = EAr itfaʿala or taf(a)ʿela*

a. This stem is characterized by the prefixing of the *t*-morpheme.

Suffix Conjugation: The majority of CAr Gt stems, however, correspond in meaning with tCCC stems. While these have traditionally been taken as tD stems (cf. CAr *tafaʿʿala*), and this seems most likely to

be the case considering Safaitic's linguistic proximity to Classical Arabic, it is worth speculating on some some other options, mainly, that it is a prefixed *t*-derivational morpheme applied to the G-stem.

meaning	Safaitic	Classical Arabic
'to long for someone'	*tśwq*	*ištāqa*
'to move ahead'	*tdym*	*iddāma*
'to guard oneself'	*twqy*	*ittaqā*
'to have one's tongue restrained on account of grief'	*tʿql*	*iʿtaqala*

Figure 25: The correspondences between Safaitic tCCC and Classical Arabic *iftaʿala*

If the Safaitic forms are in fact to be interpreted as tG stems, then the *t* morpheme could reflect a */ta/-syllable, as in Gz *taqatla* < *taqatila, or a */it/-syllable, as in Aramaic and Egyptian Arabic, *eṯqṭel* and *itʾatal,* respectively. This possibility would produce two different interpretations of the verb *tẓr* and its by-form *tnẓr*. If these spellings reflect variation in the assimilation of the /n/ in the same form, then one could posit a vocalization /tanṭera/ = *tnẓr* and /taṭṭera/ = *tẓr*. The rare by-form *tśyq* (KRS 124) of the common verb *tśwq* 'to long for' could be used to support an /i/ vowel following C² in the T-stems, which would have motivated the shift of *w* > *y*, */taświqa/ > */taśyeqa/, just as in *myt.*

It is, however, equally possible to take *tẓr* and *tnẓr* as evidence for variation between a T-infix and -prefix – *tẓr* */ettaṭera/ < */intaṭera/ versus *tnẓr* */itnaṭera/ or */tan(a)ṭera/, respectively, but with a *i-class theme vowel. Support for this interpretation comes also from the shape of the prefix conjugation, *ytẓr*, which reflects a suffix conjugation form /etaṭṭVra/.

While the case for a tG stem in the Safaitic inscriptions can be made, one must also bear in mind the overlap between the G and D stems in general (see §5.6.1). A similar overlap could have also applied to the T-stems of the G and D, ultimately resulting in the equivalence between the Safaitic tD and the CAr Gt. Evidence for this overlap is found in the CAr lexicon, where one often finds Gt and tD stems with the same meaning, e.g. Safaitic *trwʿ* 'to fear' = CAr *irtāʿa* and *tarawwaʿa* 'ibid'. Considering all of these options, the vocalization of the tCCC stems which correspond to the CAr Gt and their formal association with one of the Proto-Semitic derivational stems cannot be established with much certainty, although I favor regarding *tnẓr* as a tD-stem and *tẓr* as a Gt.

α. The inscription BES15 857 records the form *ʾtgnn* meaning 'to be driven mad (by grief).' The initial glottal stop suggests that the prefixed *t*-morpheme in this author's dialect was simply a *t* rather than *ta*, which then took a prothetic *ʾV-* to avoid a word-initial consonant cluster, cf. Aramaic *eṯqṭel.*

Prefix Conjugation: The prefix conjugation of *tẓr* is attested as *ytẓr* 'he lies in wait' (WH 3929), which, if taken as a tG, can only be vocalized as */yVtaṭṭer/ < **yatanẓiru*. The Gt would produce */yVttaṭer/. SG 5 attests *yt'gr* 'to be compensated', which may be a tG, although its semantics make a tD interpretation more likely.

Infinitive and Abstract Nouns: The infinitive or abstract noun of the T-stem of the root √nẓr is attested once as *tnẓr* (Mu 412). Its vocalization depends one whether one considers it a tD or tG stem.

Participles: Two forms which can be interpreted as participles of the T-stem are attested. The first is *mtḏkr* (KRS 1432), possibly the equivalent of CAr *taḏakkara* 'to become reminded of a thing'. The verbal counterpart is possibly attested once in an incomplete or damaged inscription, *tḏkr* (Mu 537). The other example is *mtqtl* (JaS 145.1); however, the inscription is not interpretable and so its exact meaning is unclear.

5.6.3.2.1 Notes on weak roots

a. I-w/y

Suffix Conjugation: Two examples of I-w/y roots are attested: *t's* 'he despaired' (LP 679) < √y's and *tqḏ* 'he was beaten (metaphorically, despaired)' (KRS 1161) < √wqḏ. Depending on which view of the t-stem one takes, these could reflect the prefixed form with syncope of the pre-penultimate vowel, */tay'esa/ and */tawqeḏa/ or, as in CAr, the infixed *ta* with the assimilation of C^1 to the morpheme, */Vtta'esa/ and /Vttaqeḏa/.

b. II-w/y

Suffix Conjugation: The commonest *t*-stem verb is II-w, *tśwq* (passim), discussed above, and the by-form *tśyq*. No examples of the collapse of the medial vowel are attested.

c. III-w/y

Suffix Conjugation: The single attested form of this root class, *twqy* 'to guard oneself' (C 2209), is more easily explained as a Dt-stem as we would otherwise have to again posit the irregular representation of the diphthong. The verb *nts* (AUnp 2) likely reflects a Gt-stem of √*nsy* 'to forget', /VntasVya/ 'to be forgotten,' with the rare collapse of the final triphthong. Likewise ARR 1 attests *tdy*, which is probably /VttadVya/ 'to call upon', from √ndw.

d. $C^2 = C^3$

Infinitive: C 860 attests a form {*t*}{*r*}*d*. If the reading is correct, then this may a nominal form of the tG of the root √*rdd* 'to return', perhaps */taradd/ 'recompense'.

5.6.3.3 T2: *the t-stem of the D, tCCC = CAr tafaʿʿala*

a. The T2-stem verbs discussed here have cognates in CAr belonging to the tD-stem.

Suffix Conjugation: Several tCCC stems correspond in meaning to CAr D-stems and therefore likely reflect the tD stem in Safaitic as well – *tḫwf* */taḫawwafa/ (KhBG 345) 'to be diminished by the lack of rain' = CAr *taḫawwafa*, *tśry* */taśarraya/ (RWQ 317) 'to be dispersed, scattered' = CAr *tašarrā*, and possibly *trwʿ* */tarawwaʿa/ (KRS 25) 'to be afraid' = CAr *tarawwaʿa.*

Prefix Conjugation: The verb *yt'gr* 'to be compensated' (SG 5) probably reflects an example of the tD prefix conjugation, perhaps /yata'aggar/.

Infinitive and Abstract Nouns: The infinitive or abstract noun of this stem is perhaps attested once in AAUI 271 *ṣyr m-t'fl* 'he returned to permanent water from taking cover/hiding', where *t'fl* must be construed as an infinitive of the verb *t'fl* (C 2315).

5.6.3.3.1 Notes on weak roots

a. I-w/y

Suffix Conjugation: The verb *twḫy* (AWS 48) should be connected with CAr *ta'aḫḫā*, but with a passive meaning the current context, 'to be considered a brother'. The ad-hoc change of root initial ʾ to *w* may therefore have been influenced by the vocalization /to'oḫḫVya/ > */towoḫḫVya/. The same verb is spelled with a glottal stop in LP 1211, *t'ḫ{y}*, but the meaning of this entire inscription is unclear. Otherwise, verbs of this class do not exhibit abnormal behavior, e.g. *twḥd* /tawaḥḥada/ 'to be alone' (AWS 244).

5.6.4 nCC(C)

a. The N-stem is formed by a prefixed *n-* to the verbal root, CAr *infaʿala*, Hb *niqtal,* Akk *naprus*, and signifies the medio-passive or reflexive of the G-stem.

SC	PC	INF	IMP	APC	PPC
nqtl	*yqtl*	*nqtl*(*t*)	----	----	----

Figure 26: The principal parts of the N-stem

C 2276:

nqʿṣ	*l-mn*	*ḏ*	*ḫbl*	*h-sfr*
die suddenly.INF	to whoever	REL.MS	obscure.SC.3MS	ART- writing

'may he who would obscure this writing die suddenly'

HCH 132:

ndm	*ʿl- bn*	*ʾḫ -h*	*msby*
be devastated.SC.3MS	PREP-son.CNST	brother –C.PRO.3MS	captured.PPC.MS

'he was devastated by grief on account of his nephew who was captured'

LP 475:

nġḍb	*mn-bn -h*
be angry.SC.3MS	PREP- son -CPRO.3MS

'he was angered by his son'

Suffix Conjugation: The suffix conjugation is characterized by a prefixed *n-* to the verbal root. The fact that there are no by-forms exhibiting the assimilation of the *n* suggests that it was followed by a vowel, which, based on the comparative evidence, was most likely /a/. Thus, we can reconstruct the following vocalization, *naCCaC - *nġḍb* /naġṣaba/ (LP 475).

Prefix Conjugation: The only possible example of this part in strong roots is found in AWS 264, *yqtl* perhaps */yVqqatel/ 'to be killed'. Since the N-morpheme assimilates to C^1 of the root, it is impossible to distinguish N-stems from internal passives unless other principal parts are attested.

Infinitive: The spelling of the infinitive *nqʿṣ* (C 2276) does not seem to reflect CAr *ʾinfiʿālun*, as one would expect the assimilation of the *n* in a pretonic environment. Instead, one may consider *nVCCāC = /nVqʿāṣ/.

5.6.4.1 Notes on weak roots

a. I-w/y

Suffix Conjugation: The common verb of mourning *ngʿ* 'to grieve in pain' (passim) probably reflects the N-stem of the root √wgʿ, to be vocalized as /nawgaʿa/. The G-stem of the verb, which is either intransitive or an internal passive, is attested in the same context, *wgʿ ʿl-mġny* 'he was devastated by grief on account of Mġny' (LP 314).

b. II-w/y

Suffix conjugation: One example is attested in the verb *nśl* 'to be removed' (KRS 2460) < √śyl, where the medial glide is not represented, and should perhaps be vocalized as */naśāla/ = LAr *inšāl* 'idem.'.

Prefix Conjugation: A single volitive example is attested, *l-yqʾ*, the verb of the commonly attested infinitive *nqʾt* 'to be thrown out (of a grave)', from √qyʾ. This form likely reflects the short prefix conjugation, and so should be vocalized as /yVqqaʾ/ < *yVnqaʾ.

Infinitive: The term *nqʾt* (passim) 'to be thrown out (of a grave)' reflects the n-infinitive of the root √qyʾ, and could perhaps to be vocalized as /naqāʾat/. With only two examples of N-stem infinitives, it is impossible to say if the *t* ending was characteristic of the infinitive of weak roots.

c. $C^2 = C^3$
Suffix Conjugation: Only clustered examples of the suffix conjugation of this stem are attested:
ndm /nadamma/ 'to be devastated (by grief)' (passim) < √dmm; *nḍb* */naṣabba/ 'to be hidden' (LP 1265), < √ḍbb, and *ngn* */naganna/ 'to go mad' (MAHB 2) <√gnn.

5.6.5 Rare stems

a. The following stems are exceedingly rare in Safaitic, either being restricted to a single verb or appearing once each in the corpus.

stCC(C)

The St-stem – corresponding to CAr *istafʿala* – is only attested once, *w-ʾstʿḏ ḥrt* 'and he sought protection in the Ḥarrah' (MZKHJ 2). The verb derives from the root √ʿwḏ 'to protect'. Its semantics correspond to CAr where it signals the act of 'seeking' or 'requesting,' that is, a causative-reflexive.

h-stem

The ʾ-causative morpheme ultimately derives the Proto-Semitic morpheme **sa* through an intermediate stage of /h/. A single verb, *hrq* 'to sacrifice' < *'to pour out' (AAUI 119) < √rwq, preserves an *h-* reflex, perhaps reflecting an ancient loan. Incidentally, the same root yields an *h-* causative in CAr as well, *harāqa* 'to pour out'.

R-stem

Reduplication is encountered consistently in the infinitive or verbal noun *qbll* 'to be reunited/reunion' (passim). Its exact vocalization is unclear, but it would seem to correspond in form with CAr *iqballa*, *iqbilāl* 'to be cross-eyed', although context suggests it means 'reunion' or 'to be reunited (with loved ones)'. The prefix conjugation is attested once as a clustered form, *yqbl* (SG 5). While the semantic range of the CAr stem is restricted to colors and defects, relics in Hebrew, e.g. *šaʾanan* 'to be at ease', indicate that its range was wider in former times. Another verb that possibly belongs to this category is *ḥwwt* 'to become dark' = CAr *iḥwawā* < *iḥwawaya*. The present form appears to have contracted the final triphthong, thus *iḥwawayat > *iḥwawāt > /eḥwawat/.

5.6.6 Internal passives

a. In several cases, context requires a passive reading of the finite verb. It may be the case that some of the cases identified below reflect impersonal constructions with an active verb (as possibly in HaNS 660 below - *they crucified his loved one*, i.e. *his loved was crucified*). In some cases, it is possible to take the alleged passive verb as an infinitive, e.g. KRS 1161 below can be understood as both 'the year Mn't was killed' or 'the year of the killing of Mn't'. Nevertheless, there are clear cases where a passive reading is the only option.

MISS.D 1

bḫs	*'l*	*'shm*	*f-ḥrb-**hm***	*'l*	*mlk*
defeated.SC.3MS	lineage.CNST	'sḥm	CONJ-war.SC.3MS-CPRO.3MP	lineage.CNST	*Mlk*

'the lineage of 'shm was defeated because the lineage of Mlk waged war against them'

HaNS 660:

w	***ṣlb***	*ḥbb-h*
CONJ	be crucified.SC.3M	loved one-CPRO.3MS

'and his loved one was crucified'

LP 183:

wgd	*ṣfr*	*mʿr*	*ḏ*	***ʿwq***
find.SC.3MS	writing	Mʿr	REL	be imprisoned.SC.3MS

dʿhe found the writing of Mʿr who was imprisoned'

KRS 1161:

snt	***qtl***	*mn't*
year.CNST	(be) kill(ed).SC.3M	Mn't

'the year Mn't was killed'

6 Adjectives and agreement

6.1 General remarks on adjectives

a. Both attributive and predicative adjectives are rare in the inscriptions and so our knowledge of their concord properties is incomplete. Adjectives seem to exhibit regular agreement with their heads in gender. Number agreement is more difficult to assess. Evidence from attributive participles indicates that the dual was an agreement category and that adjectives agreed in number with plural human heads. Non-human plurals and collectives appear to trigger singular agreement.

C 2031:

w	*nqʾt*	*b-* ***nfs***	***wdd***	*ḏ*	*yʿwr*
CONJ	thrown out.INF	PREP-person	loved.M	REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS
h- sfr					
ART- writing					

'and may he who would efface this writing be thrown out of his grave by a loved one'

H 191:

w	*tśwq*	*l- kll*	*ʿśr*	***ṣdq***
CONJ	long.SC.3MS	for-QUANT	kinsman	righteous.M

'and he longed for every righteous kinsman'

KRS 6:

mny	***śdd***
fate	harsh.MS

'a harsh fate'

AWS 360:

b-bʾs	*ḫbṯ*
PREP-affliction	horrible

'in horrible affliction'

b. Definiteness: The definite article is a concord feature with attributive adjectives but not attributive participles or adjectives. This may suggest that the participial constructions should instead be interpreted as unmarked adnominal phrases. For more examples of the latter, see §17.b.

Attributive adjectives

LP 146:

f	*h*	*lt*	*w*	*bʿlsmn*	*śyʿ*	***h- gś***	***h- rdf***
So	VOC	lt	CONJ	Bʿlsˈmn	follow.IMP	ART-guard	ART-rear.M

'So, O Lt and Bʿlsˈmn, follow the rear guard!'

QZMJ 476:

ṣyr	*m-mdbr*	*ʿm*	*ḫbṯ*
Return to water.SC.3MS	PREP-inner desert	year	bad.MS

'he returned to water from the inner desert during a bad year'

RWQ 325 :

ʾkl	*lḥm*	*smn*
eat.SC.3MS	Meat	fatty.MS

'he ate fatty meat'

Attributive participles

LP 317:

h-nqt	***qṣyt***	*l- nh{y}*
ART-she camel	dedicated .PPC.FS	PREP-{Nhy}

'the she-camel which is dedicated to Nhy'

C 1658:

h- gmln	***qṣyn***	*l- ʾlt*
ART-camel.D	dedicated.PPC.MD	PREP- ʾlt

'the two camels which are dedicated to ʾlt'

C 2285:

wgm	*ʿl- ksṭ*	***rġm***	*mny*
mourn.SC.3MS	for- Ksˈṭ	struck down.PPC.MS	Fate

'he mourned for Ksˈṭ who was struck down by Fate'

C 304:

ḥḏnt	*ḥbbt-h*	***rġmt***	*mny*
Ḥḏnt	loved one.FS -CPRO-3MS	struck down.PPC.FS	Fate

'Ḥḏnt, his beloved, who was struck down by Fate'

C 4988:

ʾśyʿ-h	***rġmn***	*mny*
companion.PL -3MS	struck down.PPC.MP	Fate

'his companions who were struck down by Fate'

6.2 Elatives and CVCCān adjectives

a. Only two examples of the elative have come forth. The vocalization of the masculine elative as *ʾaCCaC is clear from the copious amounts of personal names based on this pattern in Greek transcription. The masculine singular *ʾqṣ* 'furthest' derives from the root √qṣw. With only one example of a III-w/y root, it is impossible to make much of the non-notation of the final diphthong. The fact that it occupies the first slot of a genitive-construct chain may have caused the author to interpret it as a word-internal rather than word-final diphthong, and therefore not to represent it graphically. An elative of the root √ḥbb is also attested in a clustered form, *ʾḥb*, suggesting the vocalization */ʾaḥabb/.

AWS 48:

tśwq	*ʾl-*	*h-* ***ʾḥb***
long.SC.3MS	for-	ART- most beloved

'he longed for the most beloved'

C 4332:

mṯy	*snt*	*brḥ*	***ʾqṣ***	*h- mdnt*
journey.SC.3MS	year.CNST	depart.SC.3MS	furthest.CNST	ART- province

'he journeyed the year he departed to the furthest end of the province'

b. The word *hnʾn* in C 1239.1 should be understood as an adjective formed by the *n*-derivational suffix, likely forming the pattern pattern CVCCān, cf. LAr *kabrān* 'grown up', *fahmān* 'understanding.'

C 1239.1:

rʿy	*bql*	***ḥnʾn***
pastured.SC.3MS	fresh herbage	pleased.MS

'he pastured on fresh herbage, pleased'

6.3 Verbal agreement

a. non-human: As in many other varieties of Arabic, non-human plurals are usually treated as feminine singular, but in one case, the collective term *ḫl* 'horses' takes feminine plural agreement with its verb.

QZMJ 128:

ṭrdn	*h-ḫl*
year.CNST	announce.SC.3MS

'the horses were driven together'

CSNS 1:

ẓllt	*ḍʾn -h*	*ḥbst*	*ʾl*	*sl*
stay.SC.3FS	sheep -SC.3MS	enclosure.CNST	lineage.CNST	Sl

'his sheep remained in the enclosure of the lineage of Sl'

WH 1900:

ʿqdt	*m-rḥbt*	*h- ʾġnm*
restrain.SC.3FS	from-Rḥbt	ART- goat.PL

'the goats were prevented from (entering) Rḥbt'

There are cases, however, in which a non-human plural takes masculine concord.

UIO 117:

myt	*ʾʿnz-h*	*b-h-ẓrt*
died.SC.3M	she-goat.PL -CPRO.3MS	in- ART- enclosure

'his she-goats died inside this enclosure'

b. Groups of humans: Humans are treated as masculine and plural with adjectival agreement (e.g. C 4988) and pronominal resumption (e.g. §4.14.2). Social groups, on the other hand, can take both masculine (number unclear) and feminine singular agreement with verbs. It is unclear if these differences reflect dialectal variation or if this was a point of free variation.

Feminine singular agreement

WH 2815:

mrdt	*nbṭ*	*ʿl-ʾl*	*{r}m*
rebel.SC.3FS	Nbṭ	PREP-people.CNST	{Rm}

'The Nabataeans rebelled against the people of Rome'

SIJ 59:

ḥrbt	*ʾl*	*ʿwḏ*	*ʾl*	*ṣbḥ*
war.SC.3FS	people.CNST	ʿwḏ	lineage.CNST	Ṣbḥ

'the people of ʿwḏ waged war against the lineage of Ṣbḥ'

CSNS 1004:

sbyt-h	*ṯy'*
capture.SC.3FS -CPRO.3MS	Ṯy'

'Ṯy' (tribe) captured him'

Masculine agreement

HCH 126:

qtl-h	*ʾl*	*ḥwlt*
kill.SC.3M -CPRO.3MS	people.CNST	Ḥwlt

'the people of Ḥwlt killed him'

SIJ 78:

ʾty	*h- mḏy*	*bṣry*
come.SC.3M	ART- Persians	Boṣrā

‘the Persians came to Boṣrā’

BTH 228:

***ṭrd**-h*	*nbṭ*	*m- ʿnzt*
drive.SC.3M -CPRO.3MS	Nbṭ	from- ʿnzt

‘the Nabataeans drove him away from ʿnzt’

α. If Βαναα in line 5 of A 1 is a single individual, it may reflect masculine plural agreement with a dual human antecedent.

6.4 Pronominal agreement

a. Pronouns agree with their antecedent in gender and number. Groups of people are always referred to with plural pronouns, even if these sometimes license feminine singular agreement in the verb.

NST 3

bḫs	*ʾl*	*ʾshm*	*f-ḥrb-**hm***	*ʾl*	*mlk*
defeat.SC.3MS	lineage.CNST	ʾsḥm	CONJ-war.SC.3MS-CPRO.3MP	lineage.CNST	*Mlk*

‘the lineage of ʾshm was defeated because the lineage of Malik waged war against them’

NST 3

ʾl	*ṣbḥ*	*snt*	*ḥrb-**hm***	*ʾl*	*ʿwḏ*
lineage.CNST	Ṣbḥ	year.CNST	plunder.SC.3M –CPRO.3MP	lineage.CNST	ʿwḏ

‘…the lineage of Ṣbḥ, the year the lineage of ʿwḏ plundered them’

b. Collective non-human nouns take singular pronominal agreement. If pronominal agreement follows adjectival agreement, then these were treated as FS.

ASWS 73:

ngʿ	*ʿl-*	*ḥbb*	*w*	*ʿl-*	*h- ʾbl*

grive in pain.SC.3MS	for-	loved one	CONJ	for-	ART- camels
*rʿy-**h***					
pasture.SC.3MS –CPRO.3FS					

‘and he grieved in pain for Ḥbb and for the camels which he had pastured’

α. The narrative component of C 4973 may provide another example of feminine singular agreement with a non-human plural/collective antecedent: *wld **h**- **m**ʿ**z**[**y**] {w} rʿy-**h** bql b-ḏkr* ‘he helped the goats to give birth and then pastured it/them on herbage when the sun was in Aries’. Although the common formula is *wld h-mʿzy*, which is why I have restored the *y* in C 4973, the author may have in this particular case been referring to a single female goat, in which case *-h* would have a singular antecedent.

β. There is some evidence that the dual is sometimes resumed with feminine singular pronouns. As seen in KRS 1683, the clitic pronoun *-k* seems to refer to two previously mentioned deities: *hy **lt** w h **śʿhqm** slm w ʿwḏ -**k*** ‘O Lt and O Śʿhqm, let there be security and your protection’. Another possible example is found in C 2552: *ḫrṣ **ʾḫw**-h sby-**h** ḥwlt* ‘and he kept watch for his two brothers whom the Ḥwlt-ites have captured’. The word *ʾḫw* is usually taken as a dual, but it is possible that it should be construed as a collective form, perhaps something like ‘brethren’. Finally, we have *h **lt** w **dśr ḏkrt*** (AAUI 406), where *ḏkrt* can either be a 2 or 3FS verb, in agreement with a dual antecedent.

7 Prepositions

a. Prepositions govern nouns, infinitives, and clitic pronouns, with the exception of the dative *l-*, which can govern modal forms of the prefix conjugation.

***ʾl-*:** This preposition frequently occurs as the complement of verbs derived from thethe root √śwq 'to long for', and once with the verb 'to petition' *śtky* (C 31), once with *ḥwb,* and possibly with *dʿy*, in HaNSB 307 *dʿy ʾl- [l]t* 'he called upon Lt'. Since only one *l* is written in the latter inscription, this may suggest the vocalization /ʾel/ rather than /ʾelay/ or /ʾelā/, similar to the form with pronominal suffixes in many contemporary dialects of Arabic, e.g. *il-ak* 'yours' lit. 'to you', and Hb *ʾēl.*

AKSJ 1.2.3:

tśwqt	***ʾl-** ʾlbʾ*
long.SC.3FS	PREP-*ʾlbʾ*

'she longed for ʾlb"

C 1539:

ḥ[l]	*h- bt*	*[t]śwq*	***ʾl-** lbḥ*
{camp}.SC.3MS	ART- tent	long.INF	PREP-Lbḥ

'he camped in the tent longing for Lbḥ'

CSNS 918

ḥwb	*ʾl-rḍw*
cry out.SC.3MS	PREP-Rḍw

'he cried out to Rḍw'

ʾl can also have the sense of 'as far as' or 'until':

C 1167:

rʿy	*mʿ -ḫl -h*	***ʾl-** ḥrn*
pasture.SC.3MS	PREP-maternal uncle -CPRO.3MS	as far as-Ḥrn

'he pastured with his maternal uncle as far as Ḥawrān'

l-: The preposition functions as a dative, 'to' or 'for'. It sometimes introduces the direct object of infinitives, indirect objects, and is used in possessive predication (see §12.2). With verbs of motion, it more often marks the general direction of travel rather than the destination or goal, as the later function is a property of the unmarked noun (perhaps modified by an adverbial ending or accusative). The *h-* article is not elided following this preposition.

Indirect object

LP 504:

hb	***t***	*nʿm*
give.IMP.2FS	PREP-CPRO.3MS	divine favor

'bestow upon him divine favor'

Benefactive

LP 325:

dmy	***l-h***	*ʾb-h*
draw.SC.3MS	for-CPRO.3MS	father-CPRO.3MS

'his father drew for him'

WH 3925:

ḍbʾ	***l-nbṭ***
raid.SC.3MS	for- Nbṭ

'he went on a raid for the Nabataeans' or 'he went on a raid towards Nabataea'

Temporal

KRS 25:

ṣyr	*m- mdbr*	***l-ḫmst***	*ʾrḫ*
return.SC.3MS	from- inner desert	for-five.F.CNST	month.PL

'he returned to a place of permanent water from the inner desert for five months'

Directional

KRS 1670:

sry	***l-h-nḫl***	*bql*	*kbr*
travel by night.SC.3MS	towards- ART- valley	herbage	large.M

'he traveled by night towards the valley to tall herbage'

α. ***Lam Auctoris***: Nearly every Safaitic inscription begins with a *l-*, which has been termed the *lam auctoris*. Its function has been the subject of much debate, but there is a general consensus that it can

mark authorship or ownership. It frequently occurs in signature formula associated with rock art and on the names of the deceased associated with burials, i.e., *l-* PN *h-rgm* 'this funerary cairn belongs to PN'. See §1.1 for a discussion on this particle's function.

***b-*:** This preposition, vocalized as βι /bi/ in A 1, has two primary functions: locative and instrumental. When used as a locative, it is often best interpreted as 'near', 'by', or 'at' (similar to *ʿinda* in CAr). However, there are some rare cases where the translation 'in' is preferred, as it corresponds syntactically to the unmarked locative noun. The *b-* can also be used as comitative with both humans and animals, and is the regular way of expressing exchange. Unlike Hb, the *h-* article is not elided following this preposition.

Locative and Temporal

M 358:

ṣy{r}	***b-h-mśtyt***	*ʿl-h-nmrt*
return to water.SC.3MS	PREP-ART- winter pasture	PREP- ART-h-Nmrt

'he returned to water near the winter pasture bordering al-Namārah'

RSIS 339:

wrd	*h-bʾr*	***b-h-nmrt***
go to water.SC.3MS	PREP- well	PREP- ART- Nmrt

'he went to the well at/near Namārah'

KRS 1563:

tẓr	*ʾ- smy*	***b-*** *mlḥ*
await.SC.3MS	ART- sky	PREP-Aquarius

'he awaited the rains when the sun was in Aquarius'

Instrumental

HaNSB 304:

ḫzr	***b-*** *sf-h*
strike.SC.3MS	PREP-sword-CPRO.3MS

'he struck with his sword'

C 2830:

h	*bʿlsmn*	*rwḥ*	***b**-mṭr*
VOC	Bʿlsˡmn	send winds.IMP	PREP-rain

'O Bʿlsˡmn, send the winds with rain!'

Comitative

WH 325:

dṯ'	***b**-h-'bl*
later rains.SC.3MS	PREP-ART-camel.COL

'he spent the season of later rains with the camels'

In exchange for:

AbaNS 286:

śry	*m- 'ḫ -h*	*mʿḏ*	*h- frs*	***b**- m't*
buy.SC.3MS	PREP-brother-CPRO.3MS	Mʿḏ	ART-horse	PREP-hundred

'he bought from his brother Mʿḏ the horse with one hundred'

α. This preposition also seems to introduce the object of the verb *ġzz* 'to raid'.

C 4452:

ġzz	***b**-h-mʿzyn*
raid.SC.3MS	PREP-ART- shepherd

'he raided the shepherd'

HaNSB 349:

ġzz	***b**- 'bl*
raid.SC.3MS	by- camels

'he raided camels'

Compare to: C 1206 *ġzz h- nḫl* 'he raided in this valley'

bʿd-: While consonantally identical to CAr *baʿda* 'after', two separate meanings are attested, suggesting two different etymological sources – [1]*bʿd* from the root √bʿd 'to be far' and [2]*bʿd*, which is a compound of the prepositions *bi-* and *ʿad*, 'on behalf of,' or 'for the sake of,' although the latter is not attested independently in the Safaitic inscriptions.

[1]*bʿd*:

'śrq	*b-h-ḫl*	***bʿd**- h-nʿm*

WH 1700.1:

migrate.SC.3MS	PREP-ART- horses	PREP-ART-livestock

'he migrated to the inner desert with the horses following the livestock'

²bʿd

WH 599:

nẓr	***bʿd-h-msrt***
guard.SC.3MS	PREP- ART- troop

'he stood guard behalf of the troop'

SIT 52:

nẓr	***bʿd-*** *mʿzy-h*
guard.SC.3MS	PREP- sheep-CPRO.3MS

'he stood guard on account of his sheep'

KRS 1468:

qṣṣ	*b- mʾt*	*frs*	***bʿd-*** *ʾl*	*ḍf*
patrol.SC.3MS	with-unit	cavalry	PREP-lineage.CNST	Ḍf

'he patrolled with a cavalry unit on behalf of the lineage of Ḍf'

WH 374:

bhʾ	***bʿd-*** *ʾtm*	*ʾys*
rejoice.SC.3MS	PREP-restoration.CNST	ʾys

'he rejoiced on account of the restoration (to health) of ʾys'

bn-: This preposition is securely attested once with the meaning 'between', C 4037 ***bn yd-h*** 'between his hands'.

ʿl: This preposition is most commonly used to indicate the object of verbs of grief: *ndm*, *wlh*, *wgm*, *qṣf*, *ngʿ*, *wgʿ*, (see §24.1). It has the basic spatial sense of 'upon', 'on (the edge of)' or 'bordering'. In curse formulae, *ʿl* has the meaning 'against'. The preposition can also have a benefactive sense, especially when used in conjunction with the verb *ḫrṣ* and *nẓr*.

upon; on the edge of

KRS 756:

h	*śʿhqm*	*slm*	[***m***]	*ʿl- h- ʾbl*
VOC	Śʿhqm	secure.IMP.MS	REL	on- ART- camel.COL

'O Śʿhqm, keep safe what is upon the backs of the camels'

C 3230:

rʿy	{*h-*} *ʾbl*	*b-rʾy*	*mlḥ*
pasture.SC.3MS	{ART-} camel.COL	PREP-rising.CNST	Aquarius
ʿl-[*h-*]*nḫl*			
PREP-valley			

'he pastured the camels on the edge of [the] valley during the rising of Aquarius'

LP 330:

w	*qyẓ*	***ʿl- h- nmrt***
CONJ	spend dry season.SC.3MS	PREP-Namārah

'and he spent the dry season on the edge of Namārah'

against

HaNSB 307:

dʿy	*ʾl -*[*l*]*t*	***ʿl- mn***	*yḫbl*
call.SC.3MS	Upon -{lt}	PREP-anyone	obscure.PC.3MS

'he has called upon {Lt} against anyone who would obscure (the inscription)'

AKSD 5:

ṯqb	*yd-h*	*w*	*dśr*
pierce.SC.3MS	hand -CPRO.3MS	CONJ	Dśr
ʿl-ksr	*wqʿ-n*		
PREP-destroyer.CNST	inscription -CPRO.1CP		

'May he cut off his hand that Dśr be against the destroyer of our inscription'

benefactive

HaNSB 305:

w	*nẓr*	*ʿl-gś-h*
CONJ	guard.SC.3MS	PREP-CPRO.3MS

'and he guarded over his troop'

SIAM 35:

w	*ḫrṣ*	*ʿl- ʾśyʿ -h*
CONJ	watch.SC.3MS	PREP-companion.PL -CPRO.3MS

'and he looked after his companions'

Related to this sense, *ʿl-* could mean 'under the authority' in the following context:

RQ.A 10:

srt	*ʿl-mlk*	*h- slṭn*
to serve in a troop.SC.3MS	PREP-ruler.CNST	ART- governed area

'he served in a troop under the authority of the governor'

f: The locative preposition *f*, cf. CAr *fī*, is a less common alternative to the unmarked locative noun. Its source is likely the construct state of the word for mouth. In CAr, the preposition is frozen in the genitive case, *fī*; no evidence for the quality of its vowel is available in Safaitic. A parallel, yet ultimately unrelated, development is witnessed in the Hb preposition *ʿal-pî* 'according to' < *'according to the mouth of'. The plural of this preposition is attested as *ʾfwh* in NEJII 2Saf, where it appears to mean 'the foremost part (of an area).'

KRS 1617:

ḫyṭ	*sḫb*	*f-h-ḫmlt*	*f-ʾmrʿ*
journey.SC.3MS	swiftly	CONJ-PRES-plain	CONJ-find herbage.SC.3MS

' he journeyed swiftly in the plain and then found herbage'

KRS 3291:

rʿy	*h- ʾbl*	*f-h-nḫl*
pasture.SC.3MS	ART- camel.COL	PREP-ART-valley

'he pastured the camels in this valley'

Compare this with the normal idiom: C 2670 *rʿy h- ʾbl h- nḫl* 'he pastured the camels in this valley'

***m*ʿ**: Like *b-*, *m*ʿ has a comitative meaning, but it is used exclusively with persons:

LP 325:

w	*ḫrṣ*	*h- nw*	***m*ʿ- ʾḫ -*h***
CONJ	watch.APC.MS	ART- migrating group	PREP-brother -CPRO.3MS

'he kept watch for the migrating group with this brother'

C 320:

srt	***m*ʿ- ʾ*b -h***
serve in a troop.SC.3MS	PREP-father-CPRO.3MS

'he served in a troop with his father'

SESP.U 26:

w	*bny*	***m*ʿ- *ẓn'l***	*h- str*
CONJ	build.SC.3MS	with- Ẓn'l	ART- shelter

'and he built with Ẓn'l the shelter'

***m*(*n*)**: Two forms of this preposition exist: *m* and *mn*, sometimes in the same inscription. This variation probably reflects sporadic word boundary assimilation. However, the short form is attested simply as μι without the graphic notation of gemination of the following consonant in (A 1). The primary sense of *m*(*n*) is 'from' when referring to motion. In prayers for security, the preposition is best translated as 'against'. In other cases, it can be used to express reason and to express the partitive genitive.

from

C 654:

ṣyr	***m*-*mdbr***
return.SC.3MS	PREP-inner desert

'he returned to a place of permanent water from the inner desert'

ʾśrq	***m*-*ḥrn***	*b- ʾbl -h*	*śʿr*

HaNSB 218:

migrate.SC.3MS	PREP-Ḥrn	PREP-camel.COL -CPRO.3MS	herbage
b-rʾy	*yʾm{r}*		
PREP-rising.CNST	Capricorn		

'he set off from Ḥrn to the inner desert with his camels to herbage during the rising of {Capricorn}'

Against

C 31:

w	*slm*	***m***- *śnʾ*
CONJ	security	PREP-enemy.PL

'and let there be security against enemies'

CSNS 1004:

wgm	*ʿl- syd*	*mqtl*	*h*	*lt*	*ṯʾr*
mourn.SC.3MS	PREP- Syd	killed.PPC.MS	VOC	Lt	vengeance
mn- *qtl -h*					
PREP-kill.APC.MS -CPRO.3MS					

'he mourned for Syd who was killed; O Lt, he will have vengeance against his murderer'

reason

LP 475:

nġḍb	***mn***-*bn* {-*h*}
be angry.SC.3MS	PREP son-CPRO.3MS

'he was angered by reason of his son'

KhNSJ 1:

g{l}s	***mn***- *ʾ- dmt*
halt.SC.3MS	from-ART-downpour

‘he {halted} because of the downpour’

Partitive: The preposition *m*(*n*) can be used to express a part belonging to a larger mass:

C 3113:

w	*ṭʿmt*	***mn-*** *ṣd*	*l-frk*	*bn*	*ltnh*
CONJ	nourish.INF	PREP-game	PREP-Frk	son.CNST	Ltnh

‘and nourish FRk son of Ltnh with something of game’

Khunp 1

nqʾt	*b-wdd*	*ḏ*	*yḫbl*	***m****-h-sfr*
ejection.INF	PREP-beloved	REL	obscure.PC.3MS	PREP-ART-writing

1

‘may he who would efface any part of this writing be thrown out (of the grave) by a loved one’

***mʿl-*:** This is a compound of *m* and *ʿl*, cf. Hb *mē-ʿāl* ‘within’. It gives reason for the action of the verb.

KRS 1015:

h	*lt*	*{l}ʿn*	*m*	*ḫbl*	***mʿl-*** *ḥwq*
VOC	Lt	curse.IMP	REL	Obscure.SC.3MS	PREP-jealousy

‘O Lt, {curse} whosoever would obscure because of jealousy’

RWQ 310:

ngʿ	***mʿl-*** *Hnmr*
grieve in pain.SC.3MS	PREP-Hnmr

‘he grieved because of Hnmr’

mdn: This compound preposition, cognate with CAr *min dūni* ‘without’, is attested only once, in reference to the absence of Bʿl, singling the dry season and the absence of rains.

ASWS 37:

wgm	***mdn-***	*bʿl*	*f*	*h*	*rḏw*	*rwḥ*

grieve.SC.3MS	PREP-	Bʿl	CONJ	VOC	Rḍw	send the winds.IMP.MS

'he grieved in the absence of Bʿl so, O Rḍw, send the winds (with rain)'

***mnqbl*:** This preposition is attested only once; compare to CAr *min qubulin* 'from the front' and Syriac *menqᵉbol* 'opposite, against'.

AZNG 1:

mrd	*ṯlṯ*	*snn*	***mnqbl-***	*nfs*	*ẓlm*
rebellion	three.M	year.PL	PREP	Nepos	oppress.APC.MS

'Nepos, who was oppressive, faced a rebellion for three years' (lit. there was a rebellion for three years facing Nepos who was oppressive')

***ldn*:** This preposition is also attested only once. It is likely the combination of *l* and *yad* 'hand' with the old locative suffix *um*, which is realized in Arabic as *-un* (Grande 2017), cf. CAr *ladun*.

ThNTS 80:

w	*ʾtw*	***ldn-h***
CONJ	PREP-CPRO.3MS	ART- horse

'and he went near to him'

***ʿnd*:** This preposition expresses location and possession, cf. CAr *ʿinda*.

ISB 91:

w	*l-h*	*h-frs*	***ʿnd-*** *h*
CONJ	PREP-CPRO.3MS	ART- horse	PREP-CPRO.3MS

'and by him is the horse which belongs to him'

AAEK 173:

ʿrf	*sfr*	*ʾb-h*	***ʿnd-h-rgm***
recognize.SC.3MS	writing.CNST	father-CPRO.3MS	PREP-ART-cairn

'he recognized the writing of his father at the cairn'

k: Attested only thrice, all in the same inscription, the preposition introduces a nominalized preposition phrase, i.e., 'the like of'.

BRenv.H 1:

wgd	*ʾṯr*	*ʿm -h*	*ḥmyn*
find.SC.MS	trace.CNST	grandfather-CPRO.3MS	Ḥmyn
f	*ql*	*h*	*gdḍf*
CONJ	say.SC.3MS	VOC	Gdḍf
{*h*}*b*	{*l-*} {*-h*} [[]]	***k****-sʿd-h*	*w*
give.IMP.2MS	{to-} {-CPRO.3MS}	PREP- good fortune -CPRO.3MS	CONJ
k*-wld -h*	*w*	***k****-nʿm-h*	
PREP-offspring-CPRO.3MS	CONJ	PREP-livestock -CPRO.3MS	

'he found the trace of his grandfather Ḥmyn, then said: O Gdḍf, grant him the like of his good fortune, offspring, and livestock'

bʿdm: The preposition is a compound of *b-* and the noun *ʿdm* 'absence' similar to *mdn.*

C 3354:

qyẓ	*h-ṣbn*	*bʿdm-*	*ʾyb*	*nwy*
dry season.SC.3MS	TOP	PREP	return.INF	pastureland

'he spent the dry season at *h-ṣbn* without returning to pastureland'

8 Adverbs

a. Adverbs specify the location (in space and time), condition, and manner of their heads. Almost any noun can serve as an adverb, a function marked by the accusative. The adverbial use of most nouns must be inferred from its context (on the syntax of adverbs, see §14). The following are the few dedicated adverbs and adverbial constructions:

ʾḍ: 'again'

H 506:

snt	*ḥgz*	*bʿlsmn*	*ʿl-h*
year.CNST	withhold.SC.3MS	Bʿlsmn	PREP-CPRO.3MS
ʾḍ			
again			

'the year Bʿlsmn withheld [the rain] from it [the province] again'

ʿwd / ʿd: 'again'

RSIS 351:

w	*śty*	*ḥrt*	***ʿwd***
year.CNST	winter.SC.3MS	the Ḥarrah	again

'and spent the winter in the Ḥarrah again'

l-ʾbd : 'forever', 'always'

C 2446:

wlh	*k{b}{r}*	*sḥr*	*ʿl- ʾḫ -h*
grieve.SC.3MS	{continuously}	broken heart	PREP-brother- CPRO.3MS
ḥbb-h	***l-ʾbd***		
loved one-CPRO.3MS	forever		

'he grieved constantly with a broken-heart for his brother, his beloved, forever'

l-nfs-h: 'by/for himself'

LP 360:

rʿy	*h- mʿzy*	***l-nfs-h***
pasture.SC.3MS	ART-goat.PL	by himself

'he pastured the goats by/for himself'

ʾḫrt: 'thereafter'

KRS 896:

wgd	*sfr*	*ṣʿd*	*f*	*ngʿ*
find.SC.3MS	writing.CNST	Ṣʿd	CONJ	grieve-in-pain.SC.3MS
w	*wrd*	*h- nmrt*	*b- ʾmt*	***ʾḫrt***
CONJ	go-to-water.SC.3MS	h- nmrt	in- Libra	thereafter

'he found the writing of Ṣʿd and therefore grieved in pain, then he set off to water at Namārah during Libra thereafter'

α. The form *ʾbd* without the preposition is also attested (KRS 1015), and probably reflects a by-form in the accusative.

β. While *snt* 'year' is usually unmarked when used adverbially, this function is sometimes indicated by the preposition *b-*, e.g. C 2209 *f twqy b-snt ḥrb yẓr* 'so may he preserve himself during the year of the war of Yẓr'.

ʾwn: 'at the right time'

CSNS 758:

rʿy-h	***ʾwn***
pasture.SC.FMS	ART-goat.PL

'he pastured them at the right time'

ʿgl: 'hastily'

SG 5:

nqmt	*m-ḏ*	*ʾslf*	***ʿgl***
vengeance	PREP-REL	commit.SC.3MS	hastily

'[grant] retribution against the one who committed (this act) hastily'

bʿd: 'afterwards'

HCH 194:

ʾslm	*w-**bʿd***	*ʾflt*
surrender.SC.3MS	CONJ-afterwards	escape.SC.3MS

'he surrendered but afterwards escaped'

kbr: 'greatly'

C 2686:

ngʿ	***kbr***	*ʿl-ġyr*
grieve in pain.SC.3MS	greatly	PREP-Ġyr

'he grieved in pain greatly for Ġyr'

tly: 'consecutively'

ʾrbʿ	*snn*	***tly***
four	year.PL	consecutively

'four years consecutively'

8.1 Negative adverbs

lm: This forms a negative preterite construction with the short form of the prefix conjugation, and is cognate with the CAr construction *lam yafʿal*.

MSNS 2:

bġy	*ʾḫ -h*	*f*	***lm***	*yʿd*
seek.SC.3MS	brother -CPRO.3MS	but	NEG	return.PC.3MS

'he sought after his brother because he never returned'

WGGR 1:

w	***lm***	*tmṭr*	*h- skn{t}*
CONJ	NEG	rain.PC.3FS	ART- dwelling.{PL}

'and the dwellings were not rained upon'

ASAD 1:

rʿy	***sbʿt*** *ʾgm*	*ḫlf*

pasture.SC.3MS	Pleiades		type of herbage
ġnyt	*w-lm*	*ysʿd*	
abundance	CONJ-NEG	be fortunate.PC.3MS	

'he pastured during (the heliacal rising) of Pleiades on herbage following (the season of) abundance but suffered misfortune'

m: This negator, cognate with the interrogative *mā*, can precede both the prefix and the suffix conjugation.

Mu 253:

ngʿ	*f*	***m***	*hnʾ*
grieve in pain.SC.3MS	CONJ	NEG	be happy.SC.3MS

'he grieved in pain and was unhappy'

RWQ 155:

l	*rm*	*w*	*ṣʿt*	*w*	***m***	*nm*
LA	Rm	CONJ	unrest	CONJ	NEG	sleep

'By Rm and there was unrest, but he did not perish'

lʾn: /lā-ʾan/ is the antecedent form of CAr *lan,* which negates the explicit future. This particle is encountered only once in the inscriptions.

AWS 264:

w	***lʾn***	*yqtl*	*ḏ*	*yslm-h*
and	for-COMP	kill.SC.3MS	REL	secure.PC.3MS -CPRO.3MS

'and may he who keeps it (the inscription) safe never be killed'

l: */lā/ is attested only once in a negative precative construction.

HCH 132:

w-l	*yrhṭ*	*ġyrʾl*	*bn*	*ṣyd*
CONJ-NEG	league.SC.3MS	Ġyrʾl	son.CNST	Ṣyd

'and may Ġyrʾl son of Ṣyd league with no one'

8.2 Local adverbs

a. Local adverbs are also rare. Two forms are known, each only secure attested once.

hn: 'here', cf. CAr *hunā*; see β below on the vocalization.

APMS 1:

w-h-ym	*hn*	*ʾḫr*	*ḥll*
CONJ-NEG	league.SC.3MS	Ġyrʾl	son.CNST

'and let here this day be the last encampment'

α. Another possible attestation of *hn* is found in KRS 1379: *wgd* ***hn*** *ʿm -h*. This construction belongs to the inscription-finding formula and so we would expect *hn* to refer to a text, as it occupies the normal place of *ʾṯr* and *ṣfr*. A connection with CAr *hann* 'a thing' (Lane, 3045c) is possible, but if not then *hn* could also be taken as an adverb 'here' with the writing itself simply being implied. Other possible examples are attested in CEDS 268; ISB 117; KRS 3239.

β. In RWQ 335, the *h* following the verb could possibly reflect a locative adverb, *rʿy h ʾl ḥwlt* 'the people of Ḥwlt pastured here', with perhaps the assimilation of the *n* to the following consonant. This would imply that the adverb terminated in a consonant rather than a vowel, perhaps comparable with LAr *hawn* 'here'. It is also possible to interpret the *h* in such cases as a 3FS clitic pronoun with an implied referent, i.e. 'them' (the animals).

bḏ: 'here' or 'there'?: This is likely a reflex of CS *bi-ḏā* (cf. Dadanitic *bḏ*; Taymanitic *bz*, and Hb *bāzê*). It seems impossible to determine from its single attestation whether it means 'here' or 'there'.

KRS 303:

ʾḍll	***bḏ***	*gś*
lead astray.SC.3MS	here/there	troop

'he led a troop astray here/there'

9 Vocative particles

a. The inscriptions attest a variety of vocative particles used primarily in prayers to deities. Several of these can be combined into larger units. Some particles are only used in association with certain deities; the significance of this distribution is unclear.

h: This is by far the most common particle and is used with all deities. Based on the comparative evidence, its vocalization can only be */hā/.

KRS 1160:

h	*bʿlsmn*	*w*	***h***	*ḏśr*
VOC	Bʿlsmn	CONJ	VOC	Ḏśr

'O Bʿl[1]mn and O Ḏśr'

ʾ: This vocative particle is attested only once and appears to be a development from the *h*-vocative through the spread of the sound change *h* > ʾ that sometimes applies to the definite article as well.

RSIS 204:

ʾ	*bʿlsmn*	*rwḥ*	*b-mṭr*
VOC	Bʿlsmn	CONJ	VOC

'O Bʿlsmn, send the winds with rain'

hy: This is a compound vocative, combining the *h* and the *y* vocative, cf. CAr *yā*. It is attested with the following deities *lt*, *Lt*, *Lh* and with the generic *ʾʾlht* 'gods'. Its appearance with *ʾlt* and *ʾʾlht* precludes the interpretation of the *y* as a homo-organic glide in the following conditions, /hā-ilat/ or /hā-ilāh/.

C 25:

hy	*lt*	*w*	*h*	*śms*
VOC	Lt	CONJ	VOC	Śms

'O Lt and O Śms'

LP 243:

hy	*lh*	*ṯʾr*
VOC	Lh	vengeance

'O Lh, there shall be vengeance!'

KRS 1287:

hy	*ʾʾlht*
VOC	god.PL

'O gods'

ʾy: A variant of the *hy* vocative with the sound change *h* > ʾ. It can be compared to the first element of the CAr vocative, *ʾayyuhā*.

KRS 1562:

rwḥ	***ʾy***	*lt*
ease	VOC	Lt

'let there be ease, O Lt'

hyh: This vocative is cognate with CAr *ʾayyuhā*.

Mu 141:

hyh	*lt*
VOC	Lt

'O Lt'

LP 619:

hyh	***lt***
VOC	Lt

'O Lt'

10 Other particles

a. Several other particles associated with conditional clauses, presentation, and affirmation are attested. They are listed below, and will be discussed in more detail with their associated syntactic constructions in the chapters dealing with syntax.

b. Conditional Particles: Conditional clauses are rare and so our knowledge of their syntax and the various particles used in these constructions is extremely limited. So far, two conditional particles have been attested – each only once. It is impossible to determine whether these had a different semantic nuance or instead reflected dialectal or diachronic differences.

ʾn (KRS 213) This particle is cognate with CAr *ʾin*, which denotes a *real* condition. The single Safaitic example, however, occurs in a hypothetical context.

ʾm (AWS 237) The particle *ʾm* is cognate with Hb *ʾîm* 'if', Gz *ʾəmma*, and CAr *ʾimmā*.

c. Asseverative:

l The asseverative *l* serves to affirm the truth or certainty of a statement.

KRS 922:

f	*slm*	*h*	*lt*	*w*	*rwḥ*
CONJ	security	VOC	Lt	CONJ	ease
l- *wḥd*	*h*	*yṯ*ʿ			
ASV-be alone.SC.3MS	VOC	Yṯʿ			

'so let there be security, O Lt, and let there be ease, for he was indeed alone, O Yṯʿ'

C 1186:

w	*lt*	***l-*** *ʾḫl*		*w*	*wk{s}*
CONJ	Lt	ASV-uncertainty		CONJ	{loss}
w	*ḫrs*	*w*	*ʿrg*	*w*	*ʿwr*
CONJ	deafness	CONJ	lameness	CONJ	blindness
l- mn	*ḫbl*				
for- REL	obscure.SC.3MS				

'by Lt, let there indeed be uncertainty, loss, deafness, lameness, and blindness for whosoever would obscure'

SIJ 293:

ʾqsm	*b- ʾlh*	*ḥy*	***l-****hdy*	*ʿẓm*
swear.SC.3MS	by- *ʾlh*	alive.APC.MS	ASV-command.SC.3MS	greatness

'he swore by ʾlh, who is living, that he will command with greatness'

d. Presentative: The particle *ʾn*, CAr *ʾinna* Hb *hinnê*, is attested once in a damaged context; however, from the context and the photograph, the readings of the glyphs are relatively certain.

KRS 68:

{ʾ}{*n*}*k*	*bġy-h*	*w*	*qf{y}t –h*
{PRES}- CPRO.2MS	sought after-CPRO.3MS	CONJ	path-CPRO.3MS

'you are indeed the one he seeks and his path'

11 Conjunctions

11.1 Coordinating conjunctions

a. Two coordinating conjunctions are attested, *w* and *f*. Their usages are roughly equivalent to their CAr counterparts.

w: This conjunction has a variety of functions, but primarily serves to join equivalent elements, from words to entire sentences, equivalent to English 'and'. Additionally, *w* can indicate the result of a preceding action or condition 'because', 'as', the adversative 'but', and purpose 'so that'. These functions will be illustrated in (§17-19).

f: This particle mainly indicates a temporal or causal relationship between two elements, that is, X *f*- Y 'X so/then/therefore Y'.

C 2036:

wgd	*ḥbb-h*	*f*	*bky*
find.SC.3MS	loved one-CPRO.3MS	CONJ	weep.SC.3MS

'he found [the inscription of] his beloved and so he wept'

α. *f* can also connect individual words to express a sequence, as in the common expression *ʿm f ʿm*, 'year after year' (SIJ 119; WH 1193).

β. *f* can express intensity when the two words it connects are identical:

KRS 1087:

h	*gdʿwḏ*	*h{b}*	*ṯʾr*	*m- ʾl*	*gʿ*
VOC	Gdʿwḏ	{give}.IMP.2M	vengeance	PREP-lineage.CNST	Gʿ
ẓlmn	***f***	***ẓlmn***			
unjust.APC.MP	CONJ	unjust.APC.MP			

'O Gdʿwḏ, grant vengeance from the lineage of Gʿ who were terribly unjust'

b. *f* can optionally introduce a modal clause following a topicalized or vocative noun, similar to the use of *f*- in the Ancient South Arabian *zabūr* inscriptions (Stein 2008: 779).

AWS 237:

h	*rḍw*	*f*	*l*	*yʿwr*	*m*	*ʿwr*
VOC	Rḍw	CONJ	ASV	be blind.PC.3MS	REL	efface.SC.3MS

'O Rḍw, may he who would efface be made blind'

HCH 103:

h	*lt*	*w*	*dśr*	***f***	*t̲ʾr*	*mn-ḥwlt*
VOC	Lt	CONJ	Dśr	CONJ	vengeance.SC.3MS	from- Ḥwlt

'O Lt and Dśr, he will have vengeance against Ḥwlt'

c. In cases where the first clause of the narrative is introduced by *f*, e.g. *l*- PN *f* SC, the following verb has an optative sense. In some cases, this could imply that the inscription was composed on behalf of another person.

C 404:

l	*wdmʾl* [1]	*bn*	*w{l}ʿ*	*f*	*byt*	*w*	*n{g}r*
VOC	ʾs	son.CNST	Brʾh	CONJ	return.SC.3MS	CONJ	preserve.SC.3MS

'By Wdmʾl son of Wlʿ, and so may he camp the night and persevere'

C 3466:

l	*ḥl*	*b[n]*	*tlḥ*	*f*	*bt*
LA	Ḥl	son.CNST	Tlḥ	CONJ	camp.SC.3MS

'By Ḥl son of Tlḥ, so may he camp the night (safely)'

KhMNS 13:

l	*ʾs*	*bn*	*brʾh*	*f*	*ʿd*
LA	ʾs	son.CNST	Brʾh	CONJ	return.SC.3MS

'for/by ʾs son of Brʾh, and so may he return (safely)'

SIJ 975:

l	*ʿm*	*bn*	*mn*	*f*	*ʾtw*	*mn-ḥrt*
LA	ʿm	son.CNST	mn	CONJ	come.SC.3MS	PREP-the Ḥarrah

'for ʿm son of Mn, so may he return from the Ḥarrah'

11.2 Subordinating conjunctions

a. While the conjunctions *w* and *f* can express temporal and causal relationships usually expressed by subordinating conjunctions in CAr, a few dedicated subordinating conjunctions are attested. None of the following are attested with enough frequency to determine the details of their syntax.

ʾḏ: 'when' – This conjunction is probably cognate with CAr *ʾiḏā* / *ʾiḏ* 'when'.

AWS 8:

w	*ngʿ*	***ʾḏ***	*wgd*	*ʾṯr*
CONJ	devastated.SC.3MS	when	find.SC.3MS	trace.CNST
dd -h				
paternal uncle -CPRO.3MS				

'and he was devastated by grief when he found the trace of his paternal uncle'

ḥt: This conjunction signifies the limit of a series of events, 'until', cf. CAr *ḥattā*.

OAM1 1b:

rʿy	*h-ṣlf*	*ḥt*	*bql*
pasture.SC.3MS	ART-bare land	PREP	sprout.SC.3MS

'he pastured the bare land until vegetation sprouted'

ʿkd: Like *ḥt*, this conjunction expresses the last member of a sequence of events. While its etymology is unclear, it is likely cognate with the particle *ʿkdy* in the Namārah inscription (Al-Jallad 2021#).

AAd 1

wgm	*ʿl-ghm*	*w-ḏkr-h*	*f-bky*	*ʿkd-wny*
grieve.SC.3MS	PREP-Ghm	CONJ-remember.SC.3MS-CPRO.3MS	CONJ-weep.SC.3MS	PREP-grow weak.SC.3MS

'he grieved for Ghm and remembered him and then wept until he grew weak (from grief)'

11.3 The complementizer *ʾn*

a. The complementizer *ʾn*, CAr. *ʾan*(*na*), substantivizes sentential complements of verbs of cognition:

WH 1141:

w	*srt*	*smʿ*	***ʾn***	*ʿm -h* ----
CONJ	serve in a troop.SC.3MS	hear.APC.MS	COMP	grandfather-CPRO.3MS

‘and he served in a troop having heard that his grandfather…’

Ms 44:

rʿy	*h- ʾbl*	*h- ʿrḍ*	*snt*	*myt*
pasture.SC.3MS	ART-camel.COL	ART-valley	year.CNST	die.SC.3MS
qṣr	*w*	*smʿ*	***ʾn***	*myt*
Caesar	CONJ	hear.SC.3MS	COMP	die.SC.3MS
flfṣ				
Philippus				

‘he pastured the camels in the valley the year Caesar died but he had heard that Philippus had died’

12 Verbless clauses

12.1 Gapped verbs and existential clauses

a. Verbless clauses appear most frequently following vocative phrases. These include requests from deities for various favors and boons. There are two possible ways of interpreting such constructions. The first is to assume a gapped verb, implied by the presence of an accusative object. Thus, in KRS 1994 below, the word water *my* would be in the accusative /māya/ implying the imperative *hb* 'give!'.

KRS 1944:

h	*mlk*	*h- smy*	*my*
VOC	king.CNST	ART- sky	water

'O king of the sky (i.e., B'lsmn), let there be water'

On the other hand, it is possible to treat these constructions as unmarked existential clauses. No single existential particle can be reconstructed for PS and each of its sub-branches seems to have developed its own strategy of overtly marking existential clauses. Most contemporary Arabic dialects have grammaticalized a locative phrase, *fi-h* or *bi-h* 'lit. in it'. A similar construction is the source Gz *bo* < *bahu 'in it', and the Akk verb *bašûm* 'to be' also seems to have a similar origin (Huehnergard 2017). The NWS languages, on the other hand, exhibit reflexes of a single existential particle, *'it̲, Arm *'īt*, Hb *yēš*, Ug *'it̲*. The variety of forms and strategies suggests that PS did not have an overt marker of existential predication. Old Arabic, and hence Proto-Arabic, could have preserved this original situation. Existential clauses are not marked for TAM, and so these features must be determined based on their pragmatic context. In such as case, KRS 1944 could be interpreted as 'O king of the sky, let it rain (i.e. let there be water)'.

There are some cases where the interpretation of such constructions as unmarked existential clauses is to be preferred.

AbaNS 1128:

'ty	*'hl -h*	*w*	*my*	*'- ś'm*
come.SC.3MS	family -CPRO.3MS	CONJ	water	ART- north

'he came to his family because there was water in the north'

AZNG 1:

mrd	*ṯlṯ*	*snn*	*mn-qbl*	*nfs*	*ẓlm*
rebellion	three.M	year.PL	against	Nepos	to oppress.APC.MS

'there was a rebellion for three years against Nepos, who was oppressive'

C 3818:

w	*ṯlg*	*b- h- dr*	*b- {r}{ʾ}y*	*ʿqbt*
CONJ	snow	near- ART- place	during- {rising}	scorpio

'and there was snow near this place during the rising of Scorpio'

C 320:

bhʾ	*brkt*	*w*	*b<<>>q{l}*
rejoice.SC.3MS	Brkt	CONJ	{herbage}

'he rejoiced at Brkt because there was herbage'

While in other cases, both analyses are applicable.

C 1084:

rḍy	*ġnmt*	*sbʿ*
Rḍy	spoil	seven

'Rḍy, let there be spoil, seven-fold' or 'Rḍy, (grant) spoil, seven fold'

12.2 Negative existential clauses

a. Safaitic employs the particle *ls*, cognate with CAr *laysa* to form negative existential clauses. Based on its two occurrences, it is impossible to determine if it inflects as a suffix conjugation verb.

OAM1 2b

slt	*h-nʿm*	*f-wlh*	*w-**ls***	*ḫlf*
captured.SC.3FS	ART-livestock	CONJ-distraught.SC.3MS	CONJ-NEG	compensation

'the livestock was captured and so he was distraught and there was no compensation'

AMSI 41

w-m-mt	***ls***	*fṣy*
CONJ-PREP-death	NEG	deliverance

'but from death, there is no deliverance'

12.3 Possessive predication

a. Possessive predication is attested with both definite and indefinite nouns. As with simple existential clauses, possessive predication is also unmarked for TAM.

LP 342:

w	*ġnmt*	*l-ḏ*	*dʿy*
CONJ	spoil	PREP-REL.MS	read aloud.SC.3MS

'and may he who would read aloud have spoil' (lit. and let there be spoil for him who reads aloud)'

WH 368:

ʿwr	*w*	*ʿrg*	*w*	*ḫrs*	*w*
blindness	CONJ	lameness	CONJ	dumbness	CONJ
grb	*w*	*ḥkk*	*l- ḏ*	*yʿwr*	*h- sfr*
scab	CONJ	mange	PREP-REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS	ART- writing

'let there be blindness and lameness and dumbness and scab and mange to him who would efface this writing'

C 3811:

h	*rḍy*	*ġnmt*	*l- qm*	*gyʿ*
VOC	Rḍy	spoil	PREP-people	starving

'O Rḍy, may a starving people have spoil' (lit. let there be spoil for a starving people)

SESP.U17:

h	*bʿlsmn*	*wqyt*	*l- ḏ*	*śrq*
VOC	Bʿlsmn	protection	PREP-REL.MS	travel to desert.SC.3MS

‘O B‘lsmn, may he who has traveled to the inner desert be protected’ (lit. let there be protection for him who has migrated to the inner desert’

LP 562.1:

w	*l -h*	*h- ḍ’n*
CONJ	PREP-CPRO.3MS	ART- sheep

‘and the sheep are his’

SHS 10:

w	*l -h*	[*h-*] *rgm*
CONJ	PREP-CPRO.3FS	[ART-] funerary-cairn

‘and the funerary cairn is hers’

12.4 Locative and Temporal predication

a. The locative/temporal predicate can be introduced by the preposition *b-*.

LP 653:

snt	*lgy*[*n*]	*grmnqṣ*	*b- nq’t*
year.CNST	legions. CNST	Grmnqṣ	at- Nq’t

‘the year the legions of Germanicus were at Nq’t’

12.5 Equational Sentences

a. As in most Semitic languages, the relationship between the subject and the nominal or pronominal predicate is expressed syntactically by juxtaposing the two. Predicative adjectives are distinguished from attributive adjectives in that definiteness is not a concord feature. The definite article only appears on the predicate if it is a noun. The few attested examples of this construction suggest that both subject – predicate and predicate – subject word orders are permissible.

WH 1403.2:

w	***’n***	***frds***	***bn***	***‘rḍ***
CONJ	IPRO.1CS	Frds	son.CNST	‘rḍ

‘and I am Frds[1] son of ‘rḍ’

w	***mt***[***y***]	***h-ḫṭ***{***ṭ***}

C 1185:

CONJ	{Mty}	ART- writer

'and Mty is the writer'

13 Verbal clauses

13.1 Main clauses with indicative verbs

a. The finite verb stands in clause initial position. Pronominal subjects are imbedded in the verb itself, thus *rʿy* 'he pastured', *tśwqt ʾl-* 'she longed for'. The bilingual Safaitic-Greek inscription NEJII 2 demonstrates that the construction *w* + SC – which begins the narrative component of most inscriptions – should be understood as a preterite / perfective rather than a circumstantial clause, as some editors have regarded it. The author renders *w tḥll* with the Greek aorist.

NEJII 2Saf: *l ġṯ w tḥll ʾfwh ʿql sr*
'By Ġawṯ and he departed (this place) into the foremost part of
the protected area of Sayr.'

NEJII 2Grk: Γαυτος ἀπῆλθεν [ε]ἰς τόν Ακελον Σαιρου
'Gawtos departed into the Akel of Sayr'

b. Aside from the finite verb, other elements of the sentence have a relatively free syntax. The data are not plenty enough to determine if agreement features were influenced by the position of the subject, but see the discussion in §6.3.

VERB - SUBJECT - OBJECT

WH 1698:

ngy	*qṣr*	*h-mdnt*
announce.SC.3MS	Caesar	ART- province

'Caesar announced the province (i.e. Province of Arabia)'

SIJ 59:

ḥrbt	*ʾl*	*ʿwḏ*	*ʾl*	*ṣbḥ*
war.SC.3FS	lineage.CNST	ʿwḏ	lineage.CNST	Ṣbḥ

'the lineage of ʿwḏ waged war against the lineage of Ṣbḥ'

VERB – OBJECT – SUBJECT

QZUI 462:

ṭrq	*ʿn-h*	*h-mrd*
smite.SC.3MS	eye -CPRO.3MS	ART- rebel

'the rebel struck out his eye'

WH 1516:

'{ḫ}ḏ	*klb-h*	*ḏ'b*
{take}.SC.3MS	dog -CPRO.3MS	wolf

'a wolf carried off his dog'

VERB - PRONOMINAL OBJECT - SUBJECT

LP 161:

klm-h	*h- 'sd*
injure.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	ART- lion

'the lion injured him'

C 1240:

ḥgz-h	*bʿlsmn*	*ʿl-h-mdnt*
withhold.SC.3MS -CPRO.3S	Bʿlsmn	PREP-ART-province

'Bʿlsˡmn withheld it [the rain] from the province'

VERB – SUBJECT – PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE

RWQ 347:

srt	*'l*	*ḍf*	*l-ʿwḏ*
serve.SC.3MS	lineage.CNST	Ḍf	PREP-ʿwḏ

'the lineage of Ḍf served in a troop for 'wḏ'

VERB - PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE - SUBJECT

LP 325:

dmy	*l-h*	*ʾb-h*
draw.SC.3MS	PREP-CPRO.3MS	father -CPRO.3MS

'his father drew (a picture) for him'

VERB – OBJECT - PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE

KRS 1536:

tẓr	*ʾ- smy*	*b-mlḥ*
wait.SC.3MS	ART- rain	during- Aquarius

'he awaited for the rain during Aquarius'

KRS 1546:

bny	*h-rgm*	*l-gfft*
build.SC.3MS	ART- funerary cairn	for- Gfft

'he built the funerary cairn for Gfft'

VERB – PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE - OBJECT

KRS 51:

bny	*l-ghm*	*h-rgm*
build.SC.3MS	PREP-Ghm	ART- funerary cairn

c. The indirect object of ditransitive verbs is optionally marked by the preposition *l-*. Direct and indirect objects follow the verb and often precede the direct object:

C 1868:

snt	*h- rm*	*śt*	*b- ʾblt*
year.CNST	ART- rome	spend the winter.APC.3MS	at- ʾblt
w	*whb*	*ʾmlk-h*	*ʾḥrs*
CONJ	give.SC.3MS	king.PL -CPRO.3f	guard.PL

'the year Rome (i.e. the romans) was wintering near ʾblt and bestowed upon its rulers guards'

LP 460:

h	*rḍw*	*hb*	*l-ʿbdʾl*	*nqmt*
VOC	Rḍw	give.IMP.2MS	PREP-ʿbdʾl	retribution

‘O Rḍw, grant retribution to ʿbdʾl’

LP 504:

h	*ʾlt*	*flṭ*	*l- rgʿ*	*w*	*hb*
VOC	ʾlt	deliver.INF	PREP-Rgʿ	CONJ	give.IMP.FS
l-h	*nʿm*				
PREP-CPRO.3MS	favor				

‘O ʾlt, deliver Rgʿ and grant him favor’

AbNa 1:

h	*dśr*	*hb*	*sʿd*	*l-nbṭ*
VOC	Dśr	give.IMP.MS	aid	PREP-the Nabataeans
ʿl-ḥwlt				
PREP-Ḥwlt				

‘O Dśr, give aid to the Nabataeans against Ḥwlt’

13.2 Clauses with pragmatic optatives

a. The optative use of the prefix and suffix conjugation generally has the same syntax as their indicative counterparts. In a few cases, SV word order is attested, but these likely reflect a process of topicalization of the subject; see §15 for more examples.

AWS 107:

w	***ḫḍʿ***	*ḏ*	*ḫbl*
CONJ	be debased.SC.3MS	REL.MS	obscure.SC.3MS
w	***rḍy***	*ḏ*	*dʿy*
CONJ	be satisfied.SC.3MS	REL.MS	read aloud.PC.3MS

‘may he who would obscure (this writing) be debased but may he who would read aloud be satisfied’

LP 236:

f	***yq{h}r -h***	*l{h}*	*mṯy{-h }*
so	{make successful}.PC.3MS	{Lh}	journey-{CPRO.3MS}

‘so, may Lh make him successful in his journey’

LP 259:

w	***ġnm-h***	*bʿlsm{y}*	*m-śn[ʾ]*
CONJ	grant spoil.SC.3MS -CPRO.3MS	{Bʿlsmy}	PREP-{enemy.PL}

‘and may Bʿlsmy grant him spoil from enemies’

JbS 1:

ḏkr-h	*rḍy*
remember.SC.3MS –CPRO.3MS	Rḍy

‘may Rḍy be mindful of him’

b. In rare cases, the vocative is the subject of a 2nd person SC with an optative force. In one case, the verb precedes its subject, *lʿt lt mn yḫbl* ‘may you, Lt, curse whosoever would obscure (this writing)’ (CSA 1.2), while in the other examples, it follows its subject, which is marked by the vocative:

LP 687:

h	*lt*	***sʿdt***	*mn*	*dʿy*	*h- sfr*
VOC	Lt	aid.SC.2FS	REL	read aloud.SC.3MS	DEF- writing

‘O Lt, may you aid whosoever would read this writing aloud’

RSIS 80:

h	*lt*	***brkt***	*ʾḫk*	*ḏ*
VOC	Lt	bless.SC.2FS	ʾḫk	REL.MS

‘O Lt, bless ʾḫk of…’

C 4037:

{*h*}	*lt*	***whbt***	*śn' -h*	*bn- yd -h*
VOC	Lt	give.SC.2FS	enemy-CPRO.3MS	PREP-hand.DU.CNST-PRO.3MS

'O Lt, may you give his enemy into his hands'

13.3 The vocative and imperative

a. Vocative phrases usually precede the main clause, which typically consists of an existential clause or a clause containing an imperative or infinitive. Vocative phrases containing more than one element can be introduced by a single vocative particle (1) or by a particle preceding each member of the phrase (2).

C 3811:

h	*lt*	*ḏqn*	*mrn*	*f*	*rwḥ*
VOC	Lt	grow.old.SC.3MS	Mrn	CONJ	ease

'O Lt, Mrn has grown old, so let there be ease'

(1) KRS 2869:

h	*lt*	*w-rḍy*	*w-ḏśr*	*slm*	*ġnmt*
VOC	Lt	CONJ- Rḍy	CONJ-Ḏśr	security	spoil

'O Lt and Rḍy and Ḏśr, let there be security by means of spoil'

(2) HCH 72:

h	*lt*	*w*	***h***	*dśr*	*ṯ'r*
VOC	Lt	CONJ	VOC	Dśr	vengeance
{*l-*}	*mn*	*ḥwlt*			
ASV	against	Ḥwlt			

'O Lt and O Dśr, let there indeed be vengeance against Ḥwlt'

b. The imperatives, along with infinitives and existential sentences signifying requests, usually follow the vocative phrase, but can sometimes precede it as well:

C 5121:

h	*rḍw*	***flṭ-h***
VOC	Rḍw	deliver.IMP.2MS -CPRO.3MS

'O Rḍw, deliver him!'

AWS 290:

h	*ʾlt*	***sʿd***	*ḥrḍt*	*bn*	*ʾbrr*	*w*	***flṭ*** *-h*
VOC	ʾlt	help.IMP.FS	Ḥrḍt	son.CNST	ʾbrr	CONJ	deliver.IMP.FS -CPRO.3MS

'O ʾlt, help Ḥrḍt son of ʾbrr and deliver him!'

SW 264:

h	*yṯʿ*	***ʾġn***	*ʿm-h*
VOC	Yṯʿ	free from want.IMP.MS	people-CPRO.3MS

'O Yṯʿ, free his people from want'

HCH 107:

h	*lt*	***slm***	*ḏ*	*ʾl*	*ḥrm*
voc	Lt	secure.IMP.FS	REL.MS	lineage.CNST	Ḥrm

'O Lt, keep safe the lineage of Ḥrm!'

KRS 1562:

f	***rwḥ***	*ʾy*	*lt*
CONJ	grant ease.IMP.FS	VOC	Lt

'so grant ease, O Lt'

C 1837:

w	***qyt***	*mn-grb*	*h yṯʿ*
CONJ	protect.INF	against- scabies	O Yṯʿ

'and protect against Scabies, O Yṯʿ'

c. Unmarked vocative**:** Some unmarked nouns must be construed as vocatives. Unmarked vocatives, like those marked by a vocative particle, nearly always precede the request. An exception is encountered in CSA 1.2, which contains 2p SC.

w	*rḍw*	***ʿwr***	*m*	*ʿwr-h*

C 1341:

voc	Lt	blind.IMP.FS	REL.MS	efface.SC.MS-CPRO.3MS

'and Rḍw, blind whosoever would efface it'

CSA 1.2

f	*lt*	*w*	*dśr*	***slm***	*ḏ*
CONJ	Lt	CONJ	Dśr	secure.IMP	REL.MS
'l	*yśkr*				
lineage.CNST	Yśkr				

'so, Lt and Dśr, secure him/them of the lineage of Yśkr'

α. The word boundary spelling of the final /w/ of *rḍw* and the first /w/ of *wlh* in C 3177 with one *w* suggests that nouns in the vocative were not followed by a vocalic suffix.

14 The syntax of adverbs

a. Unless topicalized, adverbs follow their heads. The few attest examples, however, do not allow for any further generalizations.

C 2686:

ngʿ	***kbr***	*ʿl- ġyr*
grieve in pain.SC.3MS	continuously	PREP-Ġyr

'he grieved in pain continuously on account of Ġyr'

HaNSB 184:

mlḥ	*f*	*ʿny*	***kbr***
aquarius rose.SC.3MS	CONJ	toil.SC.3MS	continuously

'aquarius rose and toiled continuously'

K 196:

h	*bʿlsmn*	*mwl*	*h- ʾrḍ*	***srʿ***
VOC	Bʿlsmn	make abundant.IMP.MS	ART- land	quickly

'O Bʿlsmn, quickly make this land abundant'

SIJ 1008:

w	*dṯʾ*	*w*	*qy[ẓ]*	*w*	*śty*
CONJ	later rains.INF	CONJ	dry season.INF	CONJ	winter.INF
h-rḥbt	***ʿwd***				
ART- Rḥbt	again				

'while spending the season of the later rains, the dry season, and the winter at this Raḥbah again'

MKWS 8:

f	*gdʿwḏ*	*w*	*śʿhqm*	*ġnmt*	***qrb***
CONJ	Gdʿwḏ	CONJ	S²ʿhqm	spoil	soon

'so Gdʿwḏ and Sʿhqm, let there be spoil soon!'

14.1 Adverbs of specification

a. Unmarked nouns and adjectives used adverbially can specify the quality, content, or material of their head. These always follow the element they modify, but not necessarily directly.

C 4332:

h	*lt*	*ġnmt*	*m- śn’*	***’bl***
VOC	Lt	spoil	PREP-enemy.PL	camel.COL

‘O Lt, let there be spoil from enemies in terms of camels’

C 1837:

h	*’lt*	*slm*	*l- h- mṯyt*	***ḥmt***	*w*
VOC	’lt	security	for- ART- riding	protection	CONJ
qyt	*mn-grb*	*h*	*yṯ‘*		
protect.INF	PREP-scabies	VOC	Yṯ‘		

‘O ’lt, may the riding camel be secure by means of protection (from harm) and protect against scabies, O Yṯ‘’

14.2 Adverbs of circumstance

a. Adverbs of circumstance are usually formed by participles, although at least one example of the use of an infinitive is attested. These adverbs indicate an action or condition which is simultaneous with the main verb. Such forms are always indefinite and were probably marked by the accusative case. All examples are attested with a masculine singular antecedent.

WH 1361:

w	*{r}‘{y}*	*m{d}br*	***{n}wy***	*śty*
CONJ	{pasture}.SC.3MS	{inner desert}	migrate.APC.MS	winter

‘and he {pastured} the {inner desert} while migrating in the winter’

RyD 6822:

w	*wgm*	*‘l- ‘m*	*trḥ*	***mḥll***
CONJ	mourn.SC.3MS	for- ‘m	perish.PC.MS	camping.APC.MS

‘and he grieved while camping for ‘m, who perished’

KRS 1432:

wlh	***mtḏkr***	*ḥbb*	*f*	*ḥbb*
be distraught.SC.3MS	remember.APC.MS	loved one	CONJ	loved one

'he was distraught as he remembered loved one after loved one'

C 1539:

śmr	***ḥ***[*l*]	*h-bt*	[***t***]***śwq***	*'l-lbḥ*
Śmr	camp.APC.MS	ART- tent	long.INF	for- Lbḥ

'Śmr is camping in this tent, longing for Lbḥ'

15 Topicalization

a. Topicalization is rare in the inscriptions and so our knowledge of this phenomenon is extremely limited. In the examples attested so far, the topic is left dislocation of the topic towards the beginning of the clause. Examples of (1) topicalized nouns, (2) prepositional phrases, (3) adverbs, and (4) clauses are attested.

(1)

C 2964:

w	***b's***	*l-h*	*mn- śn'*
CONJ	misfortune	PREP-CPRO.3MS	PREP-enemy.PL

'and misfortune[topic] from enemies was his'

(2)

Ms 6:

l	*'qrb*	*bn*	*'bgr*	***b-msrt***	***'l***
LA	'qrb	son.CNST	'bgr	PREP-troop	lineage.CNST
'mrt	*frs*	*snt*	*ngy*	*ġwṯ*	*bn*
'mrt	horseman	year.CNST	announce.SC.3MS	Ġwṯ	son.CNST
rḍwt					
Rḍwt					

'By 'rbg son of 'bgr who was a horsemen [in the troop of the lineage of 'mrt][topic] the year Ġwṯ bn Rḍwt was announced [commander]'

(3)

ASWS 202:

w	***bḥrt***	*m*	*mṭr*
CONJ	vehemence of heat in July	NEG	rain.SC.3MS

'but during the vehemence of heat in July[topic] it did not rain'

(4)

In KRS 213, the entire apodosis is left-dislocated.

KRS 213:

ḫbl	***ḫrm***	*ʾn*	*ygll*
go mad.SC.3MS	hammer.APC.MS	COND	erase.PC.3MS

‘[may one who hammers go mad [topic]] if he should erase (the inscription)’

16 Syntax of the infinitive

16.1 Infinitive chain

a. As in ASA, an infinitive can replace a finite verb as the non-initial member of a sequence of two or more coordinate verbs which belong to a single semantic unit. Since the infinitive is identical to the suffix conjugation, it is often difficult to determine in the majority of cases whether one encounters a sequence of finite verbs or the infinitive chain. Clear examples occur when the two elements in question are inflected differently.

AbaNS 881:

w	*yqr*	*w*	***gly***	*ʾrḍ*	*t*
CONJ	cold.PC.3MS	CONJ	be cut off.INF	land	DEM.FS

'and he is cold and cut off in this land'

MAHB 5:

rʿy	*h-rmḫ*	*bql*	*w*	***kmʾt***
pasture.SC.3MS	DEF- camel.COL	herbage	CONJ	gather truffles.INF

'he pastured the camels on fresh herbage and gathered truffles'

KRS 78:

h	*lt*	*ryḥ*	*w*	***qyt***
V OC	Lt	grant ease.IMP.FS	CONJ	protect.INF

'O Lt, grant ease and protect'

C 3113:

h	*rḍw*	*flṭ-h*	*m-**bʾs***
VOC	Lt	deliver.IMP –CPRO.3MS	CONJ-protect.INF
w	*ṭʿmt*	*mn-ṣd*	*l-frk bn ltnh*
CONJ	nourish.INF	PREP-game	PREP-Frk bn Ltnh

'O Rḍw, deliver him from misfortune and nourish Frk son of Ltnh with something of game'

b. Since the infinitive chain seems to have been an optional alternative to the use of a series of finite forms. Given the defective orthographic, it is often impossible to identify which construction is being used. Thus, the second "verb" of C 98 (below) could reflect either a finite form or an infinitive, with no change in meaning.

C 98:

w	*ṣyr*	*w*	***rʿy***	*h- ʾbl*
CONJ	return to water.SC.3MS	CONJ	pasture.INF	ART- camel.COL

'and he returned to permanent water and pastured the camels'

α. In the case of the verb *ḏkr*, the infinitive and finite verb seem to have a different syntax – the former takes a direct object introduced by *l-* while the finitive verb does not (e.g. JaS 189.2; JbS 1; RSIS 351).

Mu 253:

wgd	*ʾṯr*	*ʾb -h*	*f*	*bk{y}*
find.SC.3MS	trace.CNST	father -CPRO.3MS	CONJ	{weep.SC.3MS}
w	***ḏkr***	*l- ʾ{ḫ} -h*	*{ʿ}wl*	
CONJ	remember.INF	PREP-{brother} -CPRO.3MS	{ʿwl}	

'and he found the trace of his father so he wept and remembered his {brother} {ʿwl}'

c. As in ASA and NWS, the pronominal subject of an infinitive can be expressed by a clitic pronoun. Since the infinitive is not marked for voice – compare CAr *qatlu zaydin* 'the killing of Zaid' where Zaid can either be the logical subject or object – one must infer whether a passive or active sense is intended.

KRS 37:

l	*ngm bn ẓʿn bn rgl bn ṣʿd*	*w*	***śtt-h***	*nwy*
LA	Gn05	CONJ	winter.INF –CPRO.3MS	pasture

'by Ngm son of Ẓʿn son of Rgl son of Ṣʿd and he spent the winter on pasture'

h	*ʾ{l}{t}*	***sfʾ-hm***
VOC	{ʾlt}	feed.INF -CPRO.3MP

SIJ 1008:

'O Lt, may they (the seasons) provide sustenance'

WH 641.1:

w	***flṭ-h***	*m-lḥyn*
CONJ	deliver.INF-SC.3MS	from-Lḥyn

'and may he be delivered from Lḥyn'

C 4384:

ṣyd	*ḥt*	*wqf*	*f*	*l-* {'}*kl*
hunt.SC.3MS	until	exhaustion	CONJ	asv-{eat.INF}
w	***{q}t-h***			
CONJ	{protect}.INF –CPRO.3MS			

'he hunted until exhaustion so, so may he eat and be protected'

16.2 Commands

a. The infinitive also frequently replaces the imperative in the expression of commands. There was probably a semantic nuance between the two options that is not detectable from our distance. The infinitive of command may sometimes overlap in form and even in meaning with the use of abstract nouns in existential clauses (see §12). These forms can precede or follow their logical subject.

SESP.U 18:

h	*bʿlsmn*	***trwḥ***	*b- mṭr*
VOC	Bʿlsmn	send winds.INF	PREP-rain

'O Bʿlsmn, send the winds with rain!'

C 1137:

w	***fṣy***	*hy*	*'lt*	*m- b's*
CONJ	deliver.INF	voc	'lt	PREP-misfortune

'and deliver, O 'lt, from misfortune!'

16.3 The infinitive to express purpose

a. One of the commonest usages of the infinitive is as a complement of a verb of motion, in which case it expresses purpose, similar to the Latin supine.

KhNSJ 5:

w	*ṣyr*	*qyẓ*	***rʿy***
CONJ	return.SC.3MS	dry season	pasture.INF

‘and he returned to a place of permanent water in the dry season to pasture’

NST 3:

ʾty	***nẓr***	*h- ṯbrn*	*mn-ʾl*	*ṣbḥ*
come.SC.3MS	guard.INF	ART- warriors	PREP- lineage.CNST	Ṣbḥ

‘the warriors from the lineage of Sbḥ came to guard’

LP 742:

wrd	*mn- tlʿn*	***tḍbʾ***
come down.SC.3MS	PREP-*Tlʿn*	raid.INF

‘he came down from Tlʿn to raid’

KRS 37:

rgʿ	*b- ʾbl*	***rʿy*** [[]]	*l-ḥrt*	*ʿf*
return.SC.3MS	with-camel.COL	pasture.INF	PREP-Ḥrt	‘awf.CNST
ht				
low-lying land				

‘he returned towards the Ḥarrah with camels to pasture on ‘awf (plants) of low-lying land’

KRS 2420:

wrd	***ʾʿly***	*h*	*ṣwy*	*ʾbgr*
come down.SC.3MS	raise.INF	DEM	cairn.CNST	ʾbgr

‘he came to raise this cairn of ʾbgr’

JaS 159.2:

gls	***ḥlt***
halt.SC.3MS	camp.INF

‘he halted to camp’

In one case, the infinitive occurs with the verb *mrd* 'to rebel' to express purpose. It may be the case that speakers interpreted this as a verb of motion, perhaps similar to English 'to go against' or 'to go up against'.

KRS 1023:

mrd	*ʿl-h-mlk*	*grfṣ*	***ksr***	{*h-*} *sl*{*s*}[*lt*]
rebel.SC.3MS	PREP-ART-king	Grfṣ	break.INF	ART-bonds

'he rebelled against king Agrippa to break the bonds (of slavery)'

16.4 The infinitive with *b-*

a. Infinitives preceded by the preposition *b-* denote an action preformed either simultaneously or in close temporal proximity with the main event.

WH 3559.1:

w	*tẓr*	*h- smy*	***b-ḥḍr***
CONJ	await.SC.3MS	ART- sky	PREP-camp by water.INF
w	*wrd*	*brkt*	
CONJ	go to water.SC.3MS	Brkt	

'he awaited the rains while camping by permanent water and went to water at Brkt'

WH 3584:

w	*tẓr*	*h- smy*	***b-ḥḍr***
CONJ	await.SC.3MS	ART- sky	PREP-camp near water.INF

'he awaited the rains while camping by permanent water'

16.5 Cognate infinitive

a. The cognate infinitive amplifies the meaning of the main verb.

WH 116:

ḥy{*b*}	ʿ[*l*]- *mḥbb*	***ḥb***
lament.SC.3MS	PREP-loved one	lament.INF

'he lamented greatly over a loved one'

WH 613:

f	*gdḍf*	*slm*	*m- śn'*	***slm***
so	Gdḍf	secure.SC.3MS	PREP-enemy.PL	secure.INF

'so Gdḍf, may he be very secure from enemies'

17 Relative and subordinate clauses

17.1 Relative clauses

a. There are three types of relative clauses: the first is introduced by a relative pronoun *ḏ, ḏ'ṯ, ḏw* (syndetic relative), the second is formed by pronominal resumption linking the subordinate and matrix clauses (asyndetic relatives), and the third comprises a sentential genitive construction (construct-genitive relative). All relative clauses follow the main clause:

b. Syndetic relative: These clauses occur most frequently as a component of lineage chains which introduce tribal affiliation, *ḏ ʾl* 'of the lineage/people'. Outside of this context, they are rare, simply because they are not a component of most inscriptional formulae. A few clear examples however are attested, but these all occur with definite heads. It is unclear whether the ***ḏ*** can occur with an indefinite antecedent.

LP 183:

wgd	*sfr*	*mʿr*	***ḏ***	*ʿwq*
find.SC.3MS	writing.CNST	Mʿr	REL.MS	imprison.SC.3MS

'he found the writing of Mʿr who was imprisoned'

LP 1261:

l	*dbṣy*	*bn*	*ksṭ*	***ḏ***	*nkr*	*h-śn{ʾ}*
LA	Dbṣy	son.CNST	Ksṭ	REL.MS	contend.SC.3MS	ART-{enemy}

'By Dbṣy son of Ksṭ who has contended with the enemy'

C 1758:

wgm	*ʿl- ʾśyʿ-h*	***ḏ***	*nsl*
grieve.SC.3MS	PREP-companion.PL-CPRO.3MS	REL.MS	captured.SC.3MP
b-ṯbr			
PREP-Sagittarius			

'he despaired on account of his companions who were captured during Sagittarius'

The relative pronoun ***ḏ*** often stands as the definite head of free relative clauses, meaning 'he who':

KRS 1042:

w	*rḍy*	***ḏ***	*dʿy*
CONJ	be satisfied.SC.3MS	REL.MS	read aloud.SC.3MS
w	*lʿn*	***ḏ***	*yḫbl*
CONJ	be cursed.SC.3MS	REL.MS	obscure.PC.3MS

'may he who would read aloud be satisfied and he who would obscure be cursed'

Free relative clauses with an indefinite head are introduced by ***m***:

Ms 44:

h	*gdḍf*	*lʿn*	*ḏ*	*yʿwr*	***m***	*yhnʾ*
VOC	Gdḍf	curse.IMP.2MS	REL.MS	efface.PC.3MS	REL	please.PC.3MS

'O Gdḍf, curse him who would efface what pleases'

AWS 236:

h	*rḍw*	*hb*	*l-h*	***m***	*hnʾ*
VOC	Rḍw	give.IMP.2M	to-cpro.3MS	REL	please.SC.3MS

'O Rḍw, grant him what would please'

c. Asyndetic relative: These clauses are bound to the matrix clause through the agreement of its verb or pronoun with its antecedent. Unlike CAr, asyndetic relative clauses can be used with definite heads as well.

CSNS 1004:

wgm	*ʿl- bn*	*dd -h*
grieve.SC.3MS	PREP-son.CNST	paternal uncle -CPRO.3MS
msby	***sbyt-h***	***ṯy'***
capture.PPC.MS	capture.SC.3FS -CPRO.3MS	Ṯy'

'he grieved for the son of his paternal uncle, who was captured, whom Ṯy' captured'

C 1186:

w	*l-h*	*h-mhrt*	***yrbb-h***
CONJ	for -CPRO.3MS	ART- filly	train.PC.3MS -CPRO.3FS

'and the filly, which he is training, is his'

KRS 995:

nq'ṯ	*b- wdd -h*	***yḫbl***	***h-ḫ{ṯ}{ṯ}***
thrown out.INF	by- beloved -CPRO.3MS	obscure.PC.3MS	ART- {writing}

'and may he would obscure this writing be thrown out (of his grave) by his loved one'

ISB 91:

w	*l-h*	*h- frs*	***ʿnd -h***
CONJ	PREP-CPRO.3MS	ART- horse	PREP-CPRO.3MS

'and by him is the horse, which belongs to him'

α. Attributive participles modifying noun phrases can be interpreted as asyndetic relative clauses or adnominal phrases. In this function, the participle never exhibits agreement in definiteness, distinguishing it from other attributive adjectives.

C 4039:

qṣf	*ʿl- 'l*	*ḏ'b*	*w*	*n'nl*	***ḍlln***
be sad.SC.3MS	PREP-lineage.CNST	D'b	CONJ	N'nl	lost.PPC.MP

'he was sad on account of the lineage of D'b and N'nl who were lost'

HCH 131:

ndm	*ʿl- klb -h*	***ḏll***
be devastated.SC.3MS	PREP-dog-CPRO.3MS	lost.PPC.MS

'he was devasted by grief on account of his dog who was lost'

SESP.U 13:

ḫrṣ	*ʾḫw-h*	***mśrqn***
watch.SC.3MS	brother.DU.CNST –CPRO.3MS	migrate to desert.APC.MDU

'he kept watch for his two brothers, who were migrating to the inner desert'

HH 1:

ḫrṣ	*ʾśyʿ-h*	***ḏbʾn***
watch.SC.3MS	companion.PL.CNST – CPRO.3MS	raid.APC.MP

'he kept watch for his companions who were on a raid'

The agent of the passive participle is an adnominal modifier; the two do not form a construct-genitive chain.

KRS 6:

wlh	*ʿl-hm*	*l-ʾbd*	*w*	*ʿl- zkr*
distraught.SC.3MS	PREP-CPRO.3MPL	forever	CONJ	PREP-Zkr
w	*ʿl- ḫlṣ*	***rġmn***	***mny***	*kll-hm*
CONJ	PREP-Ḫlṣ	strike down.PPC.MP	Fate	QUANT-CPRO.3MP

'he was distraught over them forever and over Zkr and over Hlṣ who were struck down by Fate, all of them'

d. Construct-genitive**:** Relative clauses of this type occupy the position of the genitive in a construct-genitive chain. These types occur almost exclusively in temporal constructions headed by the word *snt* 'year'. A similar construction is attested in CAr with *yawm* 'day' (e.g. Q 3:30).

mrd	*ʿl-rm*	***snt***	***ʾty***	***h- mḏy***	***bṣry***

SIJ 78:

rebel.SC.3MS	PREP-Rome	year.CNST	come.SC.3M	ART- Persians	Bostra

'he rebelled against Rome the year the Persians came to Boṣrā'

KhNSJ 1:

g{l}s	*mn-*	*ʾ- dmt*	***snt***	***mt***	***mlk***	***nbṭ***
{stop}.SC.3MS	PREP-	ART- downpour	year.CNST	die.SC.3MS	king.CNST	Nbṭ

'he stopped briefly on account of the downpour the year the king of Nabaṭaea died'

17.2 Purpose and result clauses

a. With the particle *l-*: Purpose clauses can be formed using *l-* with the prefix conjugation, equivalent to the *li-yafʿala* construction in CAr.

WH 3053:

rḥḍ	*b-h-ngm*	***l-yḥg***
wash.SC.3MS	PREP-Virgo	PREP-pilgrimage. PC.3MS

'he washed during Virgo in order to perform a pilgrimage'

LP 712:

wrd	*b-rʾy*	*ḏl*	[***l-***] {***y***}***śrb***
go to water.SC.3MS	PREP-rising.CNST	Pisces	[to]- {drink}.PC.3MS

'he went to water at the rising of Pisces in order to drink'

α. The infinitive can form a purpose clause introduced by *l-*, comparable to the Hb infinitive construct *liqṭôl.*

C 4803:

h	*b{ʿ}lsmn*	*slm*	***l- nʿm***	*ḥl*
VOC	{Bʿlsmn}	security	ease.INF	camping

'O Bʿlsmn let there be security to make camping easy'

KRS 1575:

h	*yṯ‘*	*flṭ*	***l-‘lgt-h***
VOC	Yṯ‘	deliver.IMP.MS	ease.INF

‘O Yṯ‘, grant deliverance to heal him’

b. With *w and f:* A sequence of modal verb forms (or an existential sentence with a modal sense) can signify purpose or result without the use of the *l-*. The second verb is introduced with the conjunction *w* and, less frequently, *f*. This phenomenon is widespread across the Semitic languages, and is known in CAr, where *fa-* is more often used (Fischer 2001, §410). The prefix and suffix conjugation and the infinitive are attested in the logically dependent clause.

LP 495:

h	*rḍw*	*flṭ-n*	*m- b’s*
VOC	Rḍw	deliver.IMP.2MS -CPRO.1CP	PREP-misfortune
w	***nḥyy***		
CONJ	live.GPC.1C		

‘O Rḍw, deliver us from evil that I/we may live long’

WH 135:

h	*lt*	*qbll*	*’hl*
VOC	Lt	reunion	family-(CPRO.1CS)
slm	***f***	***nngy***	
security	so	save.PC.1C	

‘O Lt, let there be a safe reunion with (my) family that I/we may be saved’

C 2967:

’{ġ}yr	*ḍ‘f*	***w***	***ġny***
be removed.SC.3MS	weakness	CONJ	prosper.SC.3MS

‘may weakness be removed that he may prosper’

MA 1:

ḏbḥ	*l-rḍy*	***w***	***ġnm***	*nqt*
sacrifice.SC.3MS	PREP-Rḍy	CONJ	grant.SC.3MS	she-camel

‘he performed a sacrifice for Rḍy that he (Rḍy) may grant a she-camel as spoil’

C 4457:

w	[*g*]*dʿwḏ*	*rwḥ*	*m- ʾsr*	***w***
and	{Gdʿwḏ}	ease.IMP.2MS	PREP-captivity	CONJ
slm				
be secure.SC.3MS				

'and Gdʿwḏ, grant ease to whosoever was captured that he may be secure'

C 31:

śtky	*ʾl- lt*	*f*	*ḥnn*	***w***
petition.SC.3MS	to- Lt	so	show compassion.IMP.2FS	CONJ
slm	*m-śnʾ*			
secure.sc.3ms	PREP-enemy.PL			

'he petitioned Lt, so show compassion that he may be secure against enemies'

α. The phrase *w slm*, which commonly occurs in prayers, can be interpreted in two ways: (1) as a result clause of the preceding request or (2) an existential sentence containing the noun 'security', e.g. HaNSB 197 *h bʿlsmn ġyrt w slm* (1) 'O Bʿlsmn, let there be abundance that he may be secure' or (2) 'O Bʿlsmn, let there be abundance and security'. In such cases, a decision between the two is simply an editorial choice.

17.3 Logically subordinated clauses with *w* and *f*

a. Both conjunctions can introduce dependent clauses which are logically, if not formally, subordinate to the preceding non-modal clause. Such clauses usually indicate reason and are best translated as 'because' or 'as'.

CSNS 1021:

w	*wgm*	*ʿl-swd*	*w*	***trḥ***
CONJ	grieve.SC.3MS	PREP-Swd	CONJ	perish.SC.3MS

'and he grieved for Swd because he perished'

SG 1:
= LP 722

w	*ʿlf*	*h- mʿzy*	*snt*	*b'ṣ*
CONJ	feed on fodder.SC.3MS	ART-goat.PL	year.CNST	misfortune
w	***ḥgz-h***	***bʿlsmn***		
CONJ	withhold.SC.3MS -CPRO.3S	Bʿlsmn		

'and he fed the goats on dry fodder during a year of misery because Bʿlsmn withheld the rain'

KRS 1051:

w	*wgm*	*ʿl- {'}{ḥ} -h*	*ḥry*	***f***	***myt***
CONJ	grieve.SC.3MS	PREP-{brother}-CPRO.3MS	Ḥry	CONJ	die.SC.3MS

'and he grieved for his brother, Ḥry, because he died'

NST 2:

ʿbs	***w***	***rġmt***	***mn***[***y***]
austere.SC.3MS	CONJ	struck down.SC.3FS	{Fate}

'he was austere because she was struck down by Fate'

18 Circumstantial clauses

a. Circumstantial clauses indicate an action that occurs simultaneously with the main event, similar to the circumstantial accusative discussed above. These clauses are introduced by the coordinating conjunction *w* or *f*. Circumstantial clauses can range in size from a single term to an entire sentence. Any grammatical form can follow the conjunction; however, it seems that participles require the resumption of the subject in the circumstantial clause by an independent pronoun. Suffix conjugated verbs in circumstantial clauses refer to a past circumstance while other elements are unbound by time. Since the suffix conjugation and the infinitive are often identical, one must distinguish between the two in these situations based on context.

Circumstantial clause with a participle

KRS 1684:

h	*lt*	*w*	*gdḍf*	*slm*	*w*	*mgd*
VOC	Lt	CONJ	Gdḍf	security	CONJ	abundance
w	***h***	***ṭlq***	***l-h-dṣy***			
CONJ	IPRO.3MS	set off.APC.MS	for- ART- ibex			

'O Lt and Gdḍf, let there be security and abundance as he sets off for ibex'

Circumstantial clause with a locative noun or prepositional phrase

C 3140:

wg{d}	*ʾṯr*	*ʿm-h*	*f*	*b{k}y*
{find}.SC.3MS	trace.CNST	grandfather -CPRO.3MS	so	{cry}.SC.3MS
w	***h-ṣwy***			
CONJ	ART- cairn			

'he found the trace of his grandfather so he cried while at the cairn'

Circumstantial clause with a suffix conjugated verb

b. Circumstantial clauses containing a suffix conjugated verb can either signify the past or future tense, depending on the semantics of the main clause.

C 4815:

ngʿ	*ʿl-klbh*	*bn-h*	***w***	***rʿy***
grieve in pain.SC.3MS	PREP-Klbh	son-CPRO.3MS	CONJ	pasture.SC.3MS
{h-}{ʾ}{b}l	***wḥd***			
{ART}- {camel}.COL	alone			

'he grieved in pain for Klbh, his son, while he pastured the camels alone'

SIJ 1008:

gdʿw[ḏ]	*nw{y}*	*w*	*ʾqwy*
{Gdʿwḏ}	{pasture}	CONJ	grant endurance.INF
w	***dṯʾ***	***w***	***qy[ẓ]***
CONJ	later rains.SC.3MS	CONJ	dry season.SC.3MS
w	***s²ty***	***h-rḥbt***	***ʿwd***
CONJ	winter.sc.3ms	ART-Raḥbah	again

'Gdʿwḏ, let there be pasture and grant endurance as spends the season of the later rains, the summer, and the winter at this Raḥbah again'

LP 597:

ḫrṣ	*ʿl-rgl-h*	***w***	***ḥḍr***
watch.SC.3MS	PREP-soldier.PL -CPRO.3MS	CONJ	camp at water.SC.3MP

'he watched over his soldiers while they camped by permanent water'

19 Coordination

a. The conjunction used to link two syntactically equal elements is *w*:

KRS 1683:

ḥll	*h-dr*	*b- ʾhl -h*
camp.SC.3MS	ART-place	PREP-family-CPRO.3MS
w	*ḫr{ṣ}*	*ʿl-ʾbl-h*
CONJ	{watch}.SC.3MS	PREP-camel.COL -CPRO.3MS

'he camped here with his family and watched over his camels'

HCH 72:

wgm	*ʿl- hnʾ*	*trḥ*	***w***	*ʿl- ʿbdy*	*mqtl*
grieve.SC.3MS	PREP-Hnʾ	perish.PPC.MS	CONJ	PREP-ʿbdy	kill.PPC.MS

'he grieved for Hnʾ, who perished, and for ʿbdy, who was killed'

b. The conjunction can also have an adversative meaning, 'but'.

Ms 44:

myt	*qṣr*	***w***	***smʿ***	***ʾn***	***myt***
die.SC.3MS	Caesar	CONJ	hear.SC.3MS	CONJ	die.SC.3MS
flfṣ	*f*	*sḫr*			
Philip	CONJ	be fooled.SC.3MS			

'Caesar died but he heard that Philipp had died and was fooled'

HCH 194:

w	*nfr*	*f*	*ʾslm*	***w***	***b{ʿ}{d}***	***ʾflt***
CONJ	flee.SC.3MS	CONJ	surrender.SC.3MS	CONJ	{after}	escape.SC.3MS

'and he fled, and then surrendered, but escaped afterwards'

19.1 Sequential narrative

a. Clauses which express a sequence of events whereby the second is temporally or logically anterior to the first are connected by the coordinator *f-*, and only rarely by *w*.

C 2713:

wgd	*ʾṯr*	*ʾśyʿ -h*	*f*	*bʾs*
find.SC.3MS	trace.CNST	companion.PL -CPRO.3MS	CONJ	miserable.SC.3MS

'he had found the trace of his companions and so he was miserable'

Mu 867:

w	*śty*	{*b-*} *ʿrḍ*	*h-nmrt*	***w***
CONJ	winter.SC.3MS	{PREP-}valley.CNST	ART-nmrt	CONJ
qyẓ				
dry.season.SC.3MS				

'and he spent the winter near the valley of al-Namārah and then the dry season'

b. The distinction between *w* and *f* is best illustrated by the following pair:

C 793:

wgd	*sfr*	*ʿm -h*	*f*	*ngʿ*
find.SC.3MS	writing.CNST	grandfather -CPRO.3MS	CONJ	grieve in pain.SC.3MS

'he had found the writing of his grandfather, so he grieved in pain'

C 2196:

wgd	*sfr*	*qḥś*	***w***	*ngʿ*	*ʿl- mty*
find.sc.3ms	writing.CNST	Qḥś	CONJ	grieve in pain.SC.3MS	for- Mty

'he found the writing of Qḥś and he grieved in pain for Mty'

20 Conditional clauses

a. Basic conditional clauses can be formed through the juxtaposition of two modal verbs or two verbless sentences with a modal force. Similar constructions are known from CAr, e.g. *man ǧāla tāla* 'he who wanders will find something' or even the famous introduction of Imruʾu l-Qays's *muʿallaqah*, *qifā nabki* 'stop, let us weep' (see Fischer 2001, §446).

Mu 278:

w	*m*	*{m}ḫbl*	*h- sfr*	*nqʾt*
CONJ	REL	obscure.APC.MS	ART-writing	thrown out.INF
l-ʾḫ-h				
PREP-brother -CPRO.3MS				

'and whosoever should obscure this writing, let his brother be thrown out (of the grave)'

RWQ 73:

h	*dśr*	*m*	*ẓlm*	*msk*	*f*	*bqr*
VOC	Dśr	REL	oppress.SC.3MS	msk	CONJ	split.INF

'O Dśr, whosoever would oppress Msk, split [him] in two!'

α. The common curse formula *ʿwr m yʿwr* 'blind whosoever would efface' belongs to this type of conditional clause.

Only a couple of examples attest the use of an overt conditional particle to mark the protasis.

AWS 237:

ʾm	*m*	*ʿwr*	*h*	*rḍw*	*f*
CONJ	REL	efface.SC.3MS	VOC	Rḍw	CONJ
l	*yʿwr*				
ASV	be made blind.SC.3MS				

'and if one would efface, O Rḍw, then let him be made blind'

KRS 213:

ql	*ḫbl*	*ḫrm*	***ʾn***	*ygll*
say.SC.3MS	be.insane.SC.3MS	hammer.APC.MS	COND	erase.PC.3MS

‘he said: may one who hammers go insane if he should erase (the inscription)’